Deathless

Sermon series transcript

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Part 1

The Nature of the Law

...understand about the law is that the law brought death. Okay? So when death is an enemy, and we literally are introduced to its chauffeur, if we kill the chauffeur, the enemy doesn't show up, right? So the law brought death. The Bible says the law brought about wrath, right? The word "brought about" in the Greek language means "made you fit for." Good. Right, so here's what we need to understand: the law is actually much more than the law of Moses. There's two things that the Bible refers to as the law. It's the law of Moses and the fundamental elements of the world, and when you get delivered from those two things, you'll be immortal. The law of Moses is the simple instruction that God gave to the Israelites to condemn them. The basic principles of the world: the word "world" was the Greek word kosmos. It was a harmonious agreement, or a contractual arrangement.

It means that you can be delivered from A plus B equals C, or one plus one equals two, or 50 years equals retirement, or 70 years equals death. Those are the fundamental elements of the world. So we need to be able to step away from the law to step away from death. So I'm going to make covenant make sense. If you're not free from poor understandings of covenant, then you will actually continue to die by faith. Humans did not lose their dominion; humans lost their identity. Humans lost their identity through the law. We need to expound our understanding of the law way past the law of Moses. Here's why. John 1, which we talked about last night, is the spiritual perspective of creation. Genesis 1 was the natural perspective of creation. John was correcting what was written in Genesis when he says, "Moses gave you the law, but grace and truth came through Jesus."

I would invite you to consider that the law is more than what was spoken on tablets in Exodus 19. There was a moment when Jesus was speaking to God as a man speaks to a friend, face to face, right? So the garbage of being separate from God, it's still garbage. After Moses was speaking to God face to face as a man talks to his friend, Moses requested of God that God show him His glory, right? Yeah. Then He shows him His butt, unless you responsibly approach Scripture. Okay? It says that God showed Moses His hinder parts, which is not His butt, unless you think God's butt is more glorious than His face. You guys are a tough crowd. I want to make this make sense, okay? So Moses... so He hides him. Yep. He hides him in the Word. He hides him in Christ, so Moses can actually get the perspective of God's creation.

What do you think God spoke to Moses when he was asked to show him His glory? "In the beginning." Moses authored Genesis, right? Moses authored Genesis through divine

revelation. When he was asked to see God's glory, God showed him His creation. But we would have never known that creation had another destiny outside of being governed by our senses, outside of Moses showing us that we had a different destiny prior to the fall. This is how the law came through Moses. Moses showed us that if you try to do something to become like God, you'll die. It's in the first three chapters of your Bible. The tree of the knowledge of good and evil killed humanity, not because of the fruit's function, but because of the heart posture required to desire to partake of it. I want to make it more practical than theological.

I had a friend that, he's literally, he carries the most incredible new creation marriage revelation of anyone in the world, and he used to call and ask me trick questions, and I'm so glad he did. So when my wife and I got married... this might be a long story. When my wife and I got married, I wanted to be her savior. My wife and I were... excuse me, my wife was beaten, she was neglected, she was left for dead. She had been through everything that you could ever imagine a woman is not supposed to go through. So when I met this woman, I just wanted to not be that to her. So I did what every man would do, and I became a... right? "I don't want you to be afraid of me, so I'll be spineless." And if you are not... as a man, I'll give you some marriage advice. A man is a synthesis of power and love, right? Lord and Savior.

And if you're either one of them out of proportion, you become equally abusive on both sides. If you're power and no love, your wife will be attracted to you because you can protect her, but if you don't have love commingled with your power, eventually your power will turn towards her and she'll be the object of your aggression. Here's where I stood: if you're love and no power, you'll be all good intentions and no follow-through. Yep. You'll be her knight in shining armor and not her king. You'll do what she says instead of what she needs, right? So Eric called me and he said, "Hey, how's the masculinity thing coming?" I said, "It's getting better." He said, "That's your problem." Okay? When it comes to being in Christ, when it comes to the finished work, there is no striving. I said, "It's getting better." He said, "That's your problem."

He said, "The finished work of Christ is not something you can improve on. You step in or stay out, period." When it comes to life in Christ, you cannot look for visible evidence. The Bible says His Spirit bears witness with your spirit that you're a son of God. It will not bear witness with your senses first. It will not bear witness with your intellect first. His Spirit bears witness with your spirit, and then internal governance is the key to life. The Spirit gives life to your mortal body, right? Your mortal body is the garment that the woman with the issue of blood touches, but you are the life-giving spirit that enables the garment to have a point of contact with creation that needs redeemed. How about this? You realize there was only one species that had authority on earth to redeem creation? Humans. Humans. God won't. God can't.

As a matter of fact, if you want to know why God didn't jump in and stop Eve from partaking of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, it's because you could never trust Him again when He says, "Let them have dominion." If He starts to see you screw up and He's like, "Wait, wait, don't do that," He's traversed His own guideline, and He can never be sovereign or trustworthy. So for 4,000 years, God's will was written out of human history, and He could only accomplish His will through a human being, on earth as it is in heaven. Good, I like it. So here's the deal: you lose your body, you lose your dominion. If the fullness of God's intention for His creation is that it would be redeemed by human beings that look like God, then why would death be part of the plan, right?

Hebrews chapter 11. Hebrews chapter 11 is a list of the people that have died and a record of their jealousy. I really try not to attack people's beliefs about the afterlife, but if you think death brings perfection, then you crucified your Savior. Refresh. Yep. And it's completely anti-biblical. The end of chapter 11 says they won't be made perfect apart from us. Yep. So the people that have died and gone to heaven are not perfect; they're waiting on perfection. Perfection is in a resurrection. The glory of God is in creation, right? I'm not teaching what I intended on teaching at all. We haven't talked about covenant yet.

You can't step into what God has given you from before the foundation of the world through earning, striving, trying, and deserving. You can only do this by believing that you're already the thing, right? And if you're trusting senses, experience, or effort to get you there, it'll literally kill you. They died because they stretched out their hand to grasp something that was already theirs, right? Good stuff. Okay, all right, so we've got 15 minutes for me to explain covenant to you.

Covenant and Origins

Here's why the law is a problem: the law brought death, right? 2 Corinthians chapter 3, Paul refers to the law as two things. As a matter of fact, let's talk about Paul real quick. Why do you think Paul hated the law so much? He was an immortal, and he knew what the law did. You know what Paul said in Galatians 3 about people who taught the law? Are we all adults here? He wanted to cut their genitals off. Read your Bible. It literally says that. Do you know what he wanted to do to angels that preached the law? Curse them. He said, "If anyone comes and preaches to you any other gospel, curse them." You're a life-giving spirit. Curse anyone or angels that try to take life from you and give you death as a savior. And if somebody comes and tries to compel you to be circumcised, hand them the knife, right? Legalists can't have any more babies.

Hi, beautiful. What were we talking about before that? I'm sure it was good. Oh, Paul. Most of Paul's preaching... so the intention of Paul's gospel was to bring you life and immortality, but the thing that he spent the most time tearing down was legalism, because he knew that if you were held under either the elementary principles of the world or the law of Moses, then you would continue to strive and die if you couldn't just step into something that's already done. We read from 2 Timothy last night. He literally gave us life and immortality before the foundation of the world, but it was revealed in Christ through the gospel. You lack nothing. These subtleties, these susceptibilities to step into immortality, depend on us being able to completely let go of our earning, striving, trying, and deserving, and trusting that He has already set us in Him before the foundation of the world.

The moment that you reach out your hand, you die. The moment that you think you have to eat something, follow a rule, read a book, attend a place... Listen, the local church is the hope of the world, but your attendance doesn't make you immortal. Your nature draws you to the local church. Good. The law brought death. Moses gave you the law, not just through what happened on Mount Sinai, but he literally showed you that the moment humans started to try to become what they already were, it killed them. Can I give you a little bit, because I don't want to talk about this next session, about the origin of the law? Have you ever seen the Bible call it the law of God? That's not the Bible, by the way, but it's really close. Wrong book. It calls it the law of Moses. It doesn't say the law came through God; it says the law came through Moses.

So if you approach Exodus 19, the introduction of the law, as a Berean, you'll realize that God did not desire the law. God only gives one type of covenant. It's called a royal grant covenant. It's where the greater blesses the lesser. And He said, "Why don't you all come up the mountain?" Listen. "Why don't you all," right, "come up the mountain?" That's right. He said, "You'll be My people, I'll be your God. I'll send hornets ahead of you to drive out every enemy that would ever possess your promise." Period. The end. No laws. As a matter of fact, there were two laws that He gave them when they came out of Egypt. Do you know what they were? Keep the Passover; observe the Sabbath. Life and rest. Take a day off; remember your freedom. That's it.

So God delivers this message, this invitation, to the children of Israel. And by the way, He said, "You'll all be My priests." Do you know what priests do? They reconcile humanity back to God. So had the Israelites listened, there would not have been enemies. They would have been displaced by hornets and reconciled by priests. So God would have apprehended all of humanity through the work of the Israelites in their priesthood, right? So God never desired to ostracize portions of humanity. God never desired... okay, this is where we're gonna go here,

and then we're gonna go to the next session. God never desired to judge a human being.

Legalism vs. Life

Have you ever heard "God is love, but He's also wrath"? Prove it. It's not in your Bible. It's not in your Bible, but I'll make it make sense to you. God's faithful. That's an attribute of His character. So if He makes a promise, He'll make good on it, even if it's contrary to His character. So God offers humanity a suzerain-vassal covenant, which means, "I'm going to give you things if you come up the mountain." That's it. No laws. There were no laws. But these slaves from Egypt had only seen the types of covenant that their Pharaoh had made, which were not good covenants. They were actually called kinship covenants. They were made between two equals. So they reduced God to their own intellect and understanding, and they demanded a different covenant from Him. This is why it's called the law of Moses and not the law of God. The law of God was rejected; the law of Moses was demanded by humans. Yep.

Can I show you what it looks like? Michael King, can I borrow you? Who else? Where's Tom? Tom, I'll borrow you too. Come on up here real quick. All right, you guys stand right here. Tom is the king of country A. Okay, actually, let's do Egypt. He's Pharaoh, right? He's a good king, though; there were none. But Michael is the king of Laodicea. Okay? And Rome is going to come pillage this guy's stuff. So what do they do? They make a kinship covenant. He agrees that if Rome comes to his place, he's calling Michael, and Michael and all his guys are heading to Egypt, right? They become partners in covenant. And likewise, if Rome shows up on his doorstep, he's coming to Michael's place, and they're partners in covenant. Here's the problem: these guys serve different gods. So you know what they have to do? They have to draft two copies of their partnership agreement. Two copies of their partnership agreement. Starting to sound familiar?

And then this guy... have you ever heard the term "I swear to God"? This is where it came from. This guy has to put his copy of his contract in a box. Then he has to take his copy of his contract to his temple, and he has to look at his god and say, "I've sworn to be in partnership with Michael King, and if I am unfaithful to my partnership in covenant with Michael King, then I'm punishable to you." Okay? He does the same thing. He takes his copy of the contract to his temple, and he says, "I've made a contract with Pharaoh, and if I'm unfaithful to my contract with Pharaoh, I swear to God that I'm punishable to you." That's how these guys earn trust, right? They've become punishable to their god to be faithful to their covenant with one another. Okay? Now, two copies of the contract that go in a box. The box was called an ark. Yep. An ark of the covenant.

So all of these holy, like, tabernacle fixtures and furnishings, they were Roman before they were Israelite, right? So now humanity makes a partnership agreement with God that says, "We'll be faithful to keep your 619 commandments." And God says, "Well, I don't have a temple. Why don't you take both copies?" Right? He literally said, "I can swear by no one higher than Myself, so here's both copies of your covenant." They put them in a box, right? They're used to this practice. So they truck this box into their temple, and lo and behold, their God, the God that they just made partnership with... now they're in mad trouble, right? Because they say, "We just made a covenant with You, and we're demanding that You punish us if we break it." You get it? So God, I don't want to say He gets Himself in a bind, but He knows that He's going to use this season in history to deliver humanity into life. But they have to see. They have to see that the law can't bring life.

As a matter of fact, it says the law brought death, right? And it said even before the commandment was given, death reigned from Adam to Moses. But they gave the law that it could be highlighted. Paul said the law did three things to him: it confined him under sin, it condemned his conscience, and it aroused his sin nature. He said, "I literally wouldn't have been jealous if you didn't tell me not to be," right? So it amplified the distorted form of humanity. When you amplify something, you can fix it. There's a children's book called, what's it called, Dragons Don't Exist. You guys ever heard about it? Jordan Peterson talks about it all the time. And this mom goes up the stairs, and the kid's bedroom is all torn apart, and he's like, "A dragon did it." And obviously it's illustrated; there's this little tiny dragon in the back of the room. And she's like, "Dragons don't exist."

So she comes downstairs, and Mom's fixed breakfast for everybody, and then all the breakfast is gone, and the son's like, "A dragon did it." The dragon has now gotten a little bit bigger, but you can still see it in the background of the picture. The mom's like, "Dragons don't exist." And then by the end of the book, you literally see the dragon's head sticking out the window and its legs out of the foundation of the house, and the mailman is standing there putting mail in the mailbox, but the house is gone. And the son's like, "The dragon's walking away with the house." The mom's like, "Dragons don't exist." And then they find the dragon. The house is in pieces. The mom's like, "Maybe dragons do exist," in the sense, "and maybe you just wanted to be noticed." Sometimes you have to amplify the problem in order for it to get the attention it deserves. Get it?

So the law came that it might show sin, the distorted form of humanity, so that now humanity would be aware that they were created for something better. Does that make sense? Yeah. So the law wasn't a righteous requirement. It wasn't to make you more like God; it was to prove that you weren't. Yep. You guys can say, "That's good." So you have to fully come out of

legalism. I don't know if... I know I'm speaking to a much different group here, but if there's any legalism left in you, that will be the area that you're talked out of life and identity. If there's any... as a matter of fact, the way Jesus put it, He said if you allow the leaven of the Pharisees to be any part of your life, then you won't partake of the kingdom. The disciples were so unaware of what He was talking about. They're like, "Jesus is ticked that we didn't bring bread."

And then He's like, "You idiots." He said, "I'm talk..." He literally said, "I'm talking about the doctrine of the Pharisees." Do you know why? Because He was looking in the face of life-giving spirits that were afraid that they couldn't feed five thousand people with no resources. Get it? He said, "We just fed four thousand." We've had six thousand after that. "Don't you remember that you actually fed them and then took up baskets of excess?" And then there's five thousand hungry people, and they look at their hands and go, "What are we gonna do?" And Jesus says, "You're being governed by external circumstances. You're going to reach out, try to do something to become something, and you're the life-giving spirit that is supposed to give creation everything it needs. Beware of the leaven of the Pharisees." Jesus was already warning: legalism and life cannot coexist. Get it? Last thing, I promise you guys. Good.

Glory of the New Covenant

Okay, 2 Corinthians 3. It says, "But if the ministry of death..." Wow, right? How'd we miss that one? I said something years ago and I got in trouble for it. I said I am fully in support of removing the Ten Commandments from schools. First of all, if you need to tell your children to not do those ten things in school, you're desperately failing as a parent. "Hey, no killing here," right? Yeah. What's so funny is the Western culture is so unaware of what the actual New Testament gospel is, we could post it in a school and nobody would know. You're everything He is; you're nothing that He's not. You're more than an overcomer. You're blameless, you're spotless, you're holy, you're perfect, you're the redeemer of creation. Everybody is so out of touch with what the gospel actually is, no religious freedom fighters would ever have a problem with that. Take the commandments down. The commandments killed people. Let's put up promises. Everything that was demanded from the law was given to you by Jesus. Yeah, I think we can do it, and nobody'd know any better.

All right, where'd I tell you to start? Seven. "If the ministry of death, written and engraved on stones, was glorious, so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the face of Moses because of the glory of his countenance, which was passing away, how will the ministry of the Spirit not be more glorious? For if the ministry of condemnation..." I lost my spot. Thanks. "For the ministry of condemnation..." I was going to say, yes, I did. 999. Anyway. "For if the

ministry of condemnation had glory, the ministry of righteousness exceeds much more in glory. For even what was made glorious had no glory in this respect, because of the glory that excels." Can I give you some good theology sidebar stuff, just so you know how to interpret the Bible well? So whenever there's a change of covenant, there has to be a replacement of three things: the priesthood, the temple, and the sacrifice.

Those three things have to be completely abolished in order for the next covenant to supersede it. So when Paul's teaching, he's in the 40-year period where the old covenant was expiring and the seed of the new creation was being planted. So what happened? When Jesus died, He replaced the old sacrifices. He put an end to sacrifice and offering, right? John the Baptist: he was the son of Zechariah and Elizabeth, both of them in the lineage of Aaron. That means by right, John the Baptist was a Levitical priest. He was cleansing the next priest, according to the order of Melchizedek, in the Jordan River. There's your new priesthood. It took until A.D. 70 for the temple to be destroyed. So Paul's language in his epistles, they were between 33 and 70. So he was in an inter-testament moment where he's saying something is fading, something is becoming irrelevant, something's completely going to go away, right?

But now he's comparing the glory of the old covenant and the glory of the new covenant. The glory of the old covenant: the word "glory" is the Greek word doxa, right? And the word "glory" actually doesn't carry any meaning with it; it has to have a subject to reference. So doxa means "thoughts and opinions of." So if I say "thoughts and opinions of the law of Moses," what do you think its glory is? Death and condemnation. The glory of the law is death and condemnation, right? Then we have the glory of the Spirit that excels in glory because it's life and righteousness. Can we prove it? Wait, ask me how I know, right? So Moses's face, when he comes down off of Mount Sinai, he's literally given the doxa of the law, and he comes down. He has to veil his face, or everybody's going to run away from him, not because he saw God, but because he saw death and condemnation. Nobody wants to see it.

And we wonder how on earth God can come down on a mountain with Enoch, Elijah, the disciples, and Jesus, and audibly speak: "Those are My sons, in them I am well pleased." Jesus is transfigured. Divinity is embodied in humanity, and everybody from cities around comes to see what He's shining on. Get it? Moses was transfigured according to the law. Jesus was transfigured according to the law of the Spirit and life. And He made the Law and the Prophets watch. Peter said, "Hey, I can make tents. Why don't I make three?" And God said, "No, this is My Son. Listen to Him." The truth came through Him; the law came through them. Amen.

Part 2

Rethinking the Crucifixion

All right, you guys ready? Okay. So like I said, we're going to dismantle things that are incongruent with the gospel of life and immortality. The second thing I should say, the second sacred cow patty that I'd like to throw on the grill this morning, is the way that we see the crucifixion. Okay. There's a passage, if you don't mind, go to the Book of John, chapter 16, with me, and we're going to talk about how the way that you see the crucifixion affects your conscience, and it can actually breed death rather than life. Thank you. Thank you very much. Did I lose my wife? She's making coffee. Oh, all right. John chapter 16. We're gonna go to verse 20.

And this is one of those sacred cattle that's kind of sensitive to touch, so I'm really not trying to be dismissive, but I just, I want to point out something. It kind of maybe navigate the way the church has chosen to see the crucifixion versus the way that heaven sees the crucifixion. And the way that the church has chosen to see the crucifixion actually continually condemns humanity. Okay. So here's what Jesus says about His own crucifixion. Verse 20, it says, "Most assuredly, I say to you that you will weep and you will lament, but the world will rejoice; and you will be sorrowful, but your sorrow will be turned into joy." Right? "A woman, when she's in labor, has sorrow because her hour has come; but as soon as she has given birth to the child, she no longer remembers the anguish, for the joy that a human being has been brought into the world. Therefore now you have sorrow; but I will see you again and your heart will rejoice, and your joy no one will take from you. And in that day you will ask Me nothing. Most assuredly, I say to you, whatever you ask the Father in My name He will give you. Until now you have asked nothing in My name. Ask, and you will receive, that your joy may be full." Okay, so for the most part, Western traditional teaching is making you feel guilty for

Victory Over Guilt

killing Jesus, so you storm an altar and repent, right? That is literally the antithesis of the intention of the gospel. If you reduce the sacrifice of Jesus to the blood of bulls and goats, then you will spend your life feeling guilty of the shed blood of Jesus rather than set free by His resurrection. When Jesus teaches His own crucifixion, He said, it's going to hurt for a minute, and then you'll never remember the pain again. When you give birth to a child, it hurts for hours; they bring you joy for years. In the moment that He was crucified, you'll sorrow, right? Is that you, or is He speaking to a specific group of people? Right? The Bible was written for you, but not necessarily to you. So He's speaking to people that, they're going to literally watch

their teacher be brutally murdered. They're not excited about it. But that is not how the New Testament church is supposed to perceive what happened on the cross at Calvary. He said, you'll see the death and you'll sorrow for a moment, but when you see the life, no one will ever take that joy from you.

We've surrounded our understanding of the Western gospel with sin and death, right? You did something bad, you killed the Savior, good job, right? And if you're continually guilty of the shed blood of Jesus, you can never wipe that from your conscience. All you can do is continue to earn, strive, try, and deserve, right? The Bible says when you are aware of the sacrifice, that it's actually a reminder of sin, and you can't make your conscience clean if there's a reminder of sin year after year. I'll make that make sense to you when I read it from Hebrews. Okay. The death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus was the most magnificent and victorious moment that humanity has ever witnessed. The person that died on Calvary was the distorted form of all of humanity. It was a death to be celebrated. "As in Adam all die." You realize that that was the moment that all in Adam died? He was the last Adam. If there's no more Adams, what's everybody else? Come on, you ought to just preach this. No more Adam, just Christ.

So if all of humanity was captured in the loins of Jesus when He was killed, something very specific was being put to death at that moment, and it wasn't something that you don't want to die. It was everything you were never meant to be. If we would have understood the magnitude of the crucifixion, we would have been surrounding the foot of the cross applauding that everything that Adam told us we were was going to a grave. And then the same Spirit that raised Christ from the dead now lives in you, and that Spirit gives life to your mortal body. So I'm not trying to shame, like, Christian, oh, worship songs. I'm not trying to shame The Passion of the Christ. Like, I get that stuff. I cry when I see it too. But what a natural view of something so unbelievably supernatural. And if all we do is say, "I can't believe You died for me, I can't believe You died for him," we don't get the message. He didn't die for you; He died as you. Yep. Once and for all, sufficiently, inclusively, right?

How many of you get in conversations with people, and the one that they throw at you is, "It's appointed for man to die once"? Right? Been there, done that. Yeah, got the T-shirt. Yep, you died with Christ, right? Okay. So Jesus was very intentional. How many of you know what the Crusades were? Shining moment in Christian history, right? Awful. They wanted somebody to pay for the death of Jesus. They wanted somebody to pay for the death of a man that said nobody can kill Me, "No one takes My life from Me." Hey, they took their life from Him. They clearly didn't know what Jesus was all about. The way that you perceive the cross determines if you have a cleansed conscience or a guilty conscience. When you see Jesus climb up on Calvary and you realize that the last Adam was being put to death so that all of humanity can

be enveloped in that single, simultaneous victory, then we would have been applauding the death as much as we were applauding the resurrection. Because sin was taken out in the grave, life was seated on a throne, and you were part of both moments. The death was just as victorious as the resurrection. It's not something that should inspire guilt; it's something that should inspire victory.

Grace and Judgment

Good. Let me show you the difference. John chapter 8. You don't have to turn here; I'll just talk to you about it. Do you guys remember the woman caught in adultery? Okay, let me show you why ignorance is better than legalism. John chapter 8: Jesus is kind of held in contempt by legalistic people. Woman thrown at His feet. "It's just the law of Moses says we should throw rocks at her. What do You say?" He said, "Well, I think if you're without sin, you should throw rocks at her." Okay, let me set this up for you. The Creator of the universe has a woman caught in the very act, is what the Bible says, religious leaders standing near Him. If you fast-forward through this, He'll say, "I judge no one." Okay. The reason that is extremely important is because you'll see in this moment that judgment occurs, but God doesn't do it. "I think if you're without sin, you should cast the first stone." It says that they dropped their stones one by one and left, in order from the oldest to the youngest. Why? Because the longer you spend trying to become something you already are, the more condemned your conscience becomes.

So Jesus never condemned these men. He allowed their own conscience to do it for them. So they were in proximity to the Creator of the universe, welcomed and invited, and they left. Adam hid from Him in the cool of the day when God showed up for His morning walk, because he did something to try to become like God, and then he died. The woman that was caught in the very act, her ignorance allowed her to maintain proximity to the Creator. Do you hear me? So good, right? Jesus said, how did He say it? Prostitutes, tax collectors enter the kingdom before you. "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees," you shut up the kingdom for you and everybody that hears you. Yeah. You want to lose access to the kingdom? Get strapped back under legalism. Good, good.

"Early in the morning He came again into the temple, and all the people came to Him; and He sat down and taught them. Then the scribes and Pharisees brought to Him a woman caught in adultery. And when they had set her in the midst, they said to Him, 'Teacher, this woman was caught in adultery, in the very act. Moses said we should stone her. What do You say?' This they said, testing Him, that they might have something of which to accuse Him. But Jesus stooped down and wrote on the ground with His finger, as though He did not hear. So when they continued asking Him, He raised Himself up and said to them, 'He who is without sin among you, let him throw a stone at her first.' And again He stooped down and wrote on the

ground. Then those who heard it, being convicted by their conscience..." Okay. All of us can be in this same moment. Some of you will maintain proximity to the Creator, some of you will leave, and the choice is yours. Jesus makes it His aim to disclose how He operates in this passage. Some will stay separate, some will stay close, and it has nothing to do with their behavior, because the most practically righteous people were the ones that walked away. The one that got caught in the very act was the one that got to stay.

Jesus... oh, this is, okay, I skipped ahead a little bit. "Then those who heard it, being convicted by their conscience, went out one by one, beginning with the oldest even to the last. And Jesus was left alone, and the woman standing in the midst. When Jesus had raised Himself up and saw no one but the woman, He said to her, 'Woman, where are those accusers of yours? Has no one condemned you?'" Listen: "Has no one condemned you?" "She said, 'No one, Lord.' And Jesus said to her, 'Neither do I condemn you; go and sin no more.'" Okay. "Go and sin no more." It's another one of those things that people like to use to justify continued legalism. But if you understand New Testament sin, hamartia, ha-morphē, distorted form, He wasn't giving her instruction; He was prophetically declaring that she was perfect. Yeah. "Neither do I condemn you; go and sin no more." Everything you were never meant to be was taken away from who you are. "Then Jesus spoke to them again, saying, 'I am the light of the world. He who follows Me shall not walk in darkness, but have...'" The word "have" in the Greek word means echo. It's a perfect carbon copy. Okay. "He who follows Me shall not walk in darkness," but echo "the light of life."

Conscience and Biology

Conscience matters, and the way that you see yourself will determine what you're willing to receive from Jesus. Your paradigm will continually frame your experience. Good? Are we heading in a good direction? Okay. You guys are Kirby folks, right? So conscience isn't new to you, but not very many people teach on conscience, which is wild. It's mentioned 32 times in the New Testament, by every single author. The main difference between bulls and goats and Jesus was the effect that it had on your conscience. Your conscience is the faculty of your spirit that speaks. It's the message that you authentically believe, right? So if you are good at professing life, but you actually don't afford it to yourself, your body will continually be a slave to your soul. I hope so. Which part? Oh, I don't got it. "Your body is a slave to your soul" was the last thing I said. Let me see if I can rewind. If you're good at confessing, but you don't authentically afford yourself righteousness... Nope, don't got it. Sung recorded it, though. Yeah. No, I'm famous for this. I'm famous for this.

All right, so how... maybe bringing up triggers isn't a good idea, but I didn't mean I was going to trigger you. What I meant was, okay, so the key to immortality is internal government,

right? The moment that you become sensually driven is the moment that you become susceptible to death. So if you're looking for evidence of immortality, you're going to remain dead, right? Immortality is your nature. Not something you're pursuing, but somebody you are. So the moment that you become sensually aware, which, by the way, is what happened to Adam and Eve, right? "In the day that you eat of it, your eyes will be opened," and now you're in trouble. You become governed by experience, and you become governed by situations and perspectives, and then your only interpretation of your future is what you've been through. Hopelessness, depression, and anxiety come from, right? So it doesn't matter if your internal message is good or bad; it will give to your mortal body.

The example that we always use in our school is marriage. One of the things my wife and I often are faced with: we have a young church, so everybody comes to us regarding their newly consummated marriages. Everybody understand what I just said? Okay. So they've been waiting their entire life for an incredible moment, and then they are extremely disappointed. Got it? Yeah. Y'all still giggling. We are five. Yep. Okay, so, but here's the deal. Here's, like, if you can grasp this, you can get it. So if you have an internal message, the internal message will always govern your biology. Always, whether it's good or bad. So if a woman's experience with masculinity has been negative, then her soul will actually train her biology to enter into a parasympathetic state, where her adrenal glands respond to masculinity rather than her ovaries. Do you know what happens when that takes place? It's not a super cool environment for intimacy. She can't help it, because it's the message that she authentically believes: man bad, masculinity dangerous, right? So she has to change what's fundamentally understood on the inside in order for her biology to change on the outside.

A woman that has an ovarian response to masculinity, her body will literally prepare itself to receive her husband to consummate. If she authentically believes that masculinity is a threat, then her body will not allow it to happen, right? So do you see how that's such a finite, or a secluded, view of what immortality looks like? Because what's happening in your conscience is actually being replicated in your biology. Your biology is the only gate that you have to creation, which is why creation is not looking for positional sons of God. It's looking... it doesn't... it's not looking for confessing sons of God; it's looking for manifest sons of God. That's when who God says you are, who you believe you are, and what creation experiences when it encounters you is all the same thing. So in order for that to happen, you have to completely get away from a guilty or a seared conscience. And if you believe that you're guilty of the shed blood of Jesus, good luck getting out of that. Good.

Beyond Religious Sacrifice

What time is it? Oh, we're good. Whoo. All right, go to Hebrews chapter 9. Verse 6. It says, "Now when these things had been thus prepared, the priests always went into the first part of the tabernacle, performing the services. But into the second part, the high priest..." excuse me, "But into the second part the high priest went alone once a year, not without blood, which he offered for himself and for the people's sins committed in ignorance; the Holy Spirit indicating this, that the way into the Holiest of All was not yet made manifest while the first tabernacle was still standing. It was symbolic for the present time in which both gifts and sacrifices are offered which cannot make him who performed the service perfect in regard to the conscience." Get it? "Concerned only with foods and drinks, various washings, and fleshly ordinances imposed until the time of reformation." Holy smokes. It's unbelievable how subtle this is. It's so subtle I can barely communicate it. The moment you offer a sacrifice, you're confessing separation and guilt. Do it. It's impossible.

"Sacrifice and offering You did not desire." How do we build an entire Western religion on sacrifice and offering when Jesus never gave you a gift list? He went to the gift registry and told you two things, the only two things in the world that He doesn't want: I don't want sacrifice, I don't want offerings. "Okay, it's time for sacrifice and offering time." And we build an entire religion on it. Do you know the next line? "But a body You have prepared for Me." Do you know what that means? You have ordained My incarnation. You knew from before the foundation of the world that I would be the representation of the Godhead on earth, and that's what You want Me to step into. Not sacrifice and offering, but God's visible representation, the express image of the Father in My body. If you've seen Me, you've seen Him. That's what He wants. Check Amazon; He registered for it. He ordained your incarnation, that you would do, listen, the things written from before the foundation of the world. Is it good?

So what's He saying here? You give a gift, confess guilt. Offer sacrifice, confess guilt. The moment you do to become, you're separate. It's impossible to apprehend life that you're trying to apprehend, things chased or things lost. Is it good? Verse 11, ready? "But Christ came as High Priest of the good things to come, with the greater and more perfect tabernacle not made with hands, that is, not of this creation. Not with the blood of goats and calves, but with His own blood He entered the Most Holy Place once for all." That's my favorite saying in the entire Bible: once and for all. If we can get what that means. "Once" means it was sufficient; "for all" means it was inclusive. Yep. His death, He died once and for all. Yep. Oh. "Not with the blood of goats and calves, but with His own blood He entered the Most Holy Place once for all, having obtained eternal redemption. For if the blood of bulls and goats and the ashes of a heifer, sprinkling the unclean, sanctifies for the purifying of the flesh, how much more shall the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered Himself without spot to God," listen, "cleanse your conscience," yep, "from dead works."

You know, works aren't bad. There's two kinds: there's dead works and there's good works. It's the same thing we've been talking about. Where do good works come from? Before the foundation of the world. Ephesians chapter 4: you were created for good works from before the foundation of the world. You don't want sacrifices and offerings, right? You want me to live out the scroll that You wrote for me. You've ordained my incarnation. Yep. That's what You want from me. So it says that you would have your conscience cleansed from dead works. If you don't have a cleansed conscience, your works are dead, because your works are trying to apprehend something that you already are, right? You're reaching out your hand to become who you already are, and it'll kill you. The law brought death. Good. "From dead works to serve the living God. And for this reason He is the Mediator of the new covenant, by means of death, for the redemption of the transgressions under the first covenant, that those who are called may receive the promise of the eternal inheritance."

Okay, so if we see Jesus as a sacrifice... oh man, we're going to get into this in the next session. If we see Jesus as a sacrifice for the things that you did wrong, and not your death, burial, and resurrection, then you will consistently have a guilty conscience. That guilty conscience will actually separate you from good works, because you'll be stuck in dead works. You can't have them both simultaneously. Yep. You have to have your conscience cleansed. You know what? The righteousness... we talked about this this morning, or last night. Last night. It is a matter of conscience. Righteousness is a matter of conscience. Conscience is the message that your spirit actually speaks to you; it's the one that you believe. So when God gives you righteousness, He doesn't fashion one for you and give it to you that He approves of. He gives you His righteousness. He gives you His glory. He gives you His thoughts and opinions towards Himself, to you, to have towards yourself, and He's fine with it, right?

If, like, people have been more susceptible to the message of immortality with me than they have been to the message of equality with God. They're not okay with that, even though their Bible says, "Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus, who... did not consider it robbery to be equal with God." Your Bible teaches you how to think, and you should think that you're equal with God. Kind of wild. And He's okay with it. He demands it. It's the only way creation gets redeemed, is if you stop playing small.

Cleansing the Conscience

Let me show you something real quick. You don't have to go here; Luke 5:8, just write it down. It says, "When Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, 'Depart from me, for I am a sinful man, O Lord!'" Do you know what just happened? Conscience. God is never separate from you. He will never leave you or forsake you. Your conscience will make you feel distant. There's three ways that your conscience can be: it can be seared, it can be

guilty, or it can be cleansed. It's the only three you got. Cleansed means that you believe you're everything He is and nothing that He is not. Guilty means you're stuck under the bondage of religion. Seared means you just don't want to hear. What's that? If I slow down, you get less? Guilty means you're still striving and deserving, still trying to close the gap of perceived separation. Seared is what happens when you refuse to receive the message, right? The Bible says that if you sear your conscience, you shipwreck your faith. Okay.

Have you ever seen this happen biblically? Like, somebody believes they're so downtrodden and terrible, or so guilty, that they won't receive the message of life? The woman that was at the well at Samaria. Jesus overcame that for her, because she knew that she had had five husbands, and the one that she had wasn't hers. So Jesus' prophetic unction told Him to ask her to go tell her husband, and she said, "I don't have one." He said, "Baby, I know, but I'll be your seventh man. I know everything about you, and I'm still offering you life. Get over the conscience thing." And then, do you know what made her go tell everybody that He was the Messiah? She said, "You have to come meet this guy that told me everything about me." Her excitement was that this guy offered me heaven, didn't care what I'd naturally been through. As a matter of fact, before she left to go evangelize, you know what? She threw away her water pot. She believed Him. If you drink what I have, you'll never be thirsty again. Off it goes after the first taste. Folks, come on. You guys good? Okay.

Let's wrap up at Hebrews 10. Looking at the cross of Jesus without applying the blood to your conscience would make you feel more guilty, unworthy, and unworthy. It's the perfect storm for fallen Christianity. I was going to do a session on why, or where, we lost the doctrine of immortality, and I think it's a good session, but I don't think I'll have time. But let me tell you this. You guys know that the local church, the intention of the local church, is to bring you to the measure of the stature of the fullness of God, right? Nothing else. It's not a social organization. It's not even a charitable organization. It's a training organization: "the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ." And the structure that God has put in place for that to take place is apostles, prophets, pastors, teachers, and evangelists. There is another five-tier structure in your Bible that offers a counterfeit operation to every fivefold office: powers, principalities, mights, dominions, high things, and rulers in high places. Rulers in high places and the apostolic voice have the same exact function. Yep. Demons aren't responsible for destruction; they're responsible for doctrine. Get it? Yeah. So the perfect message to send across a Christian pulpit is that death is your savior and you're still guilty, right?

All right, Hebrews 10. We're just going to go 1 through 4, and then we'll go to lunch, right? "For the law, having a shadow of the good things to come, and not the very image of the things, can never with these same sacrifices, which they offer continually year by year, make

those who approach perfect." Say "perfect." Okay. So what's the intention of the sacrifice? Perfection, right? Not improvement. Perfection, right? The author of Hebrews continually admonishes Jesus as a better Moses, as a better covenant. Now he's comparing Him, in 9 and 10, as a sacrifice, and he's telling you what happens if you reduce the sacrifice of Jesus to the sacrifice of the blood of bulls and goats. If you believe that the sacrifice of Jesus is functioning in the same way as its antitype, then you will believe that you did bad things and something needs to die in your place. And that is not why Jesus died. Sung, I'm sorry for this one. Okay, right ahead of time, and I will take time to explain it so nobody gets mad at me.

How many of you are Jews? Like, legit, not spiritual Jews. Abraham's your dad? None of you, right? So when God makes a covenant with somebody, He names who the recipient, or the other party of the covenant, is with. You're not Jews. The law of Moses has never, will never, can never apply to you, meaning you were never guilty for any reason whatsoever. And here's the part that I'm sorry for: the blood sacrifice of Jesus meant absolutely nothing to you. It wasn't required on your behalf. It wasn't demanded on your behalf. It was part of a Jewish system. It was a very small piece. I'm not saying it's irrelevant; it was necessary. There was a righteous requirement of the law that needed satisfied on the behalf of Jews. The point of the cross was the destruction of every enemy that would ever face humanity, and the envelopment of all of humanity into the resurrection. Not simply covering the dirty things that you did with blood, but bringing you into Adam so you could die your death, so that you could be in Jesus on His throne at the right hand of God. You okay with that? Okay, almost done.

Hebrews chapter 10, then we'll go eat. "For the law, having a shadow of the good things to come, and not the very image of the things, can never with these same sacrifices, which they offer continually year by year, make those who approach perfect. For then would they not have ceased to be offered?" If you have a good sacrifice, you don't need any more, because good sacrifices make the recipients of the sacrifice perfect. Yep. "For the worshipers, once purified, would have had no more consciousness of sins." Yep. Sin consciousness is the kindergarten of faith. If you believe that His death was once and for all, then sin consciousness should no longer be part of your paradigm. If sin consciousness is no longer part of your paradigm, then it's righteousness and life. How about this: "But in those sacrifices there is a reminder of sins every year." The sacrificial system of religion actually affirms your guilt, and it will never take it away. So if you reduce the sacrifice of Jesus to the blood of bulls and goats, then you'll remain guilty. Church will be the worst thing that ever happened to you.

It's true, right? I mean, think of it. Like, you guys are a different breed. Sometimes when you're in our culture, you forget what, like, Western Christianity looks like. They go to church to hear that they're guilty. They go to church to be reminded that they killed an innocent man, and that

if they don't run to the altar every Sunday, then they're going to continually be found guilty. It's the worst thing that can happen to your conscience. You find a crackhead under a bridge, and they're usually okay, right? They throw them at the feet of Jesus, and He doesn't care. He's not judged until a religious person gets a hold of them. You should have left them under the bridge. Sung, I'm done. I know. Next session is going to be good. The next session is called "The Day Death Died."

Part 3

Interpreting the Bible

And I'm going to give you some more insight in how you should interpret your Bible. Most issues that we faced in the church have just been an erroneous view of this thing, right? Just because you used it wrong doesn't mean it's bad. Just because we used it to thump sinners instead of set them free, it doesn't mean this was the problem, right? So there are things in your Bible that are natural; there are things in your Bible that are heavenly. And it's important to understand, or recognize, that distinction. Abraham was promised that he would have descendants as numerous as the sand on the seashore, right? And he had natural sons; he had a natural lineage. He was also promised that he would have descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky, and everybody that came into Christ were his supernatural descendants. There's a natural and there's a supernatural. These two often run parallel. They're often the same, excuse me, a different perspective of the same events.

So Matthew, Mark, and Luke are natural records of Jesus's ministry. There are two books in your Bible that are supernatural records of Jesus's ministry: they're John and Revelation. The way that you interpret Revelation decides whether or not you have a fearful view of what's to come, or you understand that every enemy of humanity has already been obliterated, right? So let's go to the Book of John. So we spoke about it last night, but John is the first Gospel writer that included revelatory information in his record. Matthew, Mark, and Luke simply recorded what they saw Jesus do, what they heard Jesus say. John unloads on us. In John 1:1, "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God." And that is absolutely revelatory. It was the correction to Genesis. So Genesis and John are parallels; they're accounts of the same thing, but one is the view from heaven, one is the view from Moses, right?

So what we're seeing happen through the Gospels, we see heaven's perspective of it in Revelation. But let me show you something in... go to Luke 3. We're actually going to spend some time here. I'm only going to cover two passages: it's Revelation 20 and Luke 3.

John's Baptism and Ministry

Excuse me. First one says, "In the 15th year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate became governor of Judea, Herod being the tetrarch of Galilee, his brother Philip tetrarch of Iturea..." I don't know what that says, "...and the region of Lysanias..." Okay, I'm gonna skip all that. "Annas and Caiaphas were high priests, the word of God came to this John, the son of Zacharias, in the wilderness. And he went into all the region around the Jordan, preaching a

baptism of repentance for the remission of sins." Okay, now it's really important that you interpret this passage well, because "remission" is a Greek word. Can you tell I love the Greek language? Okay, so "remission" is the Greek word aphiēmi. It's a two-part Greek word: apo means "away from," hiēmi means "by identity." Okay? So it's the same word that we translate to the English word "forgiveness."

So if he is preaching a baptism of the remission of sins, you need to realize that his message is not a religious one. His message is not about punishment and wrath. His message is about a baptism that will take away the distorted form from who you are, okay? That's what this passage is translated as. So he's preaching a baptism of the remission of sins. It makes it confusing, because he's also on a Messiah search. John's baptism into the Jordan was not the baptism of the remission of sins. He was preaching the way that Jesus would come and what He would do, right? It said He would take away the sin of the world. So John the Baptist, the message that he's heralding is: the Lamb of God is coming, and He will take away the sin of the world. He will remove creation's distorted form, right? Everything it was never meant to be was being taken away from who it is.

And he gave specific tactics in how He would accomplish that. Jesus is on His way, and there's an ax in His hand, right? He has to remove a tree, and to remove that tree is to remove the books recorded through the tree. "The one who comes after me will baptize you in the Spirit and in fire." I want us to have a good theological understanding of this. Baptism of fire is something that you can encounter. I'd prefer you give it a different name, so that you can understand what a baptism of fire really is. The baptism of fire was something that happened to all of creation 2,000 years ago that removed everything that it was never meant to be, okay? So the encounters where you feel like you got struck by lightning: super cool, super relevant, very much part of your experience, but maybe not use that term, because I don't want you to miss out on what actually happened, okay? Just say you got rocked, or high on the Most High, or something else that, what's the guy's name, John Crowder would say. Yep, all right.

"And he went into all the region around the Jordan, preaching a baptism of the repentance," or, excuse me, "baptism of repentance for the remission of sins. And it's written in the book of the words of Isaiah the prophet, saying, 'The voice of one crying in the wilderness: "Prepare the way of the Lord; make His path straight."'" Check this out: "'Every valley shall be filled, every hill will be brought low, the crooked places shall be made straight and the rough ways smooth. All flesh shall see the salvation of God.'" Okay, what a message, right? There's a guy on His way that will fix everything, right? That's the message he was heralding. He is coming for the remission, the aphiēmi, the taking away of the sin of the world from who it is, everything that it was never meant to be. As a matter of fact, He's doing Creation Part 2.0. He saw there was

something dark and formless, He saw the Spirit of God hovering over it, and He spoke and it became what He saw. Then it became distorted. So He's doing it again, but this time He's speaking it through His Son, right? Okay, so check this out.

The Baptism of Fire and Spirit

"Then he said to the multitudes that came out to be baptized, 'Brood of vipers! Who warned you to flee from the wrath to come?'" Wrong message, folks. That's what he's saying. He said, "I'm here to preach a baptism of the remission of sin. Who told you this was about wrath? Therefore bear fruit worthy of repentance." Repentance, metanoia: bear fruit worthy of higher knowledge, bear fruit worthy of the mind of Christ. This isn't about fleeing from wrath to come. That's a garbage message; that'll kill you. This is about a new mindset for a new creation, right? "And don't say, 'We have Abraham as our father.' So I say to you, God is able to raise up children to Abraham from these stones. And even now..." This is where it gets good. "...the ax is laid to the root of the trees. Therefore every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire," right?

"So the people asked him, saying, 'What should we do then?'" All right, so it's not about wrath to come, so what do we do? He said, act like your natural self. Be Christlike. Step into His identity. He says it this way: "He answered them, 'He who has two tunics, let him give to one that has none; he who has food, let him do likewise.' Then tax collectors came to him to be baptized, and they said, 'Teacher, what shall we do?' And he said, 'Collect no more than what is appointed for you.' Likewise the soldiers asked him and said, 'What should we do?' And he said, 'Don't intimidate anyone or falsely accuse, and be content with your wages.' Now as the people were in expectation, and all reasoned in their hearts about John, whether he was the Christ or not, John answers all and said, 'I'm baptizing you with water, but One mightier than I is coming, whose sandal straps I'm not worthy to loose, and He'll baptize you in the Holy Spirit and fire. His winnowing fan is in His hand, and He will thoroughly clean out His threshing floor and gather the wheat into His barn, and the chaff He will burn with unquenchable fire.'"

Okay, so John is a revelator, right? He is not a natural teacher. John is giving us heavenly insight into Jesus's tactic to removing the sin of the world. He's going to do it through baptism. That baptism is a baptism of Spirit and a baptism of fire. They happen simultaneously at the cross. The baptism of the Spirit gave you everything that you need for life and godliness. The baptism of fire quenched everything that you were never supposed to be. Simultaneously, everything that you never needed, and anything that you ever needed, were given to you simultaneously at the cross, through the baptism of Christ, right? Important. When Jesus recognized, excuse me, when John recognized Jesus, how did he point Him out? "Behold the Lamb of God that takes away the sin," the hamartia, "of the cosmos." He takes away the

distorted form of the world from who it is. Get it? There was a day that death died, and it's really far in your past.

John the Revelator wrote another book when he was called into heaven. And I would submit to you... actually, I won't submit to you, because I don't want you to become something. You'll have to call yourself a preterist, or a partial preterist, or a futurist or something, and don't do that. Revelation is a third-heaven view of human history, and it is the record of the finished work of Jesus, okay? So go to verse 20.

Revelation 20: The Day Death Died

Revelation 20. My bad, thanks for the awkward look, Michael. Okay, I might need volunteers for this. I'll let you know. Can we start a fight? Never mind, that wouldn't go well with volunteers. Okay, verse 11. Say amen when you're there. I'm going to read it straight through, then I'm going to illustrate it. We're going to go through verse 14, 15. He said, "I saw a great white throne and Him who sat on it, whose face the earth and heavens fled away. And there was found no place for them. And I saw the dead, small and great, standing before God, and the books were opened. And another book was opened; this is the Book of Life. The dead were judged according to their works, by the things which were written in the books. The sea gave up the dead who were in it, and Death and Hades delivered up the dead who were in them. And they were judged, each one according to his works. Then Death and Hades were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death. And anyone not found written in the Book of Life was cast into the lake of fire."

Ready? Okay, I feel like I need you to see something. Let's do this. Okay. "I saw the dead, small and great." Who wants to be dead? How about this: why don't you all be dead? Okay, here's the dead. I'm not gonna establish small and great, but here's the dead, small and great, okay? See them? Everything that happens here pertains to them, okay? And books... okay. "I saw the dead standing, small and great, standing before God, and books were opened." Okay, did you stand? Here's books. Everybody say "books." Here's books, okay? "And another book was opened, which is the Book of Life." Shanda, would you be the Book of Life for me? Books, book, right? Tracking? Okay. "And the dead were judged according to their works, by the things which were written in the books." Books, dead. Those people were judged according to the things written in the books.

All of humanity is taken into Jesus and became sin, right? There's the dead being judged according to the distorted form. The books were written according to the knowledge of the tree that Jesus laid His ax at, okay? And a tree that doesn't bear good fruit, what's He got to do with that? Has to burn it. Okay, ready? "And the dead were judged according to their works,"

which, "according to the things written in the books. The sea gave up the dead who were in it, Death and Hades delivered up the dead who were in them." Okay, so now the sea, Hades, nor death no longer has dominion over any human. They had to give up all humanity, okay? "And Death and Hades delivered up the dead who were in them. And they were judged according to his works." Then, here's our fire. Ready? "Death and Hades were cast into the lake of fire." Okay, if I call death and Hades up here, you won't be up here very long. So she's death and Hades. You okay?

So I just want this to track, okay? Dead, right? And, well, this has gotten more numerous, right? Hell, death, the sea, like, they just keep giving up dead people, and then they're judged according to things written in the books, and then Death and Hades were killed, okay? Next line: "And they were judged, each according to their works. Then Death and Hades were cast in the lake of fire. This is the second death." Now here's the problem with grumpy men in 1611: King James. Yep. The Greek language, I think it only has, shoot, I forget, like 17 participles. So, like, the words take on the meaning of what they're referencing. So the word "anyone" is a terrible translation. This Greek word meant "anything," okay? Do you see how that drastically changes this? This makes this extremely victorious, okay?

So here's the dead; hell, death, the grave; a fire; books that condemn them; and a book, right? So the dead were judged by the things written in the books, and then anything not written in the Book of Life was thrown into the fire, okay? So who goes to the fire? This is the difference between "anyone" and "anything." Do they burn, or does that burn? The books burn, right? Because here comes... yeah, go die. This is the only time this is permitted, because that's not Kelly, that's books. Okay, so this is literally heaven's view of what happened at the crucifixion. Hell, death, the grave, and the law were taken away from humanity, so that humanity could do exactly what Jesus intended. What did it say? "Sacrifice and offering I do not desire, but in the volume of the book it is written, to do Your will, O God. A body Thou hast prepared for me." You have ordained my incarnation.

And in order for you to step into your incarnation, the things that were written in the books have to go. This is the baptism of the Spirit and fire. He brings in the Book of Life; He casts out the book of the knowledge of good and evil. Everything written in the books of the knowledge of good and evil is burned along with the tree that wrote them. And you were judged according to them, and then the book was tossed out. So now the only thing that stands in heaven is a book in you. Is that good? You guys can sit. It's just right here, too. It's one word: "anyone" or "anything." Anything not written in the Lamb's Book of Life was cast into the fire. Your divorce was cast into the fire. Your addiction was cast into the fire. Your shame was cast into the fire. Your anxiety and depression was cast into the fire. Anything that was

said about you that was not said in His book was cast into the fire, right?

Okay, so we minimize our understanding of the baptism of fire if we think that it's an encounter. It was an encounter; it was the removal of everything you were never meant to be. John the Baptist came preaching this message: that there's a Lamb of God coming, and He's going to completely remove everything that you and creation was never meant to be. Through the baptism of the Holy Spirit and fire, He would provide everything that you need for life and godliness, and He would extinguish, He would kill, everything that ever stood against you. Hades and death were issues; they're dead. There is no record of your performance versus the books recorded in heaven anymore. As far as the east is from the west, it's gone. Yeah. How many of you realize the sea of forgetfulness was made of fire? That's good, right? It's my next T-shirt. Okay, so: the day death died.

Understanding the Greek Texts

Why do you die? Because you earn, strive, try, and deserve, because you're trying to rewrite what was written in the books. You can't rewrite what was written in the books. You can only submit to what was written in the book, and then the books get burned. Burned. Jesus came carrying an ax. Jesus came ready to start a fire. And John the Baptist recognized that this guy is on mission, and He's coming to take away the sin of the world. You realize that message is so important that John the Baptist was called the greatest man ever born of a woman up to his time? Ezekiel, Elijah, Jeremiah, any of those guys, when they meet in the cloud, John the Baptist is their superior, because all of those guys said, "He's coming." John the Baptist got to say, "There He is." I absolutely love it. Absolutely love it.

So we have a record of death's death. Jesus abolished death. Like, think of this, like, think of the mechanics of the death, burial, and resurrection. Like, you see on earth Jesus is literally taking the distorted form of humanity upon Himself. He's taking the perceived separation of humanity and God upon Himself. And then in heaven, while books are being tossed into a fire, He's opening His eyes again. He's completely abolishing everything that ever stood against your identity and destiny. There's nothing you can offer. There's nothing you can sacrifice. There's nothing you can give to make this happen. The only thing you could do is recognize: death died, Hades died, your books are burned, the tree's gone. There's only one thing that stands: it's a tree of life and the book. Is it good?

Can I show you what this looks like? Do you want to go further into Revelation? No? Yeah? You know what, let me do something. Just, how many of you think I'm crazy? Anybody yet? All right, good, the good kind of crazy. She doesn't think I'm crazy. She is absolutely positive, fully convinced, no height nor depth nor created thing could... Oh man, where is it? What did I

tell you to start? Okay. I don't like to throw out life-changing concepts without giving you solid foundational background. So the word... hmm... to "anyone," which is insane, because it was never translated into "anyone" in the Greek language. It was "any, somewhat, anything, something, certain thing, diverse things." Hmm. "Wherewith." It's the genitive indefinite pronoun used of things concerning which the writer either cannot or will not speak more particularly. It's just that simple. He didn't want to name everything written in the books, so he said anything written in the books was cast into the lake of fire. Is that good? Okay. All right, I'm gonna... okay, it's 1:30, right? So I got, like, 10 more minutes, and we'll take a 10-minute break. We'll get

The Woman at the Well

to the Q&A. All right, go to John 4. I teach from New King James. Big fan of Brian Simmons' Passion Translation. Yeah, it's fantastic. Here's the deal: I've read this so much that I can't read something else, because when I read, like, The Passion or anything, like, my mind's fighting, because I know what it's supposed to say. So I listen to François Du Toit. Somebody okay with that? Yeah? Okay. And I actually... Brian's been to our church before. Brian Simmons and Candice are wonderful people. So I listen to that too, but for some reason I can't read it, because I start turning it into this, because I've read this for 11 years. So yeah, I preach from the New King James.

John 4, verse 1: "Therefore, when the Lord knew that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus made and baptized more disciples than John (though Jesus Himself did not baptize), He and His disciples left Judea and departed again to Galilee. But He needed to go through Samaria." Isn't that good news? He needed to go through Samaria. You know, religious people went around Samaria. "So He came to," the Samaria, excuse me, "the city of Samaria which is called Sychar, near the plot of ground that Jacob gave to his son Joseph. Now Jacob's well was there, and Jesus therefore, being wearied from His journey, sat thus by the well. It was the sixth hour, and a woman of Samaria came to draw water. Jesus said to her, 'Give Me a drink.' For His disciples had gone away into the city to buy food. The woman of Samaria said to Him, 'How is it that You, being a Jew, ask a drink from me, a woman of Samaria?' For the Jews have no dealings with Samaritans.

"Jesus answered her and said, 'If you knew the gift of God, and who it is that says to you, "Give Me a drink," you would have asked Him, and He would have given you living water.' The woman said to Him, 'Sir, You have nothing to draw with, and the well is deep. Where then do You get this living water? Are You greater than our father Jacob, who gave us this well, and drank from it himself, as well as his sons and his livestock?' Jesus answered and said, 'Whoever drinks of this water will thirst again; whoever drinks of the water that I shall give

him will never thirst. But the water that I shall give him will become in him a fountain of water springing up into everlasting life.' The woman said to Him, 'Sir, give me this water, that I may not thirst, nor come here to draw.' Jesus said to her, 'Go and call your husband, and come here.' The woman answered and said, 'I have no husband.' Jesus said to her, 'You have well said, "I have no husband," for you have had five husbands, and the one whom you have now is not your husband; in that you spoke truly.'"

Okay, I want you to see how Jesus sees, so you can understand the amount of honor that He puts on His own work, right? So this woman... I don't know if you guys have had this taught this way here, but my wife and I both had similar encounters where we were supposed to justify the woman at the well. We were supposed to defend her honor. Isn't that kind of crazy? How many of you heard she was, like, a hooker? She was not. She was not an adulteress in any way. The reason that Samaritans were looked down upon by Jews is because Samaritans wanted to be Jews, and they weren't in the lineage. So they adopted Jewish culture; they adopted Jewish laws. And if you want to truly understand divorce, ladies, this isn't permission, but I want you to understand how much God loves you, okay? Just check your Bible; I promise it's true.

The disciples asked Jesus why Moses offered women a certificate of divorce. He said, "Because your husbands have hard hearts." So in the Bible there was a certified divorce and there was a non-certified divorce. A non-certified divorce meant that you didn't get a certificate; that's what happened when you committed adultery. A certified divorce was when a woman could go to her husband and say, "You've put me away. You don't love me. I deserve to find love." So he would write her a certificate of divorce. The certificate of divorce would afford her the opportunity to consummate marriage with another man without bleeding and not be killed, right? According to Jewish tradition, if they weren't able to offer a consummation garment, they would be immediately escorted outside the city and stoned to death. But if a woman married a man and he didn't love her, she could leave. Women were meant to be loved.

A woman started in the home of a Jewish father who is wealthy, loving, caring, and righteous. And then a man had to prove that she was valuable by offering the father half of her estate, or half of his estate. Then he had to go prepare a place for her. Then he had to ascribe to something called next-of-kin care, which meant he promised if he couldn't take care of her, one of his family members would. This woman was never meant to be outside the hands of a loving man. And if she ever found herself there, she could go and she would get a certificate of divorce. And with that certificate of divorce she could tell the man, "I know you love me, but I can't bleed for you. But I'm permitted to find love. And when we consummate our marriage, I'm not going to give you a garment. I'm going to give you a certificate that says I'm allowed to

be loved." Isn't that good?

So this woman is still alive after five husbands. What do you think that means? None of them loved her. Man, I can't even talk about her. None of them loved her, and the one she has now, not her husband, right? No commitment. And Jesus says, "I'll be your seventh man." But she has been so bound by religion as a Samaritan that she believes internally... This is Jesus's perfect wisdom and discernment: "I've just offered this woman living water. She's going to walk away, and I'll never see her again, because she's going to walk away saying, 'He doesn't know who I am. If He knew who I was, He'd have never offered me living water.'" So He says, "Honey, go tell your husband." She goes, "I don't." He said, "I know. I already know. And what those men said about you means nothing to Me. Those men put you away, and I never will. I will be your seventh man. I will be the one that you've been waiting for all your life. I will never see you according to the things written in the books, because I know what the book says."

Come on, He's good. Good. He's good. And we've twisted this thing to manipulate people into being afraid of the best Father that they could ever ask for. And all He wants to do is give you... listen, Deuteronomy: choose life and good, or death and curses. Everything that you were never meant to be was cast into a lake of fire, so that you could become, step into, everything that you were ever made for. Amen. Thank you, guys. That's the day death died.

Part 4

Legalism and Identity

Can you give examples of how legalism robs identity? That was too fast, wasn't it? Can you give examples of how legalism would rob someone of their identity? Okay, who would like to go? Oh, hey, we got two mics.

My entire book is that. It robbed my identity completely. It's like life led me to Jesus and then took me right out, away from Jesus, because of the legalism, the way I was brought up. My identity was in works, in trying to make Him happy: "Am I good enough, Dad?" And you know, with my father, my real father, he was not a good father, so I was looking to God to be one. And everybody told me, "He just loves you, but if you're bad, you're going to hell in a handbasket. Let's go to church." That is not exactly what I needed. So I told God, I was like, "You are a mean Dad. You're just mean. You're mean, and I wanted You to be nice, so I have nobody." So I left Him. I thought I left Him, you know, and it took me on a journey that was very, very bad and dark, and it took my identity away. And the only way I could find it was in Him. The only way we can find ourselves is in Christ, in Christ in us. And I had to figure that out, and God was so long-suffering, and in that I found my identity in Him. Did I answer that right?

That's great. Anybody else? Anybody else? She set the bar. Hi, Shanda. He said he's not willing to answer after that one. Oh, goodness. Pass the mic. We're live streaming, right?

I'd say legalism keeps you from ever... You're always almost there, but you're never there. And I always picture Chris Blackaby pulling on the rope, trying to get himself closer and closer to being who he's supposed to be, closer and closer to the Father. And like, you can do all these things, right, and you can make, in your mind, all this ground up, and you have one mistake and you go all the way back to the end of the rope. So it just keeps you, and it's never enough. That's not really an example, but that's the picture in my mind of legalism.

Out of it, so I guess, like, I would answer it: the world is very loud. Like, people have opinions of you who haven't walked in your shoes, you know? They may judge you from afar, but we come into agreement with that. So let's just say college years, you know, I'm gonna be blunt: like, you're a party animal, you're an addict, you're lazy, you're whatever, you know? And then it's like the world is so loud, and when we come into agreement, I would hear those things verbatim. Like, everything I thought I was, which was not good, I would hear it verbatim, because I knew, like, the track. Like, I knew every word, because I knew it forward and backward. But what does God say about you? That is the only thing that matters. Like, one of

my favorite quotes is, "Someone else's opinion of me is none of my business." Like, what God says goes, period, point blank, end of story. That's what it is.

I think legalism is a distraction tactic, because it makes you focus on the wrong things and ask the wrong questions on your journey. And so I think that sometimes it just keeps us from asking who we are and knowing who we are in Christ, because we're so busy taking care of it. I think about myself, and this is just... everything always boils down to me as a mom. But like, if I need to get ready, like I needed to get ready for today, to take a shower, that's the one thing I need to do for myself. But then I can't, because I got so distracted by, like, everything I kept hitting on the way, like piles on the stairs and dishes, and then a kid was talking to me, and this and that. And in the end, it's like I didn't get to that one thing, but it's just because my focus was off, you know? And it can be as simple as that: we're so focused on, you know, who everybody says we're supposed to be, and this ideal, this invisible, unreachable ideal.

Especially, I think, it's put on women. I mean, maybe I just think that because I'm a woman. I think it probably applies to men too, and you could probably speak better to that. But I know especially in women, especially in the church, there's this ideal, like, "You should be a Mary, not a Martha." I think that's wrong. Martha's redeemed, and I can go into that, but I won't. Anyways, I think they were both beautiful in their purpose, and it had to do with the heart of it. And I think that we get thrown Proverbs 31, also often misinterpreted. And so there's all of these things that we feel like we have to live up to in a legalistic way, and it distracts us from just communing with Christ and asking, "Who did You make me to be?" you know? And we feel crucified if we're a strong personality or independent: "We're Jezebel," you know? That's totally misinterpreted also, and can be redeemed. So anyways, yeah.

So you didn't take a shower? No, but I sprayed compensation perfume, and they all said I smell good, so we're good. Compensation! That's what legalism is, right there. It works, but it's not really the solution.

Well, legalism, I think it puts too much weight on your behavior, and behavior changes all the time as we go through life. And so there's no constant in it. The only constant is what God says about you, what He's saying, and that's the only constant that's established in all of reality. So there's my two cents.

You're not sitting next to her. My book is going to be called Showerless. It's gonna be about living an empowered life without needing that. Okay, that's written in the books, not the book. Whoa, come on. No one's learning. Yeah, I was listening. That's awesome, what I said. The mom is engaged, active and engaged. Yep.

So, it's the first question. I said I wasn't going to say anything, but I'm only saying this because you said it a certain way. You said you lose track of the one thing. So when Jews interpret Scripture, they're not satisfied as a rabbi, and so they have four interpretations of every scripture. Did you know that? Four interpretations. And with each one, it's a layer of complexity and mystery, and if you want, I'll send you this document; Brian Simmons sent it to me. There is an interpretation of Scripture that is called hints. Well, I forget the Hebrew word, but the English word is "hints," and it's things buried in translation that just mean something, like the city of Sychar, meaning drunkenness, right?

So when Martha and Mary were competing for Jesus's attention... I can't even say it that way. When Martha was competing for Jesus's attention, and it says, "But Mary has chosen that one thing that will not be taken away from her," do you know what the Greek word for "one thing" was? It's the Greek word heis, h-e-i-s. One thing; that means one thing. But what is one thing? H-e-i-s. Yep. So Hebrews would recognize that as one of God's... like, it's a flirt. That's so good. Yep, yeah, yep, that's exactly what it means. So yeah, you can't lose track of that one thing. Fantastic. You guys ready for the next question? Yeah.

Authority and the Tongue

Oh, okay. "Ananias and Sapphira appear to have died from a guilty conscience. Talk about that." Come on. Why and how? What was the last part of it? "Talk about that, why and how." Go ahead. Oh, I've got ugly on you to give it to me. Okay.

So I'm gonna try to do this quickly. We have Stephen the Martyr, right? And he's like, "Father, forgive them; they don't know what they're doing." And who was there? Saul witnessed it. It was later on, on his way, and Jesus said, "What are you doing to My people?" So later on, he was forgiven. So, Jesus noticed that. Jesus approaches Saul, changes his name to Paul, scales fall off of his eyes, the law's scales fall off of his eyes, and he can see, and then he just becomes this great apostle, right? We all know him. And then later we have Peter, who's a little hothead, you know, cutting off ears, you know, pretty choleric kind of guy. And he finds out that Ananias and Sapphira are liars, and instead of saying, "Father, forgive them; they don't know what they're doing," he's like, "You know what's gonna happen to you? You're gonna die." And they did. That's New Testament, folks. So we got to think to ourselves: what are we saying? You need to forgive. We need to love, because life and death literally are in the power of the tongue.

You literally gave the first half of what was going to be my answer. We're gonna ask, because that was your question. Yeah, if you read... yeah, he did. I am of the opinion that Peter cursed them to death and they died. Because here's the thing: especially when you're in an atmosphere

of glory, things accelerate, right? The thing is, when the Bible says that all authority in heaven and earth has been given to us, right, it doesn't say "only if you make the good decisions that God says He wants to have happen in that moment, and you're perfectly aligned with God's will, and you repented yesterday." Like, it doesn't say any of those things. He just says you have all authority, period. We see in Amos, the Lord does nothing without telling His servants the prophets. Psalm 115:16: "The heavens are the Lord's, and the fullness therein, but the earth He's given to man."

The reason I'm saying all of that is because I'm creating context in the Scripture, but that we have sovereign authority over what happens in the realm of earth. In fact, God has to talk to us and have us pray in order for things to happen. So when life and death is in the power of the tongue, the things we speak, we're literally co-creating as sons and daughters of the Most High God. We are Elohim, lesser gods, because we're made in His image as His new sons and daughters, as in spiritually born of our Father in heaven, right? So we are gods. That is scriptural, for anybody listening on live feed who wants to complain about it too. Like, you have to look it up. I dropped a huge bomb there, but you have to look it up, through all the description of what the Bible actually says of the new birth. We are sons and daughters of the Most High God. There is no God higher than Him, but we have been given authority as lesser gods in the earth realm. So if we decree things... the Bible says, "Decree a thing, and it will be established." We can kill people with our words.

You see this not just with Ananias and Sapphira, though, but you go later on, when Simon the Sorcerer... if you guys go read that passage, Simon sees something happening. He sees that power is released with the laying on of hands, and he says, "I want that." That is more amazing than any other power of the darkness that he'd ever worked with before. The man was a sorcerer. He was well skilled, and he knew exactly what he was doing with witchcraft and sorcery. The man knew the power of darkness, right? But he sees what these guys are doing, and he says, "I want that. How much does it cost?" Peter doesn't say, "Look, you..." (back to identity) "...you don't know who God has created you to be, and you don't know your identity. You don't know that this comes freely as a son." He says, "May your money die with you, because you tried to buy the gift of God," basically.

And then Simon says, "I'm sorry," because the man doesn't know that you can't buy the gift of God, because he's in witchcraft, where everything is a transaction. That is literally how witchcraft works. It's transactional spirituality. So he doesn't know that he's not supposed to buy it, because everything in his background says he's only supposed to buy it. So he's doing the best he knows how and trying to honor and value this person. He says, "Oh, and you're going to die because you asked me that question." And the guy's like, "Please pray that that

doesn't happen. I'm really sorry, and I don't know what I did wrong," you know? And if you look later on in history, Simon the Sorcerer is essentially the founder of Gnosticism. So the fruit of what Peter did, cursing this man to death, was not good.

We see Peter consistently doing things and making choices where the results of what he's saying are going to occur, because the man knows this authority and who he is in Christ. If he speaks death... like the tree that got cursed by Jesus, it died. If we speak death, things and people will die. Death will enter their lives; decay will enter their lives. That's why that matters. So Ananias and Sapphira, they died because Peter killed them. That is my opinion.

I just want to add, I believe there's an agreement also. Okay, there has to be a covenant. I say you're this; what say you? And exactly, and exactly, you won't. Because I've had people come against me many times and say, "You're this, that, and the other." And every day, I believe that you're asked two questions every day, every single day, every decision you have. The average person has around 40,000 thoughts a day; ADD or ADHD has around 70,000. That's a lot of thought, 70,000. But every decision you make... it says take all thoughts captive. You have to come to a decision where you're not going to agree with it, you know? You're not going to let me think... I want to put this... Oh, that's gonna do it. I lost my thought with "all thoughts captive" there. That thing went. I took it captive. Yes, yes. 2 Corinthians 10:4–6, I believe.

So I believe there's a covenant, an agreement, and if you're not coming into that with a person... you know, people come against me, like I said, and I'm just like, whether I was guilty or not, you have to say, "No, I'm innocent." Two questions, that's where I was. One, you're gonna be asked two questions every day: "What did God say?" or "Did God really say?" Every decision you have, Satan's asking you every day. He's coming, saying, "What did God say? Did God really say? Did He really?" So you have to ask those questions. And I just believe that you have to come into agreement with somebody, with what they're saying. It's a covenant. So no, I don't think they had to die. I think they could have said, "No, I'm sorry, I don't want to do this anymore." I think they would have lived.

So this is the fourth interpretation I'm about to do. I think Peter still had the sword with him. Come on. And the sword... I didn't hear that. He sure did. Oh, he said he thinks that he still had the sword. Okay. I mean, this is not something, you know, I'm making doctrine out of or anything, okay? But I'm just saying there's a chance that he actually... I mean, he had the sword still. He could have... I mean, it just doesn't write in the detail of how they died or whatever. I know that that was a verbal conversation, but if he struck him, if he struck him down, then they would be struck down. Unlikely, okay, very unlikely. But he did go to try to chop someone's head off not too long before this. So I'm just saying the possibility's there, because, you know, we needed four interpretations, and I'm coming up with something. Yeah. So I'm just saying, I

mean, think about it. Of everything that's being said, I personally am on board more with the power of the tongue, right, and the coming into agreement with the condemnation, and that literally killed them, that judgment. I'm personally... that's what I would lean towards. But I'm just saying that if you look at Peter's tendency, right... Yeah, it is. He heals... the sword, that's it. Okay, yeah.

Also, I think that, you know, it just goes to show they probably had massive respect for Peter. They probably idolized him on some level, because he was leading the movement, and they were trying to bolster their position in that by saying, "Look at what we did." And so there was definitely a strong people-pleasing aspect in that. And so when I think about it, you know, people we look up to, people we put on pedestals, we unveil ourselves for their words. Their words penetrate deeply, because we're not guarded to it. So I think, as you know, if you're speaking into people's lives, you know, it's just a responsibility to understand that sometimes your words have penetration on a deeper level than a stranger's would, and to really make sure that the Spirit's moving, and even speaking life always, and not get caught up in the emotion of it, you know, your own just knee-jerk reactions.

And then also, on the flip side, to be guarding your heart and really listening: like, is this person speaking life? I know I've had... I'm sure we've all had people in certain positions that have disappointed us, because we realized, you know, they're still humans, and they're being transformed. Okay. And sometimes we've put them... so sometimes you just have to learn, like, to really just allow Christ to speak truth and life and to show you who are safe, you know, to speak into you, so you don't automatically just come into agreement because of their position and their authority. Anyone else?

I want to just add one more detail, and this is going to help you as you read your Bible, in how to get new revelation in things that you've read a trillion times before. There's a passage, and I don't remember where it is, but it's somewhere in Acts. They're writing a letter, and the disciples write a letter that says, "It seemed good to the Holy Spirit and to us," and then they say, "Just follow these four legalistic rules." Okay? So my question when I read that is, I'm like, did it really seem good to the Holy Spirit and to you to give them four rules out of the long list of things to follow? Because the gospel is actually that the law was done away with and we have a new law. So why are we only following four at that point in time? You might as well follow all of them, or follow ten of them. Like, it's an arbitrary number based on an old, inferior covenant that Jesus completed and did away with.

So when I read that passage, I'm asking myself the question: what actually was going on there? Did they think it seemed good to the Holy Spirit? Did it seem good to the Holy Spirit because there was a situational moment, in that moment, that they needed that instruction, and it was

only good for a period of time, then it would move on? Or did it never seem good to the Holy Spirit to begin with, and they just thought it did, and they wrote that? The reason that matters is because when we read Scripture, there's this idea that we've been taught: "The Bible says it, I believe it, that settles it." And it's never... not never, but it's rarely that simple. We have to critically think with what we're reading and be intentional about engaging with the Holy Spirit, who literally has all wisdom and knowledge about what we're reading in the text. And I think if we are intentional about doing that, when we see stuff, we can ask Him questions, and He'll lead and guide us into all the truth. It's His nature. Anybody else?

Okay, this question is actually specifically for Neil: "What are the Hebrew names of each of the eyes of the cherubim, and what do they mean?" My question is, Neil, I may have gotten word that that question was planted by Sung and Michael. Oh my gosh. Okay, you ready for the real one? Okay.

The Defeat of Death

Okay, I like this one. "Death is defeated, but are we still waiting for the last enemy, death, to go from this realm?" Death is defeated, but are we still waiting for death, the last enemy, to go from this realm? Shoot your shot, y'all. Neil, Neil knows it like the back of his hand. So death is clearly defeated, like we just learned, Revelation 15: it's dead. Are we still waiting for something other than what happened in the heavenlies to take place on earth? Is there still an appropriation that needs to take place of the finished work?

So the way I look at what our job is: right, Romans 8 tells us that all creation is groaning in eager expectation, waiting for the manifest sons of God, basically, to manifest themselves. The firstfruits of that is the redemption of our bodies, right? We know that the last enemy to be destroyed is death, and everything's placed under Jesus's feet. Once all that happens, He hands things over to the Father. The way I look at this, Jesus completed a legal battle in the heavens to transfer something legally in creation. So what we're dealing with is, Jesus accomplished something essentially in a courtroom; that's a way you can think about that. Whereas we... if you think of the way the U.S. works, we have the executive, legislative, and judicial branches, right? We are the executive branch that carries it out. We, and the angels really, we're the ones who carry out God's word. So yes, death was defeated legally. We're the ones who go and manifest it into the earth.

So when we see a problem, right, sickness and disease, if we don't go fix it, nobody else is going to, right? This idea that God sovereignly moves: God has not once sovereignly moved in all of Scripture outside of what He determined in the beginning and preset that He had the ability to do, because He gave us authority. So when we're saying, "Well, God had a sovereign

move," no, He had somebody in Africa pray in tongues yesterday, and you just don't know about it. Like, I mean, honestly speaking, we have these moments where, like, "God sovereignly did something." No, He woke up your great-aunt at two in the morning, and she never told you about it.

Like, I would have died January 1st at about 5:30 in the morning this year, instantly, in a car accident, except God, three weeks before that, told my wife to be praying for me, for safety on the road. I missed instantly dying by probably about a foot, and in the distance of about a second of time. And I'm saying that because the Lord told my wife, and she didn't tell me about it either until I told her later that afternoon, because I didn't want to freak her out either. My vehicle's untouched. You wouldn't even know that I barely missed dying instantly. But the whole thing is, if we don't pray, nothing happens. If we don't do something... you pass by somebody on the street, and they're like, "Oh, you know what the Bible says about..." you know, "Be blessed, be well, be healthy," and Jesus is like, "No, you have to actually give them food and drink." Like, if we don't intervene in events, nothing happens, because we are God's solution in the earth.

So if we want to see death go in a manifested form... we already know it's been defeated on the cross, as we come to understand, and that's a lot of what this is. This is a prophetic message we're preaching about what God's releasing now into the earth, so that we can go walk that out and release all creation from its bondage to death and decay. So if each one of us here doesn't take hold of that and doesn't start speaking life and removal of death and decay from the world around us, from our bodies and those of the other people around us, then we should expect nothing to change. But as we do it, we should expect that everything will change. Does that make sense? So yes, we are waiting for something to happen. What we're waiting for to happen is us. We're waiting for us to happen to things, and when we happen to things, those things will change.

Who's next? Shanda? Short, just a short little blurb. We wait on God so much, and He waits on us even more, you know? And the last thing I heard was, "It is finished." Come on. Awesome.

I was just going to say, and some of you guys have probably already heard this, but, you know, one of the best analogies that I've heard regarding this, and I've thought about it more, was the Emancipation Proclamation, when the slaves were freed according to the government. And then Juneteenth is celebrated in the South, because it took them months and months and months to find out the slaves were free. And it wasn't an accident. It wasn't, like, because the mail was slow. It was actually because the plantations down there, and the industry that had developed, was based on slave work, and they knew that they would go bankrupt if they had to start paying them and hiring them. And so they intentionally... the principalities and authorities

of that region intentionally kept it quiet so that the slaves would continue to work, even though on a legal level they were totally free. And it took a lot of bravery and a lot of, you know, infiltration finally for messengers to come and to convince them that, "No, no, you're free. You're free." Okay?

And so I feel like that's it. Death has been defeated, but we still have principalities and rulers of this dark world that have created a system that works based on fear and death and shame and condemnation, and that's how they get rich, and they don't want that system to go. And so they're intentionally blinding people to their freedom, and it's our job to go and to let them know what's already been conquered. Right. Very good. Yeah, yeah.

So I would just say both things are true, because death has been defeated, and the evidence of that is the resurrection of Jesus. That was the start of the new creation. That was the beginning of this new creation, and we're that new creation. It's happening on a development level, but at the same time, I believe there's a fulfillment of it as well that will see the completion of it. But that's why, like, the church is so amazing. Like, our mandate on earth as a church is absolutely... it's so phenomenal that we get to, like, literally co-create this new creation and bring it on to this being, bring it on to this realm, this earth. And that's why we're here.

And I mean, think about this: when you guys were growing up, did you ever hear a message about immortality in the church? No. But look now, look at what's happening. And so if no one sat... and it's not preached, how will they know, right? And so this truth is being released more and more, and it's been becoming more acceptable. I mean, before, I would give credit to Kobus van Rensburg as the first to really preach this and get it out there, a true forerunner in that. And there was a reason for that, and there's a reason why we're all here, and there's a reason why this message is going forward now. And so I would liken it to, like, healing, and the way we understood salvation, things like that. It's so much easier to step into belief with now, and we see more and more of it. Same thing, I believe, with everlasting life: yes, there will be a time of complete fulfillment, but at the same time, we're creating it. It's coming to pass. And so it's God doing the work, and we're here for the ride, and our job is to believe. And we believe by feasting, right? So, all right. Cool.

All right, I like this one too. "If Jesus paid the price, won the victory, baptized us into His death..."

Progressive Revelation

burial and resurrection, and seated us in the heavenly places two thousand years ago, why has it taken us, His sons and daughters, so long to get this, the good news that is ever increasing?

So for me, previously, death was my savior. I thought, "Oh my gosh, when I get to heaven I'll be cured, I'll know everything," like, it's everything I hoped for. And then, you know, we talk about the cloud of witnesses, and, you know, we learned, like, sitting under our pastor's teaching, those in the cloud are waiting to come back here. Like, heaven is not the destination, you know; it's a new heaven and a new earth. And so I think coming out of agreement with that, and like knowing my identity, because I thought I had to wait to die to get everything that was promised to me. And then, you know, with the book Deathless and with the teaching we sit in at the academy, that is all for right now. Like, I am a manifest son, so you better believe I'm going to be understanding and operating in that power, because it was freely given to me.

And even that's a little hard to govern sometimes, hard to understand and grasp, but I think what it is, is an identity crisis, because we don't know who we are. We don't know how empowered we are. You know, it's weird to say that we are equal with God, like, I am as He is. And even for myself, it took me forever to learn I'm a spirit with a soul and a body. My spirit was with Him before the creation of the world. Like, we are one. And like, yes, my body is upon the earth at this time, but like, we are one. I mean, for me to understand who that was changed everything.

Okay. I think there's an element of this that has a lot to do with... some of it has to do with the fullness of time, some of it has to do with the progression. Like, the Bible says that of the increase of His government and peace there will be no end. When Jesus died and rose again, He established a new reign of His government, and it's ever increasing, right? But if you look through history, you've got the Dark Ages and all this other stuff. You see this gradual increasing of, really, government and peace in the earth. And it's not limited to the earth, but if we stick with that throughout history for a second, you then have, like, the Renaissance and the Age of Enlightenment, the Industrial Era. You have these things where information travels faster, which then causes revolutions in technology and other things, which then causes information to travel faster, which causes new revelations and understanding.

So now, once we got the internet, like, that changed everything, because we're seeing this exponential growth curve of the speed at which information can travel, which then causes us to encounter new ideas, new thoughts. We transform our minds, come into alignment with new things, which then causes things to be released into the earth to transform it and speed it up even further. So I think some of what we're seeing is we're seeing that we're in a place in history where some of it's a timing issue. It's the age we're in, right? We're in the dawn of, you could say, the seventh day, right? If you look at the seven days of creation, we're at the seven thousandth year. C.E., 2000 anno Domini, post-Jesus, but there was, what, five thousand before that? Yeah. So four thousand before that, we had 2,000 after, and then we're at the

beginning of that seven thousand, which would be a day. Does that make sense, what I'm saying? Okay.

So we're at the dawn of the seventh day, which is His rest, but we're also at the dawn of the third day. Now Hosea 6 talks about it. It says, "For He has torn, but He will heal us; He has stricken, but He will bind us up. After two days He will revive us," right? So the last thousand years was about revivals, right? Or we were looking for revivals, where we had a revival here; God releases a revelation of something and restores it to the body of Christ. But it says, "On the third day He will restore us, so that we may live in His sight." So restoration and life. We're at the beginning of the dawn of the third day, where we're seeing... and the seventh day, they're converging, right? So we see restoration, life, and rest. And so some of what this is, is this is the fullness of time, where we get blessed to be in a generation, and I include everybody who's here, if you're alive you're in this generation, that gets to see the release of the manifold wisdom of God in rest, life, and restoration.

So some of it is a timing thing, and some of it is just the speed at which information travels. We get to communicate and step into these things and accelerate it faster. Rapid transformation happens. Transformation happens at the speed of revelation, not education. Yeah. So 40 years of bad teaching can be undone in the blink of an eye. Yeah, it's good. Yeah, we're all thankful for that one, right? Anybody else have anything to add to that?

There's one more thing with this whole idea of getting new understanding, right? I think it's important. You said something about a new heaven and a new earth, Kelly, and I think that's important. When the Bible talks about there's a new heaven and a new earth, we've been taught that God's scrapping this creation and He's bringing in a new one. That's literally not what that means. Heaven, earth, and the sea were what was referred to as the Holy of Holies, the inner court, and the outer court, right? There's a reason He says there's a new heaven, a new earth, and there will be no sea. It doesn't mean He's killing all the manatees off, right? He's not... like, it doesn't mean He's just going to evaporate the ocean and so all of the ocean creatures... Like, as a kid that's what I thought. I was like, "Well, that's weird, but okay. I mean, You're God, You can do what You want." But I was like eight, so that's understandable.

As an adult, it means there is no outer court. The outer court is where you deal with sin. There is no more outer court. So even in verse, what, 20, or chapter 20, or whatever we're reading, it's talking about the sea. Think of that as the outer court, where sin is dealt with. That's, I believe, thrown into the lake of fire. It says something about that; I forget what it says, you'd have to look at it, but it matches with that, that you're not dealing with sin anymore. So when we understand God's not scrapping this creation, we're restoring it. So the new heaven and new earth has to do with the temple and where that's located: in us. It doesn't mean that we're

waiting for, like, a new heaven to come out of the clouds physically, because there's another translated meaning, basically, that that has. But when we understand that, it changes what we believe and then how we live our lives as a result.

Just again, just a quick thing to add to that. I forgot who said this. It was a quote that really made me think about it, and it's right along with what you're saying, and I think it's going to help us all. It's: if we knew for sure that the full fulfillment and manifestation of everything, the new creation, the new heaven and earth, is tomorrow, what's going to happen, right? So what would we do today? Go plant a tree. Because what we do today, in the coming and the ushering of the timing aspect that we're waiting for, the ordained time of it, is... everything matters. I'm not sure how it matters, but I know that it's exponentially exposed in a very good way. And so the good works, not the dead works but the good works we do, absolutely matter, because it's something that we'll see even more of the fruit of in this new creation.

So it's not like we just twiddle our thumbs and, like, "What's coming tomorrow? So, you know, we're just gonna sit here and wait." No, we're doing everything we can today, because when it does come, it all bears some type of incredible fruit that, honestly, I can't really describe to you, except that it's like an enhancement of everything. It's just an enhancement of everything, because He's not destroying this world and He's just gonna start over new. It's actually like the transformation, the Transfiguration. Jesus has a body and it was transfigured. Same thing with this earth; it's transfigured. That's why it's groaning, waiting for the manifestation of the sons of God. So it's not a, you know, "God's gonna nuke this world," as many people think, "and then this new heaven and earth is going to be created." No, it's from this same, from this material; something's happening. And so, yeah.

This young lady asked a quick question. This will just help, and really your question has some, like, specifications to it that would require way more information, but, you know, the Bible was largely written by Hebrews, and Hebrews have something in their understanding called the heaven and earth system. And the heaven and earth system is where heaven met earth. So the first heaven and earth system was the garden, and every heaven and earth system has a marriage, a son, and a temple. And heaven and earth systems change when the marriage changes, the son changes, and the temple changes. So Eden was the first temple. God and humanity was the... excuse me, Adam and Eve were the first marriage, and humanity was the first son. That was the heaven and earth system.

When that was lost, then the heaven and earth system became the temple system. The temple system was the second heaven and earth system. And then the passages in, like, 1 Peter, where it talks about heaven and earth passing away and the elements melting with fervent heat, Hebrews, like, they have such a wildly clear understanding of that. That means the temple is

going to burn. And the word "elements" meant literally sacrificial furniture. So it's not, like, earth, air, wind, water, fire, whatever those things are. It's the things that were used in Levitical worship. Those things will be burned up, and that heaven and earth system will fade away, will die. And then there was a new heaven and earth system. There was a new marriage, a new son, and a new tabernacle. That's why, when they talked of Jesus, it's that God is now tabernacling among men. He was the tabernacle Himself. The new marriage was between Christ and the church. The new son was Christ. So now there's an ever-increasing heaven and earth system that was planted in the old one, and now of this one there will be no end, according to the prophet Isaiah. Yeah. Yeah, sure.

Yeah, no, the Hebrews are smart people when it comes to their own book, you know. So 70 A.D. was a ridiculously significant date to them, and we kind of rob ourselves sometimes. We really focus on the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ, but the inter-testament period... everything that God does that has to do with transformation and probation is 40. So there were 40 years between 30 and 70, which is... 30 was when Jesus was ordained a new priest. Which, real quick, I'll answer that question: how did Jesus being baptized in the Jordan fulfill our righteousness? Somebody asked that question; that was you. He put an end to the Levitical priesthood. The last line of the Levitical priests, John the Baptist, now cleansed the new or next priest, according to the order of Melchizedek. The book of Hebrews says that of necessity, with the changing of the priesthood, of necessity the law has to be changed. So if there's no priest officiating at the altar for that particular system, then the law is completely null and void. Yeah.

So that happened at 30. And then the futurist people, they say that "he will make a covenant with many for one week, but in the middle of the week he'll put an end to sacrifice and offering," and they usually say that's the Antichrist. Funny story: it was Jesus. Yep. He made a covenant with many for one week. The gospel was never preached to Gentiles until three and a half years after the resurrection. So for seven years they went solely after the lost sheep of the house of Israel, but in the middle of that endeavor, Jesus was killed, buried, and resurrected. So He put an end to all sacrifice and offering. So 30 A.D., priesthood's changed; 33 and a half A.D., the sacrifice has changed; 70 A.D., temple's obliterated. So it's over. And from that moment, that 40-year period, it was inter-testament, and now it's an ever-increasing kingdom, and there's nothing left to come. It's good.

Absolutely. So Jackie, Jackie Vote, do you guys know her? From Colombo, is that where she's from? She does tremendous teachings on prophetic timelines. All the stuff that Michael mentioned is really good. So did I answer a question? Which one was it? It was yours. Oh, because we were talking about something before that, right? Your question. Okay. Does

anybody have anything to add to that question? Okay, there's two questions that are kind of the same. I'm gonna put them

Fasting and Thought Control

together. So somebody asked, like, how fasting and taking your thoughts captive are not striving. Like, if we're a new creation, why do we have to take thoughts captive, and why do we fast? And that is a phenomenal question, and I would just start by saying that they're both relevant and they're both expressions of the new creation. But, and then I'm going to let everybody else on the panel answer the question. Who's up first? Shanda, you're good at this. Yeah, go ahead.

So if my husband and I argue, it's over fasting. But I like to always, again, I like to say, "It is finished. Why do we have to do this?" Because we have this behavior, we have this identity crisis that we... I know personally I keep going back to, I'm like, "Why do I keep doing the things I don't want to do, and I can't do the things that I want to do?" Who else said that? You know? And I think we're trying to get more spiritual, and I believe that fasting isn't... like, I don't fast to say, "Jesus, I really want a new car, I want to fast to get it," you know. We... and this is why I used to fast. But now I fast because I want to kill this flesh, because it is so alive and it can run me all day, for days. So if I fast, it's like I'm closing the eyes of the flesh and opening the eyes of the spirit. And the more I fast, the more I hear Him, the closer I am. And we don't live by bread alone; we live by every word that proceeds out of the mouth of God.

And was it fasting, or what else was it? Yes. That's one of my favorites too. Again, 2 Corinthians 10, if you start at verse 4, it talks about taking all thoughts captive into captivity. And then, basically paraphrasing, He is going... once you make a decision, He's going to come down and He is going to just destroy everything... that you've been obedient for, anything that was disobedient against you, He's going to come and destroy it. He says, but you have to make a decision, and sometimes we don't. So those thoughts have to be taken captive every single day, until we get it under our feet for real, and believe it, not just say it, but just over and over, until our head, our soul, knows what our spirit is saying. The spirit has to be the boss, not the brain. Is that what you wanted me to say? Oh, do you want to tell about our fights with fasting? I'm like, "I don't understand." No, I'm just kidding. Ha ha ha.

Yeah, yeah. So kind of, just to confirm what Shanda was saying, is that the fasting aspect of it, you're not fasting to become anything that you're not. It's just making you more sensitive to the things that you wouldn't be sensitive with, because you're so used to these five senses. So that's where the fasting side comes in. In terms of taking every thought captive, if you continue on, that verse has "taking every thought captive to the obedience of Christ," which is the

faithfulness of Christ. And so it's so easy for our minds to stray, right, about the truth and the finished work of Jesus, and the faithfulness of Jesus, and the power of Jesus and the cross. What does the death and resurrection, the cross, really mean to, like, my living today, right now? Like, do we really... you know?

So the more we actually take every thought to the faithfulness of Christ, or the obedience of Christ, it keeps you... it's like this. You guys, you know, when you come here, like on a... if you go to church, right, on a Sunday, and your mind is just... it's, you know, your intention, your focus, your worship, everything is on Jesus, and you're, quote, "more in the spirit," whatever, however you want to call it. You feel more of the presence, all that stuff. All of a sudden, that world, right, your world is... He seems so much more real than that world, right? Do you know what I'm saying? Like, He's just like... that's why I call, like, Sunday one of my favorite days of the week, because I get to see all you guys and stuff. But it's so easy to be in that realm that we're in, okay?

And this ties in with fasting, because with the fasting you're more sensitive to that realm as well, and your true identity. And so when that happens, it's so much easier. But outside of that environment, you're going to work, and you have co-workers or an unruly boss or all kinds of stuff that's now entering into your eye gates and ear gates and whatever. It's easy to get sucked back in into that lower level of life, really. And so that's why I think taking every thought captive to the obedience of Christ actually goes along with the fasting aspect of it. So, thank you.

I thought it was awesome, because, you know, you guys are really touching on just the benefit and the importance, really, of taking thoughts captive and fasting. The question he was asking was, you know, had to do with how is that not striving? You know, because we're supposed to be at rest, so how are those things not striving? And so I think that comes down to what is being at rest, because a lot of us think of rest as, like, napping, you know. But really, in my opinion, like, being at rest is a position of your spirit and your soul of peace, right? Complete peace. It's a clean conscience. And from that place you can actually do a lot of work and get a lot done. Striving is when you don't have that place of peace and you're trying to find it through your work and through your efforts. So it's just flipping that paradigm. That's how you can do all those things and not be striving.

But if you don't have that peace, and your conscience is accused, and so you try to fast, and so you just attempt to wrangle all of your thoughts, you're striving, because you're using all of these things that we do in behavior modifications to try to create something that we already have in Christ. So that rest comes first, and then we can be busy all day. So, sorry.

Just real quick, and I love it. Oh my gosh, that was so good, because I just told somebody earlier, striving is not... a striving to enter His rest. Rest is not a verb, it's a noun. It's a place. You gather to get to a place, you get to get to a place. And what he was saying, just quickly, I think, you know, if you want to, like, jump through all the hoops really quickly: meditate. Meditate. And there are two types of meditation. You have the namaste, "thoughts go out," and then you have the Paul kind, "thoughts go in." That's the good stuff. That's, you know, that's the taking of the thoughts captive. Because if you're putting in all good stuff, "think on these things, meditate on these things, whatever is noble, whatever is good"... God is good, God is love, God is amazing, so am I. This is awesome. He's prosperous, I'm prosperous. You think on those things, boom, thoughts are captive. Okay.

I feel like my answers to these questions are embarrassingly elementary. For me, like, to agree with what Pastor Shanda said, it comes down to, like, it comes down to perspective for me, because it's not to get something. So for me, which is, like, so simple, it's doneness and oneness. Like, it's done, it's a finished work, and I'm one. Like, we are one. Like, I am equal with Him. We always say "as He is," you know. And so it's the perspective. Knowing... I always, like, mentally picture, like, the cross behind me. I know what was nailed there. Like, everything... I'm not every... like, it's a finished work, and point blank, God has the victory. Like, God has the victory. So it's just knowing it's done and knowing we're one. Yeah, that was really good. Together, that was seriously... that was really good.

So I would differentiate this thing about fasting. I would say there's an old creation, or old covenant, whatever you want to call it, old creation and new creation versions of fasting, right? In the old creation, we were engaging the power of sacrifice in order to accomplish something, right? If you work really hard, you sacrifice enough things, the energy and power of that sacrifice... And honestly, what I'm describing isn't really significantly different than witchcraft. It works exactly the same way, the old creation fasting. And yes, I'm sort of tangentially suggesting it's possible we engage in witchcraft-like things by trying to fast to earn things. Do with that what you will. But old creation fasting, you're engaging in the power of sacrifice to work really hard to earn something.

However, what is it... what our pastor teaches about this frequently enough, and he does a really good job explaining it: if you receive an inheritance, right, I receive an inheritance, who is it that has to die for me to receive an inheritance? That's a real question I'm asking. Do I have to die to receive an inheritance? Who dies? Somebody else. The person who's the testator, right? The person giving. I'm the... what's it called? I'm the beneficiary. Thank you. So I'm the recipient. Somebody else dies and I get it, right? So in fasting in the new creation, we've already received the inheritance. What we're doing is we're letting something be revealed in us.

So the difference is, most things in the New Testament, if you look throughout the teachings of Jesus, you'll find that many times things come in seed form. We've received the deposit of the Holy Spirit, guaranteeing what is to come. You receive a seed; eventually there's a full manifestation of the tree, right? You receive the data packet of everything that it will become; it just hasn't fully been revealed and manifested yet, right? So when we fast, if we fast from an Old Testament perspective, we're fasting to try and earn, strive, and create something through enough of our own human effort. From a new creation perspective, what we're doing is we're saying, "We know we have already received everything pertaining to life and godliness. So Lord, I'm going to engage You in this time, setting my focus on things that are above and not on earthly things during this time." And by doing these things, sacrificing stuff to keep my physical body and its needs... literally, intentionally pushing those down so that I can focus more on spiritual things, so that I can let this be revealed in me, that which has already been given.

Equality with God

I think we've got one more that we're gonna go, and everybody has to answer it, and then we're going to wrap up. If... do you... how long do you think it'll take? You want me to answer it? Okay. Text it. That's a great question, so I'll give you a short but accurate answer, okay? Satan's an angel; he's not a human, okay? So humans were freely given what angels desired, okay? So you're not gaining equality with God; you're recognizing it, okay? John 14 has the best language in the entire New Testament about this moment, okay? So John 14 says that "I'll send my Holy Spirit, and in that day you'll know," okay? He doesn't say "in that day it will happen." He said, "In that day you'll know that I'm in the Father, you're in me, and I'm in you." So the purpose of the Holy Spirit's ministry was to show union, right? So it's not that humanity ever had to endeavor to gain equality with God. They had it from before the foundation of the world.

I believe, and actually I think I stole this idea from my wife, that the psalmist that was quoted in Hebrews 2, "Who is man that you're mindful of, and why would you take a second look his way?" I believe that that was Satan's complaint. Yeah, I believe that that was Satan's complaint. But then it goes on to say that the reason he was ticked is because God put the entire handcrafted creation under the dominion of these idiots. Like, that, I mean, that was Satan's argument, you know? And then it said, but when he gave them dominion over all things, he left nothing excluded, and we don't see it yet. And this is what I love about that passage, and Michael teaches on this frequently: we don't see it yet, but we do see Jesus, right? So we can't live by 2,000 years of unrealized promise, but we do have one man that walks into everything that humanity was ever supposed to apprehend.

And you know, that whole thing about, like, laying divinity aside as Jesus, I think that's okay to a point, but I think what's more important is to realize that Jesus overcame hell, death, and the grave as a human being, you know? There's no... it's good, I'll answer it. There's only arrogance and pride in striving and trying. You cannot be arrogant and prideful of a free gift. I'll tell you a quick story. Our drummer is the dad of Cody Garbrandt. Do any of you know who Cody Garbrandt is? He's a middleweight UFC champ of the world. He's, like, he's just an unbelievable athlete, and he won the middleweight title. You didn't know that? Yeah, yeah. So what's... so when Cody won the fight, he beat Dom Cruz. When Cody won the fight, there's a young guy in our town that was battling leukemia, and, oh Jesus, Cody gave his belt to this boy, okay? He gave his belt to Maddox, okay?

So this is why there's no boasting. He told Dana White, the president of the UFC, that if he won this, that boy was going to keep the belt, and Dana said okay. So imagine somebody going into the ring for you, defeating the champion, handing you the belt, and then you have to wear it, okay? And when somebody asks you if you're the middleweight champion of the world, you have to say, "Yes." Yep. And you never threw a punch, yet there's a bloody, vanquished enemy lying on the floor of the ring that was put there on your behalf by a champion, okay? So there is no pride in grace. There is no pride in grace, which is why the entire first three books... three chapters of Romans is "Where is boasting?" Like, it's not there. If it's a free gift, you can't boast about it.

That's a great question. It's the fact... just, I'll do it quickly, just the fact that we're... because it almost hurts my feelings when I say we're equal, because I get it, I get it. But when you read Zephaniah 3:17, it says he rejoices around you, dancing and singing. If you look up "rejoices," it means to twirl violently. So he is, like, worshiping and twirling violently around you. It's like a... it's like a... it's a beautiful marriage. I'm not better than my husband, he's not better than me, but we love each other so much. But that's why we morph into one, and we are a husband and a wife, and it's just a perfect union.

Sentence. So with that, you know, Jesus came to fulfill the Law and the Prophets, and then it was to spill the blood of a better covenant, which we are in. So what Satan wanted, he tried trading for. We have been legally handed our identity in him, and that's binding. So we have everything he wanted. We have it. And that's what... God... he wanted to trade for what we have been freely given. Yeah, because Jesus died for that. Some... do we have five more minutes? One last question. Okay, here's the last question, and this is the one that was typed in: you have one minute

Closing Thoughts and Prayer

to tell us the most important thing in the world. Okay, and everybody has to answer, and it starts with Jackie and goes down the line. The most important thing in the world. Jesus. Okay, okay. So let me give you some details. So much pressure. You... like, I... when I train ministers and they're about to get up to preach, I say, imagine that you're desperately in love with them, and this is the only chance that you're gonna get to tell them something. It's clearly not... you're the pastor of this church, but if that were the position you were in, what would you say in 60 seconds? Do we have six seconds to think? I think... let's do it. Does anybody have theirs? Shanda? Okay, you have 60 seconds to think about it, starting now.

Immediately know who you are and whose you are. It started... the entire key to me is Eve. If she had just known who she truly was and didn't doubt, none of this would have happened. If you ever have to second-guess "Who am I?"... like I said, two questions every day, you will answer them. You will answer them every single day. Who... you know, "Did God say...?" Did he say that I was lovely and perfect and beautiful, or what did God say? Because that's him asking, "What did I say, kiddo? What did I say about you?" And if you recite that: "Well, you said I'm lovely, you said I'm beautiful, you said I'm perfect." Your identity is everything, because again, it's found in Christ, in Christ in you, that perfect union.

That was really good. So I think my mantra would probably just be: you're free. Like, I just really, really, really, really, really, really, really want people to know that they're free, because what he did made us free, and made our conscience free, and it made us free to live and move and have our being. And whom the Son sets free is free indeed. And it just absolutely wrecks me and breaks my heart when I see people go back into bondage over legalism or an addiction or anything, because you don't know the price that was paid to make you free and the system that was broken. And the freest people I see, whether in the church, normally outside of the church, they live with, you know, just abandon. And that's when your passions come out. That's when your dreams are alive. That's when you love deeply. That's when you live loud. That all comes from just a foundation of freedom. And that's when love... you know what true love is, from free will. That's why we were created the way we were. So our innate design is to be free and to love from that place.

Good. Well, that's going to be a lot better than when I... so to me this makes a lot more sense, but if the most important thing in one minute... if I... I would say that Jesus is alive and Jesus is the true Lord. I think that would be the quickest answer that I could come up with, because that to me changes everything. Him being alive is... yeah, it's the hope. It's the reality of where everything is heading. He's the beginning, he is the end, he's all in all. But also that he's Lord. And so then all of a sudden, instead of taking on... knowing that even the governments of this world are under his lordship, and there's something to that, that when we know that he's the

true King of all, and the way we serve him. So that's what I would say. Hello, I'm talking.

But... and I say that because, like, I look at all of these guys up here, and for me it's kind of intimidating because you all are powerhouses. But you all are powerhouses as well, and I am too. And I think that's my heart: every single person has an impartation, something that only you have. No one else in this room and no one else in this world... like, a billion people... have what you have that God has placed in you specifically for such a time as this. So that's my biggest thing. I hope that when you look in a mirror, you know that you're looking back at God. He's literally like, "Hey, that's me right there, and I'm giving you everything." Like, everything. So if anything, if you leave with that: you have a seat at the table, because you've been there since before the foundation of the earth.

That was really good. So for me, it's knowing I was never a Jew. Like, you know, it didn't partake... didn't pertain to me. So, well, Jesus didn't even need to die for me; he died as me. So, you know, we were co-killed, co-buried, and co-resurrected. So everything that I'm not, my distorted form, is laying dead in a grave. Yeah, I might take more than a minute. I've been thinking about... no, but I have been thinking about something like three and four questions ago, and I guess it ties into this. But my short answer is this entire thing is about relationship. Yeah, this entire thing is about relationship. So the question of, if it was defeated 2,000 years ago, why hasn't it been fully removed from our society now? And it's because of that.

And I just... back those questions ago, all I kept thinking about was, you know, the Father, the Son, and the Spirit have reconciled all of creation back to themselves. Why don't you please reconcile yourself back to the Father? Reconciliation requires a commitment to relationship. When Jesus came, they said, "How do we pray?" Jesus: "First of all, start off by calling him Father." And then whenever we get to his final discourse, he's like, "I no longer call you servants; I call you friends." Like, there has to be a commitment to relationship. So how about a group of us... how about a group of us commit to relationship with our Father, with our friends, and we go after this thing, so that our sons and daughters, like, see... like, they see it, and they can obtain it freely. I'm done.

So I'm primarily a teacher; therefore I had to write notes. So if we think about this, like, the one thing that I would say is it has to do with what the Godhead did in sacrificing himself. And I say that because, first of all, there's only one religion in all of the cosmos where the god of that religion became the sacrifice for his followers, right? We see, like, we've been taught that Jesus... that God the Father was angry, he sent his Son as the sacrifice on our behalf. And that's not what the Bible says, right? The Bible says the fullness of the Godhead took bodily form and dwelt among us. That means the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit collectively, as one, as one federal head, they collectively chose as the Godhead to dwell in bodily form and become man.

So it wasn't that the Father was sacrificing the Son; it was that the Godhead took bodily form and collectively sacrificed himself. Does that make sense? So God was in Christ. I mean, the whole Godhead was represented in Christ.

So when we see that the fullness of God took bodily form, they collectively chose to sacrifice himself for us, as us, to free us for all time and eternity from every bondage and barrier. Because greater love has... there is no greater love than this, than to lay your life down, right? So God stops at nothing to make us one with him. And again, he was the Lamb who was slain before the foundation of the world. So it doesn't matter if it was something in eternity, it doesn't matter if it was something in the spirit, it doesn't matter what realm, timeline, or dimension you're dealing with, it doesn't matter what the issue is: he was the Lamb who was slain before the moment of conception of time and space. The fullness of God sacrificed himself on our behalf to make us free and to remove every barrier from oneness with him, because he loves us. It's all about love.

So I'll give you 30 seconds of theology and 30 seconds of my response. The church has focused on distinction for so long, "we're apart from him and we need to worship him," that we're moving into this revelation of union and oneness. The reality of the mystery is how something can be distinct yet in union at the same time, okay? It's a 301, not a 103. And what I would tell you is that if you move too far into oneness and you lose distinction, you'll lose relationship, you'll lose romance. If you lose romance, immortality loses its wheels, because if you don't believe that you're worthy of love, you will not believe that you're worthy of life. And you can only believe that you're worthy of love if it's something other than yourself showing it to you. So the mystery is that the two are distinct. You are, like Olivia said, you're a unique expression of Christ, but you're also fully in union with him. And if you don't believe in this divine romance

Part 5

The Priesthood and Covenant

And I want to say a few things, because I'm not permitted to preach on them tonight. Not because of your pastors, because of Jesus. But I just want to give you a few things to encourage you that aren't part of my sermon, and then we'll get into the Word. But do you realize that something significant happened when John the Baptist baptized Jesus? It was one of the most significant moments of all covenant transition. John the Baptist was the son of Zechariah and Elizabeth, and he was six months older than Jesus. Okay? So Jesus completely submitted to the rules of the temple, so He did not begin His ministry until He was 30, because that's how old you have to be to be a rabbi. Okay? So Jesus turns 30, and then He goes to John the Baptist. Now, there's a bunch I could teach you about this, but I just want to make my point.

Jesus's baptism is so unbelievably misunderstood. People think that Jesus was baptized because He was a good Jew, and if you're a good Jew, you get baptized. How many of you know Jews don't get baptized? John the Baptist's baptism was a Messiah test. That's all it was. Did you know that the prophet told John the Baptist, "Go dunk people in water, and the one on whom you see the dove alighting, that's the guy"? I mean, that's it. Like, "Not you, not you, not you." Like, that's what John the Baptist was doing. So in reality, everybody that was lined up there to participate in John's baptism thought they were Messiah. He was that normal of a human. Get it? You're gonna have to. So John the Baptist, the son of Zechariah and Elizabeth, means that he is six months older than Jesus. That means he's been in the priesthood a whole six months.

Jesus comes to him and He says, "You have to baptize Me to fulfill all righteousness." Okay, thank you. So John the Baptist baptizes a man who was not born of Levitical lineage. He was born according to the tribe of Judah. So he proceeds with a cleansing process from the Book of Leviticus of a new priest. Now imagine this: imagine Pastor Sung ordains a new pastor, and the new pastor, after six months of being ordained, turns the entire church over to a new guy. How do you think John the Baptist was received by his religious counterparts? John the Baptist, imagine the humility. He has disciples with him. John the Baptist has disciples. Jesus steps on the scene, he goes, "Bros, I'm done. Follow that guy. I must decrease that He may increase." Okay, I'm getting ahead of myself. This is one of the coolest moments in Scripture.

It's actually prophetically foretold in Joshua, when the Israelites are about to cross into the promise. He says, "When you see the priest standing in the river with the ark, it's time to cross over." Yep. So there was this transitional time where the Levitical priesthood was brought to a

close, and there was a new priest ordained according to the order of Melchizedek. Okay? The old priests officiated at the altar of the old covenant. That means they offered sacrifices on behalf of humans according to the Levitical law. Now, in the new priesthood according to Melchizedek, there is no priesthood family. Every human being was brought into that priesthood. Okay? So that means all of us are a royal priesthood, where super cool was saying we're the bride. We're fine with receiving the romance that a bride should receive. We're fine with being sons and receiving an inheritance, right? We're cool with union and being one with God.

But do you know what the responsibility of the priesthood according to Melchizedek is? To appropriate the finished work of Jesus to creation. Maybe we will go here, I don't know. This is kind of good so far, isn't it? So if the responsibility of humanity is the redemption of creation, then your office as a priest means that the verdict that you pass regarding creation stands. Yep. The one thing that Jesus mentioned when He said, "As I've been sent, so I send you," was the appropriation of the finished work. He said, "As I've been sent, so I send you. Anyone's sins that you retain, I retain." Isn't that terrifying? "And anyone's sins that you forgive, I forgive." That was literally labeled the apostolic commission in your Bible. Okay? So what's that mean? You cannot hold creation in accusation, or you'll kill it. This was just supposed to be a little thing that I said before I started preaching, but we're going there, man. We have to go there.

Okay, so the new creation community has to lead the rest of the body of Christ into freedom, and you can't do that if you're still accusing it. Okay? There's denominations that are completely, completely enamored with physical things, right? How you dress, the music you listen to, your gender, right? And then they judge one another based on natural things. And then if you're fortunate enough to crawl your way out of that type of church, you step into a charismatic church, right? Then we over-spiritualize our judgment with prayer requests. Yep. "Is it true, Sister So-and-so with Brother So-and-so? Maybe we should pray for them," right? That's the cherry on top of your gossip to make it holier, right? So here's the deal. Okay, we're in an appointed time where the new

The Three Levels of Church

creation church is going to either inspire or empty every other church in the world. Okay? It's going to inspire or empty every church in the world. It's up to you. Okay, I don't know where this is coming from. Okay, so most of us have come out of the... Chris Blackaby's terminology, because he said I'm allowed second heaven, 60-fold churches, right? They are spiritual gifts oriented. You can step in and step out. The way Chris defines it is they live on earth out of Heaven's supply, right? And then there's a little bit of elitism associated with these churches, because they're no longer these churches, right? "We got out of legalism, now we're into the

charismatic church." That means we're not enamored with physical things; now we're enamored with soul things, right? These people think they're better than these people. These people think these people are heretics.

Now, there's something really unique about the 100-fold church. Everybody's a member, and only if you're aware that you're a member of the 100-fold church can you see the rest of the members of the 100-fold church. The Bible says you have not come to a mountain that can be touched with hands, but you have come to Mount Zion, the city of the living God, to an innumerable company of angels, to Christ the firstborn, to the spirits of just men made perfect. The whole of humanity exists in the 100-fold church. Do you like that, Bishop? Yeah. The only way that we are going to inspire... this sounds like such an elitist message. Okay, the only way that we can fix the rest of those bozos is, no, is if you completely relinquish accusation. Yep.

Do you know what the very manifestation of unjustification is? "Thank God I'm not like those guys." Twice. Twice Jesus said two guys went down to the temple to pray, and the one that said, "Thank God I'm not like those guys," did not leave justified. Is it good? Okay, so if we actually intend to redeem creation, then we can no longer allow agreement, denominational lines, philosophies, theologies, things like that, to determine who we see and how we see them. Is it good? The redemption of creation is fully dependent on the manifestation of sons of God. Okay? Fully dependent. Nothing will happen to creation until sons manifest. And if we as the new creation community stay in our little tiny weird groups and say, "Thank God we're not like those guys," we cannot enter the promise alone.

Joshua, right? There's some language in the Book of Joshua where God speaks to Joshua, and He said, "Every place that the sole of your foot will tread, I have given you," right? Okay, this is really important that you see. "Every place that the sole of your foot shall tread, I have given you." Who was He talking to? Joshua. Joshua only. Okay? Nobody else. And He said, "And the land that I have given you, I am giving them." Okay? So there was a finished work on Joshua's behalf that was being appropriated by the Israelites. There was a victory that had been apprehended by a vicarious victor that was being fully expressed in an entire community of people. Okay? We see what happens when somebody wants to cross over by themselves. Caleb and Joshua were ready to jump into the promise. They had some bad spies, and God said, "Back out. One mind, one accord. Try again." Get it? What if the avenue to transformation in the body wasn't education, but it was forgiveness? Is it good? Go to John 20. Let me show you something.

Entering the Promised Land

John chapter 20. Thank you. Are you guys okay with, like, I know you know Chris Blackaby, right? So every time I ask if I can steal a Chris Blackaby sermon, Chris says, "If you believe it, it's yours. Don't give me credit," which is why I always give him credit, because he has such an incredible heart. But the natural, the thirty-fold church, they desire something. They desire a rapture, right? They're very body oriented. They want to get out of here. Yep. They want to abandon mission so they can go to heaven. What was that? Yeah, that was Chris Blackaby. Mention his name. The 60-fold church wants something else. They want revival, right? The hundredfold church wants to reign. Yep. But the 100-fold church can't reign by themselves. We can see the promise, but the promise needs appropriated to the body.

And here's the wild thing about being a priest: you can take people camping that don't want to go. Three million Israelites were led out of bondage into freedom screaming, kicking, and crying, because one mediator determined that it was time for them to be free. Thank you. Tell them. Hesitate a little bit. Let's go to John 20. I'm not scared, I'm just waiting. Where do we want to start? At verse 1. Now let's go to verse 6. "Simon Peter came following him, and went into the tomb; and there they saw the linen clothes lying there, and the handkerchief that had been around His head was not lying with the linen clothes, but it was folded together in a place by itself." One of the most pure, tactful, prophetic pictures of God's plan for creation that you and I can find in Scripture. Michael's like, "Why?" Because the head has been revealed. Creation has been given a neck-deep victory. Get it?

Hebrews chapter 2. One of the questions that we immortality guys get all the time: "Prove it. Who lived forever?" Jesus, right? I'm not trying to be dismissive, but I am trying to be snarky this time. Yep. So your Bible in Hebrews chapter 2 says that God placed His entire handcrafted creation in the hands of men, that when He put all of creation under their charge, He left nothing that was exempt. And then Paul says, but we don't see it yet, right? But we do see Jesus. We see that the head has been revealed. We see that somebody has apprehended a victory on our behalf, right? And everything that He has given Him, He is giving us, just like Joshua and the Israelites. But there was a collective conscience that it took to enter the promise, and it was through an intentional act of will of humanity. Okay? Grace will get you out of bondage; maturity will get you into the promise.

Forgiveness and Conscience

Yep. Let me show you why. Israelites, kicking and screaming on their way out of Egypt, they get to a body of water, and what happens? Okay, "I said don't worry about it. I got it handled. Be still and know that I am God," right? That is God's instruction to the immature. "I'll kill them. I'll make the water go away. Just walk," right? Grace got them out of bondage. But then they get to the next river, the river that separated them from their promise, and they're like,

"Okay, God, do it again." He's like, "Nope, your turn." He's like, "But we don't have any food." He's like, "Plant a garden." "Our clothes are wearing out." "Make some." There's an intentional act of will in bringing your soul into alignment with truth, and you decided what was appropriated on my behalf through my Savior is now my portion, right?

So when they get to the Jordan River, as opposed to the Red Sea, what happens? They get there and they're ready to cross over, but they have to do something first. Adult men had to circumcise themselves, right? No fun. How many of you ever heard of Lynn Hiles? Lynn Hiles is, I can't remember, the guy's Joseph Prince's spiritual father, and he's from West Virginia, and he is the coolest dude you'll ever meet. You need to have him out here. He can put Jesus in the Old Testament like nobody I've ever seen. He sees Jesus in the bread, he sees Jesus in the wheel, he sees Jesus in the prophet. He's unbelievable. But he said, "Next time that somebody tells you that you're still under a law, have an altar call for circumcision. See how quickly they change their minds," right?

But here's the point. Okay, so these guys are about to go into the promise, and Joshua stops them all. He's like, "Okay, circumcision time. You get three days to rest, then we're going in." And he said, when you get circumcised, "Today the Lord has rolled away the reproach of Egypt." Come on! He took away the sin of humanity before they stepped into the promise. Everything they were never meant to be was taken away through a prophetic act of circumcision. Get me? And then they get to the next river, and they're about to walk in, and they're like, "Okay, do it again, God." And He's like, "No, get in the water. It's different," right? God's not babying them. He'll baby you out of your bondage, but He will lead you into your promise. Is it good? Yeah. All right, so they get to the river called Jordan, and they're like, "Oh, nothing?" "Nope, you gotta step in. When you step in, then the water will move."

Do you know what happened? They stepped into the Jordan River, the water dried up. The water dried up all the way back to a city. Anybody know what the city was called? Like, that's good stuff. That's good stuff, right? They had to make the conscious decision to bring their soul into alignment with their spirit, and then everything that Adam ever wrought became history, right? And then, instead of two forerunners stepping into a promise by themselves and then saying, "Thank God we're not like those guys," these dudes decided to go back into the wilderness with these folks for 40. Are you willing? They went back into the wilderness with the multitudes, with the next generation, for 40 more years. And then, before they went in, they said, "We've got a question for y'all. Are you all going to follow the Lord?" Coolest altar call ever. How many of you have ever seen a preacher make an altar call and then try to talk everybody out of it?

Like, "We will." "He's not going to... I think you get it?" "No." "Every idol gone, all of your history, old baggage. Can't do it. Now who's going to follow the Lord?" "We will." He's like, "I still don't think you get it. We're gonna have to go in there and possess a promise that's guarded by 31 hostile empires full of giants. Now who's going to follow the Lord?" "We will." "Okay, I believe you now." And the entire community possessed the promise simultaneously. Forerunners have to find mercy. Forerunners have to find mercy as priests for the people that don't see them as the 100-fold church yet. Good? The Bible says, "Anyone's sins that you retain, I retain. Anyone's sins that you forgive, I forgive." There's a perfect biblical example to explain this.

How many of you have ever had a really tough time reconciling what happened to Ananias and Sapphira? Yeah. Holy Spirit kills people. Peter has a temper, right? Already cutting off Malchus's ear, made lots of mistakes, and I don't know, maybe the church was out of money or whatever. Do you realize what Ananias and Sapphira did? They were still wildly generous. They sold a property, and then they had committed to giving the entire amount to the church, and then they just lied about what they sold the property for, so they keep some of it for themselves. And what Peter said is like, "You could have sold that property and did whatever you wanted with the money." Like, there was no 10% requirement. You could have did whatever you wanted. "Was the property yours?" He said, "Yeah." "Was the money yours after you sold the property?" "Yeah." "Then it was yours to do what you wanted." Yep. "So why'd you say you're gonna give it all to the church?" "I wanted to look good," right?

"We thought religion might put us in the right light." So, because religion doesn't justify anyone, we had to lie. Yep. Religion gives you two things: defeat if you're honest, and pride if you're a liar, right? So he said, "Okay, so why did you say that you sold the land for such and such price?" And then he said, "The Holy Spirit is coming to kill you," and he died. Right then he asked Ananias, or excuse me, Sapphira, "Is it true that you sold the land for such and such price?" And she said yes. So she and the husband had clearly conspired to tell the same lie, right? Right. "Is it true that you sold the land for such and such price?" "You bet." He said, "Do you hear the guys' footsteps coming right now? They just buried your husband. They're burying you next." Done. Terrifying, right?

I've actually heard preachers, modern preachers, say that God is restoring Holy Spirit murders to the body. "God is restoring Holy Spirit murders to the body so that we would come back into reverence." I won't say who it was. I know I'll get in trouble. But my question for you is, what do you think is more of an offense towards the local church: stealing from the offering, or murdering the pastor? "Equal." Oh my God, son, I don't know if your offering is really valuable or you're just not... I know the heart behind your answer is that all sin is equal. I know

exactly what you meant, but it's good. Okay, so let's pretend we're not being theological about it. What would you be more upset about? Somebody murdered your pastor, right?

So we get this other moment where Stephen, who is actually the apostolic father of the Jerusalem church, preaches the gospel, gets him in trouble, and then he is unwilling and immovable to come off this revelation of grace and goodness. So they're like, "Just kill him." The senior leader of the Jerusalem church is murdered, and while he's being murdered, there's a guy named Paul, that is, excuse me, Saul, that is consenting to his death, literally saying, "Kill him." And while he's actively being murdered, he pleads for the forgiveness of his murderers, right? And while he's pleading for the forgiveness of his murderers, he sees Jesus standing in heaven, right? Ridiculous. Do you think Peter saw Jesus standing in heaven while he was death-sentencing Ananias and Sapphira? I don't think so. Sometimes being like your Father in heaven is a conscious act of will. Matthew says if you do these things, you'll be like your Father in heaven, right? If you do these things, you'd be like your Father in heaven.

So what we see is the priesthood in action. "Whoever's sins you retain, I retain. Whoever's sins you forgive, I forgive." So we see Stephen, who is like his Father in heaven, actively forgiving his murderers, and he opens the door. Not only does he require Heaven's assistance, or does he allow Heaven's assistance... Could you imagine Saul walking down the road to Damascus, being like, "My God, what is wrong with that guy?" He has the death of Stephen in his rearview mirror, while the person he's consenting to their murder is literally begging the Father for their forgiveness. What's going on in the conscience of that man while he's off to take more prisoners captive? Stephen begged, begged for the life of his religious persecutor, and in the very next chapter, Saul becomes Paul and the most significant apostolic voice of the New Testament.

Sixty-fold churches are going to be emptied or inspired. It's up to you. Good? Peter refused. I would love to... So Peter refused to extend forgiveness to Ananias and Sapphira, and because of his office of priesthood, their sins were retained. Yep. I heard Bill Johnson years ago. He said, in the United States, does anybody know what state has the worst weather and is in the most danger? California. Does anybody know which state the church decides to judge the most? California. So what if California's destiny is in the hands of the church? Yep. Conscience matters. To the pure, all things are pure.

Governance and Identity

So, asked that I give a demonstration of the 30-, 60-, and 100-fold church. What we communicate to our school, a lot of our teaching is founded on this principle: "In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth," right? So very clear, heaven has a plurality to it. Paul,

in his preaching, said that he knows a man, he didn't know if he was in the body or out of the body, but he knows that he visited the third heaven, and that third heaven was such a mystical place that he can't even talk about what he saw, right? If there's a third heaven, it would stand to reason there's a second and there's a first. First heaven are things that are seen and created, like this, like my body. Second heaven are things that are unseen but created. That would be the angelic, the demonic, the soulish realm. The third heaven is God in heaven. Actually, let me put it better: the third heaven is heaven in God. Okay? Because God does not live in the Kingdom; the Kingdom lives in God.

Okay, so there is a mechanism of your humanity that occupies each realm. Your spirit is one spirit with the Lord, right? Your spirit is unseen and uncreated. It's really important to know. Your soul occupies the second heaven. Can I ruin something for you? Okay, spiritual warfare is not necessary. Spiritual warfare is second heaven business. The Bible says that he who has been born of God does not sin, and the evil one can't touch him. Okay? So if you can be drawn onto his turf, then you will engage in his games. But if you stay here, he's not even permitted. Yep. So you just govern. You don't have to fight; you just govern. This is actually how transfiguration takes place. Okay? And in the first heaven you have this thing called a body. Not your flesh, that's a nature; your body, right? And in your body you have a point of contact with earth, which is why your body is the most important piece of technology in all of creation. God cannot do what you can do. You all right with that? Yep.

The only species that He permitted to have dominion on earth was a human being. If you lose your body, you lose your destiny. That's why immortality is wildly important. Your third heaven identity is the Lord from heaven. Your second heaven identity is your soul's identity, which is who you believe you are. Okay? Your first heaven identity is what creation encounters when it experiences you. Okay? The process of transfiguration is an active choice of will to be governed by spirit that gives life to your mortal body, right? Will is a soul thing; action is a body thing. And the Bible says that you should be preserved body, soul, and spirit. That wasn't me. Okay, so check this out. Have you ever, like, heard those really catchy things, like, "It's Christ in you both to will and to do His good pleasure"? Okay, that's governance. That's governance. Christ in you both to will, which is soul business, and to do His good pleasure, which is body business. Yep.

The manifestation of sons of God is when what God says about you and what creation experiences when it encounters you are both the same thing. Yep. A positional son of God cannot redeem creation, because creation is redeemed through a physical body. So the manifestation of the sons of God is the intention of the gospel, right? Let me read you three things real quick. Matthew 17:2, you don't have to turn here, I just want to show you this: "And

He was transfigured before them. His face shone like the sun, and His clothes became as white as the light." Okay, this isn't... oh. Ready? It's right here. I can go with a handheld, it's okay. Check. What? I do that stuff, not even aware. It's like everybody leaves the room and I'm alone, and then my wife goes, "Sorry." I... Bible. Ready? "And He was transfigured before them." Okay?

Was transfiguration spiritual business? Yeah. Was it visible business? It absolutely was. The transfiguration of Jesus was when humanity was able to perceive His divinity in His body. Humanity was able to perceive His divinity in His body. There was a visible transformation to His humanity. Do you know what's funny about transfiguration? Glad you asked. Transfiguration is what enabled Jesus to interact with death as someone who has dominion over it. Transfiguration was the moment that Jesus became divinity on earth, not His resurrection. Tell me more. You do not have to die to be divine. You don't even have to overcome death to be divine. Your spirit gives life to your mortal body, not life to your death. From the moment of the transfiguration, Jesus had victory and ability to overcome death, from that moment, because divinity was now housed in humanity. So He did not die as a victim and then be like, "I gotta get out of here." Absolutely not. He was transfigured, and He was able to interact with death as someone who has dominion over it.

You know what that means? How many have kids? How many have kids that are afraid of the dark? Anybody? Okay, what do you do? You go in the room, you shut the light off, turn it back on: "See? Nothing to worry about." The Bible says that humanity was held in bondage to the fear of death all their life. All fear is rooted in the fear of death. So Jesus went in, He shut the light off: "See? Nothing to worry about." Is it good? Matthew 9:2, excuse me, Mark 9:2, same verse, just giving you some more substance: "Now after six days Jesus took Peter, James, and John, and led them up on a high mountain apart by themselves; and He was transfigured before them," right? Ready for this? Romans 12:2.

The Process of Transfiguration

"Don't be conformed to this world." Okay, this is a teaching of governance. Say "governance." Okay. "Don't be conformed to this world, but be," it says, "transformed." It's a bad translation. Metamorphoō, higher form: same exact Greek word that it used in Matthew and Mark to describe what happened to Jesus when He displayed divinity in His human body, right? So the effect of renewing your mind is not transformation. Transformation gives the impression that you're taking something that was inherently bad and making it better. Transfiguration is when you turn humanity into divinity, which is way better. How does that happen? It says, "but be transfigured by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God." That was better than your reaction, Jackie. Nice job. Okay, get it?

Okay, why'd we start talking about this? Some 30, 60, 100. Okay, perfect.

Okay, so transfiguration is the hope of the world. Transfiguration is the avenue to manifestation, and manifestation comes through the renewing of your mind. It's not that you just change your thoughts; it's that you realize that your mind was taken from you. Carnal mind: emptied, gone, done, dead. And now you have the mind of Christ. Your Bible is so scandalous when it talks about the mind that you actually possess. Again, one of those possessive genitive moments. The Bible says, "Eye has not seen, nor ear heard, nor has entered into the heart of man those things that have been prepared for those who love Him." And then we write a song about how mysterious God is, and how His ways are higher than our ways, and He's ever increasing and ununderstandable, and He's off in the distance and He's unconcerned. But the next line says, "But He has revealed them to us through His Spirit." Yeah.

And then it says this. He quotes a prophet and he says, "Who has the mind of the Lord, that he can tell Him what to do?" It's literally what it says. Then he says, "You do. We have the mind of Christ." We don't have a mind that He fashioned and gave to us. We have... out of His, into yours, right? So it's not about fixing something that's broken; it's about making something that's fallen divine. Good. Wow. Transfiguration is the hope of humanity. Ready for this? Go to 2 Corinthians chapter 3. Speaking of transfigured, oh, hahaha. You ever seen, oh man, what's this, the cartoon's name? Roger Rabbit. Yeah, the way he reacts to Jessica Rabbit, that's our house every day. That's our house every day. This poor woman. Nothing. Just... what did I tell you to go to? I forget. 2 Corinthians 3. Okay, we're going to talk about that and then we're going to minister. Okay, 2 Corinthians 3. Oh man, let's go. Let's go to verse 7.

Okay, so let me show you something real quick. Do you realize what happened to Stephen when he chose to be like his Father in heaven? Divinity showed up in his body. Do you remember that? If you're looking for the word "transfigured," it's not there, but the action of it was there. They said they looked at him, and what'd they see? The face of an angel. Yep. The mark of your Father's heart is that you would bless those who curse you, and that you would pray for those who spitefully use and persecute you. Paul's heart was that he would gladly... listen, his name... I must pick this up for a Bible again. It's close. That he would gladly have his name removed from the Book of Life so that his own countrymen... does anybody know? His own countrymen are Jews, the people that reviled and persecuted his own movement, the people that reviled and persecuted his own movement, that they might be saved. It's good, right? Okay, so there's four places in the New Testament where the word "transfigured" is used: twice when it described what happened to Jesus, once in Romans chapter 12, verse 2, when it talks about what happens when you renew your mind. Here's the third: 2 Corinthians chapter 3, verse 7.

Glory and the New Covenant

No, don't go there. Go there. Good place. "If the ministry of death, written and engraved on stones, was glorious, so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the face of Moses because of the glory of his countenance, which glory was passing away..." which we taught on this morning, so I won't do it again tonight because your time is valuable. Go listen to it later. "...how will the ministry of the Spirit not be more glorious? For if the ministry of condemnation had glory, the ministry of righteousness exceeds much more in glory. For even what was made glorious had no glory in this respect, because of the glory that excels. For if what is passing away was glorious, what remains is much more glorious. Therefore, since we have such hope, we use great boldness of speech, unlike Moses, who put a veil over his face so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the end of what was passing away."

Let me mention this. I mentioned it this morning, but it's worth talking about, okay? The Greek word for glory is doxa. It means "thoughts and opinions of." It doesn't carry any nature with itself; it carries the nature of the subject that it's referencing, okay? So the nature of the subject that it's referencing is the law. I'm going to stand here while my wife takes my picture. Yep. The thoughts and the opinions that it's referencing... the subject that it's referencing is the law. So Moses's face was shining with the glory of the law, which your Bible just referred to as death and condemnation. So you can understand why nobody would want to approach this guy when he came down the mountain, because he was wearing disapproval and death. Yep. So he had to wear a veil over his face because this covenant sucked. That's why. It wasn't because he saw God's... we're not gonna go there again tonight. You got it, Craig? It's because he was wearing disapproval and death, right?

So Jesus gets transfigured on the mountain, and in His transfiguration He's literally wearing "This is My beloved Son. Hear Him." Then He gets transfigured, and now the shine that He carries is attracting people from cities around, because you will reflect the God that you know. That's why your religion isn't working. People will run from you when they see what covenant you're in. Good. "Unlike Moses, who put a veil over his face so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the end of what was passing away. Their minds were blinded. For until this day the same veil remains unlifted in the reading of the Old Testament, because the veil is taken away in Christ." Yep. "But even to this day, when Moses is read, a veil lies on the heart. Nevertheless, when one turns to the Lord, the veil is taken away. Now the Lord is the Spirit; and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty. But we all, with unveiled face, beholding as in a mirror the glory of the Lord, are being transfigured..." Oh, metamorphoō. "...we are being transfigured into the same image from glory to glory, just as by the Spirit of the Lord."

Now let me fix some bad doctrine, all right? How many of you ever looked at "glory to glory" like it's a spiritual graduation, right? What drives me nuts is when people put a third, fourth, and fifth glory in there, right? "I'm just being transferred from glory to glory to glory to glory." There's only two. There's only two. There's the glory of death and condemnation; there's the glory of Spirit and life. When you come out of death and condemnation, you get transfigured into the same image as the Lord, like you're looking in a mirror. I guess I didn't break my watch. It's my favorite watch. Good.

John chapter 20. We'll go back to where we started. The head is unveiled. When the prophets foretold of the Messiah, they said, "Unto you a child is born, and unto you a Son is given, and the government is on," not His head, "on His shoulders." Yep. And He's waiting for it to be under His feet. The victory that He has given Him, He is giving you. Good. I think it's good. I think if I start something else, we're going to go all night. Transfiguration is the hope of the world, right? You, as a life-giving spirit, have to actively forgive your persecutors. By actively forgiving your persecutors, you get transformed into the same image. Stephen's transfiguration came because he made a decision to be like his Father in heaven. Peter didn't glow after Ananias and Sapphira died. The wrath of man will never bring about the righteousness of God. Amen. Okay, so one of the things that I'm really bad

Part 6

The Nature of the Church

I want to share a few things with you regarding the local church this morning. Is that okay? And I want to share some things transparently before we get theological, and I want to kind of just emphasize what you guys have in your backyard. We live in a county with 93,000 people and 226 churches, okay? That's a lot. You would think, because we have, like, you know, 25 bars, that there would be more people in churches, but that's not the way it works. Very infrequently do people become part of a local assembly and not get hurt by it, right? It takes a very specific type of leadership to create a culture that surrounds itself as a family rather than an organization.

And Shanda and I are blessed to know the best New Creation teachers in the world, and they are dear and best friends. And those people see hundreds or thousands of pastors in their lifetime, and of all of the people that those people could tell us we need to connect with, everybody that comes through our house, everybody that speaks in our church says, "You have to connect with Sam and Jackie Hunt." They have made such an impact and impression internationally that their apostolic voice has been heard round the world. And sometimes when you can drive 10 miles and pop in here, you really don't realize how fortunate you are to be part of a local assembly like this.

I sent my associate pastor, Aaron, a video the other day, and it was just this guy talking casually, and it was kind of strange because I was convicted, because he was addressing, when somebody asks, "How many people are in your church?" what's the answer that every pastor gives? "Well, when we all show up..." Yep. So I literally said that to somebody the day before I saw this video: "When we all show up, it's this many." Then somebody sent me a video, and I'll tell you what the video said in a minute. A week later, I get picked up at the airport by Pastor Sung. Somebody asked, "So how big is your church?" And he says, "Well, when we all show up..." Yep, yep.

So in this video, this pastor said, "So I started telling my church, I'm not your drug dealer. God has placed me in this place as an apostolic father, and families don't gather around need." You can't pop in on a Sunday when you just need your fix. Families show up. It's a big deal, right? The church became consumer-driven. I don't know when, but if you live by the sword, you die by the sword. You know, the responsibility of the church is to produce sons of God, the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ. They're not required to be a charitable organization. They produce sons for the work of ministry. Yep. And when you approach the

church as an organization that's supposed to meet your needs, you will always be disappointed by it, because that's not what it's for. Yep. It's supposed to confront you. It's supposed to challenge you. It's supposed to change you. It's supposed to give you accountability. Sometimes people call accountability church, right?

Do you guys have a father and a mother here? We've watched them. Like, if I start talking about it, I'm going to fall apart. Like, these guys have five beautiful children, they have a thriving real estate business, they have a thriving local church, they have treated us like kings since the moment we stepped off the plane, and the life that they live just leaves us all struck, because they have smiles on their face, they have energy just blowing from their body, and they're a rare breed that we don't run into very often, if ever. I think this is the most impressive thing we've ever seen. So I mean it, brother: the world needs to know that you're here. The world needs to know that you're here.

And I encourage you, and this isn't supposed to be a correction or a rebuke, but family shows up. Family shows up. You gather around covenant. The fact that you're registered in heaven together is why you belong together. You have a passion for a city, a passion for a metron, and as a family you take full responsibility for the area that you're responsible for, and you show up. Amen. Unbelievable. I can't even begin to tell you about this trip. It's been the best thing that's ever happened to us. We've received a hundredfold more than we've ever considered pouring out. It's been amazing.

You guys want to get into the word? Okay, let's do it. Can I pray for you? Can I ask how much time I have? Now till noon? Easy. Okay, we can do that. Father, thank you so much for this incredible morning. We ask that you bless this word, that you send ministering angels to be here, to move to and fro, to deliver, to set free, to make safe and sound. We declare this place an open heaven, and we ask that you do what only you can do. In Jesus' name. Everybody said, "Amen." Okay, so I want to talk to you about

Understanding God's Glory

the glory of God. The glory of God is something that can be articulately defined, and it's been kind of a mystery in the body of Christ, right? Sometimes we call, like, fuzzy clouds the glory of God, or feel the manifest presence of God. The glory of God, in reality, is none of those things. Those are encounters. Again, sometimes we just have to be really strict regarding the terminology that we use, because God was pursued by Moses, and he asked the question, "Would you please show me your glory?" Right? So if you ask God what glory is and he answers you, you need to probably accustom yourself to his definition. Yep. So if you understand what God's glory is, then you'll realize that the whole earth will be filled with his

glory, and that is not very impressive when it's just a sparkly cloud. Yep. The intention of the gospel, the redemption of creation, is that the whole earth would be filled with his glory.

There was a man that asked God to see his glory, and something spectacular happened. And I'm going to tell you that this is prophetic revelation. I might get in trouble for this doctrine, but I don't think you can argue it either, so let's go there, okay? Exodus describes the relationship that God had with Moses. And contrary to our Western traditional belief, the Bible says that God can't look upon sin. If he looks upon you, what's that mean? Come on. Yep. So we think because God can't look upon sin, he can't look upon us, because we've defined ourselves as distorted. But God says, "I can't look upon sin," and he's staring at you. "I can't look upon sin," and he's staring at you.

So, okay, so Moses has this relationship where it says that he met with God and talked to him face to face, as a man talks to his friend, right? So do you think that any attribute or characteristic of God was hidden from Moses's sight? They spoke like friends speak. And after those types of encounters, Moses still said, "God, will you please show me your glory?" Okay, this is deep. You have to follow me. So he hides him in a rock. Okay, for you prophetically minded people, where do you suppose that Moses got stuck? In the Son. Yep. John 1: "In the beginning was the Word, the Word was with God, and the Word was God," and nothing was made without him, right?

So God takes Moses, he puts him in the pattern, and he puts him in the pattern and allows him to see his hinder parts, which, if you define the word in the Hebrew, means times past. I'm getting goosebumps like crazy. So this is what happens: "God, show me your glory." "Okay, then I'm going to put you in my Son, and I'm gonna let you watch me reach into him and throw creation into existence." "Show me your glory." "Well, here it is: in the beginning, God created." God's glory is his intention manifest. God's glory is Jesus become flesh. God's glory is you. It's there. "I'll put you in a rock." 1 Corinthians chapter 10 says that rock, it's Christ. God is human-affirming. We better be also. The local church is responsible to affirm humanity in his sight.

Okay, 2 Corinthians chapter 5 gives you the ministry of reconciliation. Yep. I'm going to read it to you, but do you know, like, the pinnacle of that passage is that God was in Christ reconciling the world to himself, not imputing their trespasses to them? Yeah. He gave you the ministry to affirm humanity. He was so intentional about revealing his feelings towards human beings that he gave Moses a prophetic image of his glory. His glory is his creation, the capstone of his glorious humanity. If the intention, the end game of the gospel, is that all humans would become the manifestation of the Godhead, or the measure of the stature of the fullness of God, then the whole earth being filled with his glory is much less about the giant

worship service and way more about you understanding who you are. Yes, that's right. Yeah. Good. Okay, let me give you some local church understanding. So the local church is the hope of the world.

The Local Church Mission

Okay, I didn't say church; I said local church. The way that the redemption of creation was established was God appointed apostolic fathers over regions, and in those regions they had to take responsibility. Paul called it a sphere. In English, in Greek it's a metron. That means that Lacey is your responsibility to turn into heaven. You have to take full responsibility for the things that you're naturally in charge of, and evict anything that is illegal in heaven, and bring in the culture, the family, the nature of Christ, the family of heaven, and the culture of heaven. That's your responsibility.

Okay, now let me tell you something. How many of you have read the book of Romans? Arguably the most significant New Testament letter, right? The most succinct explanation of God's intention for creation, the most articulate delivery of covenant theology. At the end of the letter, at the end of the livestream, at the end of the online course, at the end of the book, Paul says, "But I need to come to Rome so I can give you an impartation and bear fruit among you." Impartation and fruit doesn't happen if you don't show up. Paul wrote the book that changed our lives and said it won't do anything unless you get a relation-based impartation from somebody that you love. Isn't that good?

Go to 2 Corinthians chapter 5. I want to read that. While you're turning there, I'll give you a little background on the local church and why it's established. Okay, so Jesus came in at a point of time. The appointed time was when Rome had established a military system, and Jesus stole all of Rome's terminology to be able to explain how heaven would take over earth. The term ekklēsia was not a Christian term. As a matter of fact, we baptized the word church and we made it something religious. The Greek term ekklēsia meant governing assembly. It was more like a courthouse than a sanctuary. They governed things, they took responsibility for their region, and they set things in order.

So Rome did warfare differently than Egypt did. When Egypt went to war, they would go kill all their people, take all their men, steal all their treasures, bring it back to Egypt, and then this little kingdom would just keep growing in its locale, right? Rome, being the war geniuses they are, decided, "That's not a very good idea. We can get population, we can get wealth, and we can get territory if we have the right tactic." So what's the tactic? Apostles. Yep. So when these conversations were happening between Jesus and his teenage followers, they would have completely understood what their mission was, because the term apostles hadn't been baptized

yet.

So there's a kingdom and there's a colony: Rome, and then there's the place that they're overtaking. And when they overtake that place, rather than just stealing their stuff and making their little kingdom bigger, they take the territory by establishing an ekklēsia. They don't even have to go to war. They just have to topple the government. Now they just have to replace a system. They establish an ekklēsia; they put a governing assembly in there. The people that lead the ekklēsias, they're called apostles. Apostles are sent ones. They come from the kingdom to the colony to turn the colony into the kingdom.

When Jesus taught people how to pray, he literally taught Roman warfare: "Our Father that's in the kingdom, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come in the colony as it is in the kingdom." The tactic for redemption of creation was thriving local churches, churches that feel like family and look like heaven. The power of relationship and impartation only happens if you show up. It's a big deal, huh? What did I tell you to go to? 2 Corinthians chapter 5. Go there. Okay, so, so churches, hmm.

Seeing the Body Correctly

But let me give you a distinction between... Sometimes Jesus is sneaky, right? So somebody asked Jesus, "What is the greatest law in the Law and the Prophets?" Okay, and then he delivered to them what we call in the church the Golden Rule, right? Love the Lord God with all your mind, heart, and soul, or, I don't even remember what those three things are, and love your neighbor as yourself, right? Upon these things hang all the Law and the Prophets, right? Jesus fulfilled the Law and the Prophets, so that statement, it's completely null. Yeah. Means nothing anymore. He answered the question he was asked, no more, no less: "What's the greatest in all the Law and the Prophets?" Okay.

Jesus says, the only time he says anything about telling you what to do, "A new commandment I give to you." Yeah. "Love your neighbor as I have loved you." Yep. Love becomes transcendent rather than reciprocal. Yep. So the way a healthy local church functions is not by recognizing one another for who they are; it's recognizing one another for who he recognizes you as. Yep. Much better, right? So we have to come up, right? Churches, like, there is literally a counseling office in our town that is nearly solely dedicated to church hurt. It's awful. We come in here and we put people under the bondage of religion. We actually reduce the identity that they even had while they were smoking crack under a bridge: "You're not just a crackhead, you're a sinner," right? "If you didn't know, we've got good news for you."

So when Jesus says something like, "I want you to love one another as I have loved you," then we have to evaluate: how are you loved? John chapter 17 says that the Father loves you with the same love he loves the Son with. It's transcendent through the divine, and it comes from the divine into the body. That has to be the bar that the body sets, or we fail. 2 Corinthians... This is the second time I told you to go there and I didn't go there. 2 Corinthians 5:14–17: "The love of Christ compels us, because we judge thus: that if one died for all, then all died; and he died for all, that those who live should no longer live for themselves, but for him who died for them and rose again. Therefore, from now on," or basically, from now on, "we regard no one according to the flesh. Even though we knew Jesus Christ according to the flesh, we know him thus no longer. Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he's a new creation; old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new."

Okay, so sometimes when the Bible says all, we get really hung up, because we don't like the word all in the Bible. If one died for Christians? No. If one died for all, then all died. Jesus took away the sin of the world, right? And now the finished work of the cross needs appropriated to creation by sons. Yep. So the way that they endeavor to steward their relationships is that they would no longer perceive anyone according to the flesh. Now, I want you to see that this is a much more subtle tendency than it might sound. When we think of flesh, it's like this just nasty, disgusting thing, but Jesus is actually the victim of being perceived according to the flesh, right? They said, "We used to know Jesus according to the flesh, but we know him thus no longer." They literally got to watch the Transfiguration. They got to watch him go from being a carpenter's son to the divinity of the Godhead literally manifesting in his physical body. John got to see the resurrected Christ, right?

There's so many big revelations in here, I'm afraid that I'm not going to get them all, so I'm going to drop bombs, okay? Okay, here comes one. Paul told the Corinthian church, "Many are weak, sick, and dying among you because you haven't discerned the body." Many are weak, sick, and dying among you because you haven't been able to see one another for who God created you to be, and you're still full of judgment, bitterness, and hurt. We regard no one according to the flesh. We knew Jesus that way, but now we see him as the resurrected Christ: hair like wool, eyes like fire, feet like bronze, a sword in his mouth. Do you know that's the person you're sitting beside? Yeah. Like, that's the culture that you have to endeavor to create: that when somebody walks in the door, we no longer regard them according to the flesh. They're everything he is and nothing that he's not, and if they don't know it, it's your responsibility to appropriate that to them.

Now, Jesus, right? Jesus goes to the temple to preach. When Jesus goes to the temple to preach, they go from being, I'm going to find the exact words, astonished to offended in five

minutes. Astonished to offended in five minutes, right? Check this out. Mark chapter 6, 1–6. "He went out from there..." You don't have to turn here; I'm just going to reference it quickly. "He went out from there and came to his own country." Everybody say, "His own country." Problem. Okay, problem that Jesus fixed, and I'll show you how. "His disciples followed him. And when the Sabbath had come, he began to teach in the synagogue. And many hearing him were astonished: 'Where did this man get these things? And what wisdom is this which is given to him, and such mighty works are performed by his hands?'" Okay, nothing changed. They're astonished. They came in in ignorance, in the correct posture, and they were astonished.

Somebody pipes up from the back and says, "I know his dad. He's the carpenter's kid. His brothers and sisters are sitting here listening." Then they were offended at him. They didn't see him as a drunkard or a demon-possessed man or a winebibber, yet. They didn't see that. All they saw was him according to his flesh, his genetics and his environment. They saw him as a mere man, and they lost total respect for him. And guess who it cost? He could do no mighty miracles among them, right? Many are weak, sick, and dying among you because you haven't discerned the body. You haven't realized what one another are carrying. You haven't made an impartation of honor so that you can receive an impartation of gifting. You haven't recognized that you're standing in the presence of greatness. The local church is the hope of the world. We always say things like, "Familiarity breeds contempt." That's not true. Familiarity plus immaturity breeds contempt. Jesus...

Unity and Structure

Okay, here's another bomb. There's a difference between power and authority, okay? Authority is what holds the local church together. Power comes from God; authority does not. Okay, so Jesus turns 30. It's time to start his ministry. He needs recognized as a rabbi, so he goes to somebody that can authorize him. Yep. It's his cousin, his wet-behind-the-ears cousin. He's been in ministry for six months. He's literally six months older than Jesus. So Jesus is stepping into ministry, this dude's still in training, and he says, "I need to come to be baptized by you to fulfill all righteousness." Jesus is empowered by his Father; he's authorized by his cousin. Yep. Jesus flipped the script. He looked at a cousin that he had known for so long, they recognized one another in utero, and he says, "I need to be baptized by you."

Then Jesus gets caught by the rabbis doing miracles, and they say, "By whose authority do you do these things?" And if you understand Hebrew culture, they knew where the power came from. They were fine with that. They said, "Who authorized this? Who says you can preach behind our pulpits?" And he said, "Well, you asked me a question; let me ask you a question. What do you think of John the Baptist? Is he from heaven or from men?" Yeah. They said, "We can't answer you," because somebody's going to get ticked off. It doesn't matter what we

say, it's going to end bad. And he said, "Then I can't answer you," because you won't affirm the guy that authorized me.

The Creator of the universe stepped into the local body and said, "What can I do?" It's the most gorgeous picture of family there is. Jesus was a victim of familiarity, and he flipped the script by submitting to his own cousin, who had been in ministry for six months. Why do you think that is? It's not because there's a hierarchy. It's because these two men completely understood who one another were in the heavenlies.

The Bible says you do not need to create unity. Creating unity is an uphill battle that you never win. When you try to create unity, what you do is you get all the denominations together, and you leave all of your doctrines at home, and you settle on one stupid thing that does nothing, right? We've done it. Yeah. "Let's host the National Day of Prayer, but you can't sing fast songs, you can't sing slow songs, you can't take communion because it's on a Friday," like, all this stupid stuff. And we're like, "Jesus," that's what we're allowed to say, right? Because we've made doctrine something that we form relationships around, and that's stupid and that's shallow, right? You cannot gather around doctrine. You can't gather around agreement. You have to gather around family. Family shows up.

Unity needs preserved. Paul said to endeavor to preserve the unity that's in the Spirit. Yep. The church is already resurrected in heaven. There's no denominational walls in Zion. Yep. That is the church of the firstborn, those registered in heaven, the spirits of just men made perfect, whether you're a Baptist or Pentecostal. And that unity does not need created. That unity existed before the foundation of the world. But you have to look past pet doctrines, you have to look past preferences, you have to look past attitudes. How many of you know that not all of you are the same? Some of you here, let's be practical, some of you are 100% relationally incompatible. It's fine.

The church in Ephesus had 26,000 members. The church in Acts had 3,000 members on the first day. Do you think they all got along relationally? Nope. Stay away from each other. It's fine. I've tried it. I sat across from a guy and I was like, "I don't like you, and I can't help it. I've tried. We have nothing to talk about. It's wildly uncomfortable." That's why Acts chapter 2 gives you the ability to go house to house and break bread, so you can hang out with the people that you do like. It's just the truth, right?

So house churches... House churches were much different, right? They sat under the apostles' doctrines and teachings in gatherings of 26,000 and up, okay? Their purpose for gathering in homes was to break bread, to have gladness, favor with people, simplicity of heart. They were bros. That's it. Yep. So this small church thing is garbage too. Yep. I was like, "I want to go to

a small church where you clearly don't care about your city." Right? Go to a big church, and then go to your house with everybody that you like. Yep. I mean, this is church structure. I'm not teaching anything new. This is Acts chapter 2. This is literally the first week of the first-century church. The first-century church had 3,000 people on its first day. Three thousand. The very next verse says, "And the Lord added daily those who were being saved." So three thousand and counting, which is why small, isolated portions of heaven in your homes is necessary, but so are regional apostolic fathers. They can't pick one over the other. Good.

Okay, where do we want to go? It's 12:02, son. I'll finish. Okay, 12:02. He said, he said, "I'm done two minutes ago-ish." Okay, last two things. Okay, so John the Revelator. Yep. Nobody can find any record of his death. I'm tying these things together, right? Many are weak, sick, and dying among you because you haven't discerned the body, because you go to a group and you get offended by everything. Yep. You were bitterness. "Well, come to my church, it's all right." Many are weak, sick, and dying among you because you haven't discerned the body.

Okay, so John the Revelator is the only one of the twelve apostles that we can't find a death record for, okay? Jesus even prophetically affirmed that John wasn't going to die. He said, "What is it to you if John doesn't die?" They even tried to kill him. Didn't work. But I'm going to submit to you that I know why. In Revelation chapter 1, he got to see the resurrected Christ. Yep. A.D. 68, he got to see the resurrected Christ. The resurrected Christ took him through an entire process of showing the destruction of every enemy that would ever face humanity. And then in Revelation 21, okay, there's two times that John fell down as dead: when he saw the resurrected Christ, and when he saw the resurrected bride. Yep. The angel's like, "Look, there she is again. Like, stand up, bro. Like, we're trying to get revelation here."

Twice he fell down. He said, "I saw the bride prepared as, or for, her husband, the Lamb's wife," and he fell down. He was able to discern the body. And then he came back and he wrote you a letter, and he said, "As he is, so are we in this world. Love has been perfected among us in this." Why do you think he referred to himself as the Beloved in his letter? He knew his resurrected self, and he discerned the body, and he was able to appropriate the unity that already existed in heaven at Zion to our natural local church. Family shows up.

Part 7

Spiritual Warfare Structures

So, if we need to take a seventh-inning stretch, we will. But today's word, I believe it's really important. The title is "The Battle for the Body." And I'm going to give you a perspective on physical healing that you maybe have never had before. But it's not just about physical healing. I want you to understand kind of the history of this narrative. Do you realize that the entire biblical narrative has been a battle for the human body? And anything that we can do to attack or devalue or, how do I say, on purpose, the human body is, I would say, just a continued attack against the importance of the human body.

And this is probably going to hit you from left field, because let me explain something to you. How many of you ever heard of the fivefold ministry model? Apostles, prophets, pastors, teachers, and evangelists, right? Do you realize that there is another structure that is five layers deep that exists in your Bible? Powers, principalities, mights, dominions, and rulers in high places. Does everybody know what that is? That's the governmental structure of darkness. So oftentimes we think that our battles are being fought spiritually, but God instituted a spiritual body of people to overcome powers, principalities, mights, dominions, and rulers in high places. So it's not like Michael and Raphael the archangel fighting against these structures. It is the local church. The local church is the one responsible to make known the manifold wisdom of God to the powers, principalities, mights, and dominions. That's what your Bible says.

But what's odd about these two structures is these two structures directly oppose. One is authentic and one is counterfeit. But they do exactly the same thing. You get what I'm saying? So if the apostolic responsibility is to set doctrine and create culture, what do you think a ruler in high places does? They do the same thing. But it's important, and I really want to make this not come out the wrong way or make it sound elite or anything, but having an integrity when you approach Scripture that doesn't have tradition and religion kind of soaking it down is vital to understanding this. So Jesus referenced legalistic doctrine as the doctrine of demons, right? So we may think that hell is responsible for, like, the darkness that we see. But I think a more tactful assault on the local church is bad doctrine, right? A more tactful assault on the local church is bad doctrine. So if Jesus says, "I've came to give you life, and life abundant," then why don't we get our pulpits preaching a message that makes you jealous of dead people?

Rethinking Death and Doctrine

Right? It's true. Right? We all go to, and I'm not trying to be dismissive or patronize anyone, but we go to funerals and we all say, "Well, they went home. They're dancing now. They're

happy." That kind of attitude towards death is something that's not found in the Bible. There's even a malfunction in the articulation of the language from the original language to English. How many of you ever heard a preacher, especially at a funeral, say that "precious in the sight of the Lord is the death of one of His saints"? Right? Have you heard that? Do the research and you'll find that the word "precious," even though the English words are very close, the Hebrew words are definitely, definitely different. Precious and costly are two very different words, right? So if I told you that costly in the sight of the Lord is the death of one of His saints, you would take it much differently than precious in the sight of the Lord. Right? God loves when your friends die. We say that and we don't question it.

If I have a car that's precious, okay, right now I have a car that's precious. It's a big Ford. It growls. It makes it through the snow. It has attitude. That's a precious car, right? Yep. I had a costly car at one time, much different than a precious car. It was a BMW with bald tires, cracked joints, and, like, it was just a death trap. Shanda and I went down to play a worship event down in Columbus, and we were just thanking God that we were alive when we got there. Like, worship started early. It was just raining. Just raining and cold. You know how underpasses get, like, those gusts of wind? Every underpass. "Okay, we're straight again. Okay, we're straight again." Like, we made it through like thirty of those, right? The Lord was with us. But because of everything that was broken on it, it was costly. It wasn't precious. So the death of one of God's saints is costly to Him. That's right. It's not precious. Okay. So what I'm saying is perhaps we should approach Scripture with some integrity and see

The Battle for Humanity

that the message that Jesus preached was actually a message that redeemed the body and not got rid of it. And since Genesis, there has been a battle for the human body. And let me explain to you why. You're going to hear some things today that are extra-biblical. They're not in your Bible. They're extra-biblical. And I'll explain to you why I'm okay with them being true. How many of you know that "true" and "scriptural" aren't necessarily synonymous, but they can go together, right? Like the invasion at Normandy. Is that scriptural? No. Is it true? Sure is. Yep. Yep. We have to be okay with that stuff.

Okay. So, in Genesis, we've covered this a million times, so I'm going to go quick here, because the content that I have to get to is deep. In Genesis, you see God specifically ordain a specific species for the government of His visible creation, right? He said, "Let Us make man in Our image, and let them have dominion." So He gave a species, a human being, dominion over all of creation. The only difference between God and man at that moment was a body, right? Because He made them out of Himself. John 1 says without Him nothing was made that was made, and everything that was made was made from Him. Right? So God took a piece of

His divinity, He fashioned it in His image, and then He put it in a dirt body. And then that specific species, human, Adam, mankind, is what He gave dominion over all of creation.

So if I say, "Let us have you over for pizza," and you're eating pizza, who's eating pizza? You, not me. I would have said "us" if I meant us, but I said "you" on purpose, right? "Let Us make man in Our own image, and let them have dominion." That's the kingdom mandate. That's why everything makes sense. So the human body is the most important piece of technology in visible creation. That's why everything in the world is trying to kill it. Got me right? So God told Adam and Eve, "In the day that you eat of that tree of knowledge of good and evil, you will die." Satan understood that if he could get them to spiritually die, then that carnality would be absolutely useless. He wanted to borrow the authority that that body possessed. That was the first attack assailed on the body of man, right? And he won.

Now, if you can reduce a human from their divinity and you can only get them to live according to their sensuality, then they're only as good as it's going. If you're only as good as it's going, what happens? You die. Right? You're only as good as the creation around you. The thing that you were supposed to dominate then starts governing you. The thing that you were supposed to expand starts to decrease and starts to take you with it. Right now, don't get up and leave. Just listen. Okay? We're going to talk about some stuff real quick.

Genesis 6 and the Nephilim

How many of you have ever read a passage in Genesis 6? Then the sons of God came down and lay with the daughters of men, and they bore children to them, and these children were called Nephilim, and they were the giants, the men of renown. And then the Bible says nothing else about it. Don't you hate that? There's two scriptures and you're like, "Wait, what? Giant babies?" And then the Bible's like, "Yeah, what? Moving on." It's like Matthew 27. "And dead men got out of their graves, walked into the holy city, and preached the gospel." Moving on. Shh. What? Wait, you have to tell me more, right?

Well, here's the deal. Okay. And I'm not saying it's scriptural. I'm just saying it's true. And I'm borrowing that statement from my friend Chris. Do you know that there is a book that explains what happens in Genesis 6? Does anybody know what the book's called? Enoch. Right. I'm not saying it's canonized. I'm not saying it should be. I'm not saying it's Holy Spirit inspired. Quote, "I do believe that it's true and that it's historical." The reason I believe that is because every single New Testament writer quoted the book. Okay? So, if we weren't supposed to be referencing the book, then I don't think Paul would have referenced the book, right? So, there's some safety there.

So, here's the deal, and I don't want to get too weird about this, but Genesis 6 says it. Let's just go on what's in your Bible and be okay with it, right? The sons of God, who there's massive amounts of evidence, right? When, excuse me, when Satan walked into the presence of God to ask Him about Job, who was God with? The heavenly council, right? We're not making this up. We're just not used to talking about it. But God's not alone in heaven, right? Hundreds of thousands of the heavenly council, sons of God, exist in heaven. And that is the heavenly council that He sits among as the Most High, right? And they decided in Genesis 6 that they wanted to procreate with women. So they did. And that species, listen, that species violated human seed. Okay? It's a battle for the body.

Why is human seed necessary? Well, do you remember Genesis 3? After the fall of humanity, God promised the restoration of humanity. How did He promise it? He said, "I will put enmity between the woman's seed and your seed." I'll bring My seed through a woman. Right? That's what God said. I will bring divine seed through human seed, and then I will put, excuse me, enmity between human seed and demonic seed. Human seed will crush your head, and you'll only bruise their heel. Right? Okay. So why is that important? That's important because now we only have one species, one thing that can possibly carry the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ, and it's a human being. Okay.

So, what happens in Genesis 6? Pure humanity is compromised through, it says it. Don't, like, I know this sounds weird. It says it, or, this isn't what we're going to talk about most of the time anyway. This is just to make a point. Sons of God came down, lay with the daughters of men, and had children with them. These were Nephilim, the men of renown. Right? So these aren't pure humans. So now we've compromised the humanity that's supposed to carry the seed of divinity to restore the human race as God intended it. Right? Are you okay with that? Then in the book of Enoch, it says that they didn't just compromise human seed. They actually taught humans how to destroy themselves. They taught them sorcery. They taught them metalworks. They taught them to build swords and shields. They taught them to fight over territory. They taught them to go to war. They essentially authored the destruction of humankind.

And I can put this in perspective for you so you understand why Noah was righteous. Okay? The Bible says that with no law there can be no transgression. So if there's no law, then you can't be found righteous by your behaviors. Right? Righteousness is established based on the covenant that you're in. So if there's no law to render Noah righteous, what is God looking for at this point? To be able to save, so that His promise and His destiny can be fulfilled. Have you ever, like, applied for a job and said, "I just need somebody with a pulse and a body"? It's all God was looking for at the time. Noah didn't really, you know, he didn't have to accomplish a whole heck of a lot for this job, okay? He just had to be a human.

So when it says that God relented of the day that He made man, or regretted the day that He made man, He didn't regret it because men were evil. He regretted it because they had been made evil by the influence of these Nephilim. Okay? And they were destroying themselves. Not only that, the earth, as it was created, was created for humans. And these things were huge, and they were burning through natural resources so quickly that they turned cannibalistic. Okay, so God sees this happening. He understands that we have to have the restoration of a human body. So He says we have to save humanity. So what does He do to save humanity? He puts all of the humans that He knows in a boat. Is this making sense? And He kills everything, right? Not because He hates humans, but because He loves humans and He wants to reestablish their race to bring divinity. How many of you have read Isaiah chapter 9? Go there real quick.

Redemption of the Body

Verse 6. Say amen when you're there. Okay, I'm going to read it straight through, then I'm going to explain it. It says, "For unto us a Child is born, unto us a Son is given; and the government will be upon His shoulder. And His name will be called Wonderful, Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. Of the increase of His government and peace there will be no end, upon the throne of David and over His kingdom, to order it and establish it with judgment and justice from that time forward, even forever. The zeal of the Lord of hosts will perform this." Okay.

Now, very specific structure to this passage, and if you aren't looking for the restoration of humanity here, then you won't notice it. "Unto us a Child is born." The word "born," like, pay attention to that passage. The word "born" was the Hebrew word yālad, and it meant to be begotten, brought forth, or birthed. Okay, so "unto us a Child is born, and unto us a Son," is the word "Son" capitalized in your Bible? Okay. "Is given." The word "given" was nāthan, which meant gifted or bestowed. Okay. So the prophet Isaiah is actually talking about a very specific synchronicity between divinity and humanity, because he said, "Unto us a Child is born." Who bore the child? Mary. "And unto us a Son is given." Who gave the Son? God. Right?

So now what we see is what God intended was a dirt body with the fullness of God dwelling in it, manifesting itself as God's intentional human, as the manifestation of the Father on earth. Right? Is this a lot? Is this okay? Okay. It's going to get practical here in a second. I just don't like fluff. So, I don't want you to just believe me. I want to give you background, and then I'll tell you what I'm trying to tell you. Okay? So, this is the seed that God needed that was almost sacrificed. As a matter of fact, the Bible says that God gave the Ten Commandments to protect the body, right? The 619 ordinances were to condemn all of humanity. But the first ten were just to make sure that you didn't do again what the Nephilim talked them into before. Don't have any other gods before Me. Don't kill each other. Don't do drugs. Don't commit sorcery,

right? Like, we're trying to preserve this thing because it has intention.

Why do you think everything in your life wants you dead? Because your body is the antenna of heaven. The only touchstone that heaven has with earth is you. You are Jacob's ladder. You are what heaven and earth descends upon. And if you don't have a body, your task here is done. Understand? Do you think it's an accident that you ended up depressed? Do you think it's an accident that you wanted to take your own life? Do you think it's an accident that you were so tormented in your mind that you turned to something? Listen, tormented so much in your mind that you turned to something that would kill your body. It's because you're a big deal. It's because you have purpose. It's because, listen, it's because the Bible says, "Lift up your heads, O you gates, and let the Lord of glory come in." Right? If He's coming to earth, He's coming through you.

They said, "Jesus, show us the Father." And He said, "Look at this." Look, just turn your front-facing camera this way. That's how you see the glory of the Lord. 1 Corinthians 6 says, if you want to see the glory of the Lord, it's beheld in a mirror. It's your body. It's your visible manifestation on earth. There has been a battle to make you dead since before the foundation of the earth. Now, here's the deal. Okay, this is what I'm talking about. We have created doctrines. We allow them in the church that would rather you dead than alive. We gather around funeral processions and we just wish we were them. "I can't wait till I go." What in the heaven are we talking about? Jesus said, "I came to give you life." And not just any life, but abundant life. Life to the full. And we're jealous of dead people.

The Temple of God

Hebrews 11:12. Do you know what Hebrews 11:21 is about? It's about the Hall of Fame of faith. Integrity. Approach Scripture with integrity. Okay. Everybody thinks we're trying to escape this body to go somewhere. All of the people that have escaped this body and went somewhere are waiting to get their bodies back. It's your Bible, right? Okay. And them getting their glorified body is dependent on you living. The last scripture in Hebrews chapter 11 says, "And they won't be made perfect apart from you." Right? So, this is going to throw a wrench in your gears. It's not supposed to not bring you comfort. To be absent from the body is to be present with the Lord. That's the absolute truth, right? But that's not the end. Perfection is in a body, right? You're not trying to get to where they are. They're trying to get to where you are. Okay? That's the gospel.

The Bible literally says in Romans chapter 6 that you would receive the redemption of your body, the hope to which you were called. Okay? So, we've been taught, almost every religious circle that I know teaches us, that this thing is the problem. This thing is the answer. We've

been all taught that once we shed, I don't know how. Listen, all we got to do is read. Most of the time the bad stuff that you hear in the Bible, just read the next verse and it'll make sense, right? Paul said, "I know this tent is perishing." So, that's all we do. We walk around and tell each other, "Yep, this old man is perishing." And we welcome it. And we sustain it. And our conditioning allows it. And we allow things in our life like bad mentalities, poor attitudes, and condemnation and guilt and addiction and depression and anxiety. All of these things that are simply trying to hijack your destiny, because your body is the most important technology on earth today. Does this make sense? Okay.

Where you want to go now? I'm going to read 1 Corinthians 6 to you. You don't have to go there. I just want to show you something. And then we'll read 2 Corinthians 5 together. 1 Corinthians 6:19–20 says, "Do you not know that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have from God, and you are not your own? For you were bought with a price; therefore glorify God in your body and in your spirit, which are God's." Okay? Your body is God's. We've been taught in every religious circle we know that your body is the enemy. That you'll be perfect when you get rid of this ugly thing. Am I right or wrong? You'll be perfect when you get rid of this stupid thing. This thing is the problem. This thing is not the problem. Right?

God gave a very specific species. I want to make your Bible make sense to you. Okay? There's 4,000 years between Genesis and the New Covenant, Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John. It's about 4,000 years. In that 4,000 years, you see a bunch of things that you are mad at God about, right? How many people do you know who say, "I don't want to be a Christian because God let babies die, because God this, because God did that, because God did this"? Listen, I want to tell you something about the first 4,000 years' worth of biblical history. Humanity did everything. Okay? God's not an insecure CEO. When He gives dominion to a species, He lets them have dominion.

Human Agreement and Destiny

Okay? How many of you remember when God wanted to judge Sodom and Gomorrah? Who did He tell about it? Abraham. Then Abraham said, what did he say? "If I can find fifty righteous people, will You spare them?" I don't remember the numbers. I'm making them up. God's like, "Sure." Don't you hate when you haggle and they say yes the first time? You don't know what you could have got out of them. Yeah. "How about twenty?" "Whatever you say." "How about five?" "Sure thing." "What about just one righteous person in Sodom?" What's God say? "If we can find one righteous person, I'll spare it." And Abraham says, "Done. Let's go." What do you think would have happened if Abraham would have just said, "No"? He just spared Sodom.

Do I have biblical proof? You bet I do. Because God asked Moses the same question. God asked Moses the same question. He said, "Hey, Moses, listen. I'll make you a deal. These guys are train wrecks, right? Let's just off them all. We can start all over, Me and you. Just Me and you, buddy. Right? We won't have these three million whiners in the wilderness with us anymore." Right? And what's Moses say? "Do You know how bad You'll look if You kill everybody right now? Come on, God. Get it together." He says, "If You kill them now, they'll think You literally led them out of captivity to kill them in the wilderness. What kind of God will You look like then?" And God says, "You're right. Let's roll." Okay.

So, we have two instances. Who is in charge? "Let them have dominion." This body calls the shots. Right? So, everything on earth right now is a matter of human agreement. We have to get this body redeemed. We have to be all right with physical healing. We have to be okay with deliverance. Almost every spiritual gift that's mentioned in 1 Corinthians 12 is to redeem this body, to heal it, to save it, to deliver it, to keep it from death, to store it safe and sound. Because it is the touch point between heaven and earth. What's the Bible say? Lay hands on the sick, and what happens? They recover. Why? Because these hands are fully loaded.

We have to stop hating this body. We have to get the conditioning out of our head that dying is better than living. We have to get the lies out of our doctrine that death is our goal. One of my favorite singers on the planet, and one of his best songs ever, says that he was facing the death that he'd been waiting for. Sorry, Mattie Montgomery. That's not the right gospel. And only, like, two people in here know who that is. But that's okay. I won't tell you to look them up either. You'll think I'm demon-possessed. Okay. Now, go to 2 Corinthians chapter 5, you guys.

All right. Have you ever had one of those moments where, like, you realize that you've been duped for a long time? You just, like, facepalm yourself. You're like, "Now everything makes sense." That's how I feel when I get this revelation. Like, why is my body constantly being attacked by sickness? Because it's really important. Why am I being convinced that being dead is better than being alive? Well, because if I die, I lose my body. Why am I convinced that addiction can solve my problems? Well, because you're mentally in torture. So, you take it out on the thing that houses your purpose. Right? Then you get to this and you're like, "I've took the bait, hook, line, and sinker, the whole time." This body is made for greatness. This body is literally, I just read it in 2 Corinthians, or 1 Corinthians 6, the temple of God. It's where He lives. Now, I'll give you a little insight. The academy students are going to get this lesson on Tuesday night. It's a big deal. But do you realize that the, I don't know how to do this without

Tabernacling With Men

doing it big. So, I'll try to make it as concise as possible. There are three phases in biblical history of where heaven met earth. Okay, Genesis 1 is the first one. Heaven met earth in a garden, and God was there with him, right? They lost that heaven and earth. Then heaven met earth in the tabernacle of Moses, above the mercy seat, right? When Peter mentions heaven and earth passing away, all of the Jews understood that that's what Jewish people referred to as heaven and earth. So heaven and earth passed away in 70 AD. That place was blown up. But now it says, "Behold, God is tabernacling with men." Do you know what that meant? You're the third heaven and earth. You're where heaven meets earth. You are the temple of God. Not a piece of Him. The measure of the stature of the fullness of God, the fullness of the Godhead bodily. That's Ephesians 4 and that's Colossians 2, if you want to look it up, as to not sell yourself short. You're welcome to.

1 Corinthians, no, 2 Corinthians 5, I'm sorry. It says, "For we know that if our earthly house, this tent, is destroyed, we have a building from God, a house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens." Okay. So, if you don't read any further, that sounds like death is a good idea, right? If I read that to you and you didn't know the point of the gospel, you didn't understand the mandate of the kingdom, then that would sound like really good news. "Hey, if you lose your body, it's all right. You got a better house." But that's not what Paul's writing about. Paul says, "For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed with our habitation which is from heaven, if indeed, having been clothed, we shall not be found naked." Listen. "For we who are in this tent groan, being burdened, because we want," or excuse me, "not because we want to be unclothed." Okay?

What's Paul saying? We don't want to die, right? If we're in this tent, we're groaning for something. We're not groaning to die. We don't want to be taken out of this tent. It says we want to be further clothed. Okay? We want this body to get better. We don't want this body to go away, right? We want the measure of the stature of the fullness of God to give life to this mortal body. That's Romans 6. Okay? And then it says this. This is the most powerful line in all of the Bible. And I'm not wrong. That's up for debate. I guess you guys got really, like, silent. I thought maybe you thought I was serious. I'm not. But okay.

"For if we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed with our habitation which is from heaven, if indeed, having been clothed, we shall not be found naked. For we are in this tent," excuse me, "for we who are in this tent groan, being burdened, not to be unclothed, but to be further clothed, that death might be swallowed up by life." Isn't that better news? Yep. "That death might be swallowed up by life. Now He who has prepared us for this very thing is God, who also has given us the Spirit as a guarantee." Isn't that awesome? If you don't believe it, come on. He has deposited the fullness of the Godhead bodily in you. His intention is for that

Godhead to make His way to manifest Romans chapter 8 in your mortal body, so that who God says you are is what people experience of you when they encounter you, right? Your identity on the inside is intended to be, excuse me, your manifest identity on the outside.

There has been a battle for the human body. There's been a battle for seed from the beginning of Revelations. Do you know that Genesis 11 is the middle of your Bible? Your Bible is a 4,000-year written record, and Genesis 11 is the middle. How much do you think's missing from the beginning? A boatload, right? So that's why the Book of Enoch and some other things that are true, but maybe not scriptural, are important. Everything has been after the human body, right? So why do I say this now? Well, in the last year I have more friends with health issues than I've ever had in my life. In the last five years, I've seen more anxiety and depression than I've ever seen in my life. I want to say it's something around 60 to 65% of Americans are on antidepressants. The rest of them just won't do it, right? Doesn't mean they're not depressed. Okay?

Do you realize, and this is how this is meant to work, right? So, if the Spirit is supposed to give life to your mortal body, and the Spirit is supposed to govern your soul, then your body is a slave to your spirit. Excuse me, your body is a slave to your soul. So, if something can attack your soul, it has your body, right? Neurologists say every thought that you think has a biological or a cellular response. That means when you wake up on the wrong side of the road, you're breathing death into the body that God gave you.

Healing as Divine Purpose

Right? So, we think everything that God tells us is like, how do I say this? Everything that God tells us is a rule. It's not a rule. Okay? It's a strategy, right? "Well, why wouldn't I want to take my own life?" Because your destiny's gone. Then you get to go hang out in the cloud of witnesses and wait for perfection, for a bunch of other people to get it right. You get me? Right. Do you know, what was it, 1 Corinthians 6 that we just read? Do you know that's about sexual immorality? When it's talking about your body being a temple of God, it says to flee from sexual immorality. What's sexual immorality have to do with the temple? If you knew, how do I say this? If you knew what being in a relationship without being in love does to your soul, you'd never do it again. It's not a rule. It's not harsh. It's not trying to keep you from enjoying the pleasures of life. No, no, no, no, no. It's so that you understand the gift that God has given you. Okay?

Do you know what I'm talking about? I'm not trying to make it sound better than it is either. I get it. But what I'm saying is God has strategies. God has things in place to protect your body. And every enemy that you will fight is after that body. Sickness, death, depression, anxiety,

right? All of these things are simply trying to thwart your destiny. So I say all of these things to say this. This is why this is important. If you don't understand God's skin in the game when it comes to your body, then you won't realize. How many of you have ever wanted to ask God to heal you, but you didn't feel worthy? You didn't feel valuable, or you thought maybe other people needed it more than you, right? Happens all the time.

But do you realize that your body on earth is God's avenue to express His will? He has as much benefit of you staying alive as you do. He doesn't want your body in pain. He doesn't want your body dead. He doesn't want your body in destruction. He doesn't want your body to be a crippled mess from the life that you've lived, in the pain that you've gone through. He wants to use your body to glorify your Father in heaven. He wants people to be able to say, "If you've seen me, you've seen Him. Look no further." You understand that the manifestation of sons is the intention of God?

If I could put it simply this way, you have three identities. You have a third heaven identity, you have a second heaven identity, and you have a first heaven identity. They should all be the same, but they're expressed differently. Your third heaven identity is who God says you are, right? That's unchanging. Your second heaven identity is who you actually believe you are. And your first heaven identity is what people encounter when they encounter you. So the intention of the redemption of your body is so that people encounter who He says you are when they encounter you. Do you understand what I'm saying? Okay? Blameless, spotless, perfect, holy, loving, right? Above reproach, powerful, sound-minded, all of the things that He says you are. Everything He is, and nothing that He's not. Okay.

So, 1 Corinthians 6:15, and then I think we'll probably wrap up. Say amen when you're there. "Do you not know that your bodies are members of Christ?" Okay. "Do you not know that your bodies are members of Christ?" Sometimes we relegate spiritual things to spiritual planes, and we don't realize that your body is just as important to Jesus as your spirit. "Shall I then take the members of Christ and make them members of a harlot? Certainly not! Or do you not know that he who is joined to a harlot is one body with her? For 'the two,' He says, 'shall become one flesh.' But he who is joined to the Lord is one spirit with Him." Okay? So, do you understand what he's saying? This isn't about prostitutes. This is about joining yourself to something less than the Spirit of God.

Anything that you allowed to govern outside of you, you become one with, right? Your body becomes a reflection of the glory that you serve. If that's finances, worry will constantly be manifesting in your body. If it's depression, depression will constantly be manifesting in your body. You join yourself to something, you become one with it, and then your body becomes a reflection of it. That's why it says when you join yourself to the Lord, you become one spirit

with the Lord. That union in that Spirit expresses itself through your mortal body, right? I don't want to get too far away from this.

I was talking to my friend Jeff this morning, and some words came out of my mouth that weren't in my brain first. Have you ever had that happen? Words came out of my mouth that weren't in my brain first, and I just started crying when I heard them, because it was as though somebody else said them. I said I was going to share a perspective on healing that I've never taught before, and everybody's getting healed. Okay. There are people... Is Aden here? Yeah. Come hang out with me up here. There are people that have vaccine injuries in here. There are people that have residual COVID effects. There are people that have had poor diagnosises. There are people that are mentally in anguish. There are people that are physically in anguish.

And what we need to understand is your healing isn't only for your benefit. It is greatly for your benefit. It was His act of love for you to take your stripes on His back. But understand that your body is the most important piece of technology on earth today. If you lose it, if you lose it, heaven can't touch earth through you anymore. Okay? When Jesus spoke to the disciples, He said, "You'll see the Son of Man," and you'll see, He's the ladder, "you'll see angels descending and ascending upon Him." You're the gates. You're the ladders. You're the touch point of heaven and earth.

I'm going to read Hebrews 11 to you, just so you know that I'm not fibbing. Feel like when we preach these new things, sometimes it requires a lot of background. But Hebrews 11 is about Moses and Jeremiah and widows and all of these people that had a promise but didn't see it. They died in faith. Like, they were being faithful to attain a promise, but they died before they received it. And if they died, what happens to them? To be absent from the body is to be present with the Lord. So those people, in Hebrews chapter 12, they're referred to as a cloud of witnesses, right? So that word "cloud" is a very specific Greek word that is used often by Jews to refer to a company of people. Like when it says Jesus is coming on a cloud. Yep. It's not like a cumulus. It's these folks.

Do you know what they're coming back to do? Inhabit their bodies. The dead in Christ will rise first. Those of us who are alive and remain. Those of us who are alive and remain. There's a group of people that cancel their appointment with death. There's a group of people that maintain the integrity of their God-given body. You understand what I'm saying? This is orthodoxy. Like, this has been believed for 2,000 years. The end of Hebrews 11, it says, "And all these obtained a good testimony through faith, but they didn't receive the promise. God provided something better for us, that they should not be made perfect apart from us. Therefore, since we're surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight and sin which so easily ensnares us, and let's run the race with endurance that is set

before us. Let's look unto Jesus, the author and the finisher of our faith, who for the joy set before Him endured the cross, despised the shame, and has sat down at the right hand of God." Good, right?

Do you know what it means when somebody's your forerunner? That means they did everything that you're supposed to do first. Yep. So, the defeat of hell, death, and the grave in His life is the defeat of hell, death, and the grave in your life. That means Jesus faced hell as a man and said, "I'm leaving," right? "Give me the keys." He faced death as a man and said, "I'm actually going to come back to life. This has no dominion over Me." And then He raised to the summit of opulence and prosperity by putting Himself at the right hand of God in heavenly places. And in Ephesians 2, it says, "And you He raised with Him." So that spiritual reality is what He intends to manifest in your body.

And He wants to save your body. He wants to redeem your body. He wants to heal your body. There's a reason why this stuff is so important to talk about. Because if you have a bad paradigm, you'll have a bad experience. If you believe that you're sick because God's teaching you a lesson, then you'll stay sick. God doesn't use sickness to teach you lessons. He uses this. He uses the government of His Spirit in your life. He doesn't intend to hurt you. He wants to heal you and make you whole.

Part 8

The Hope of the World

You want to turn in the Bible to the book of Romans, chapter 5. You guys are really good, huh? Book of Romans, chapter 5. We're going to start in verse 12. The title of my message today is called "Deathless." Everybody say, "Deathless." All right, it's going to be good. And I'm going to lay some things out that you're going to have to contend with, and some things that I've said happen... I don't say haphazardly, maybe passively in the past, I'm going to say pretty directly. And I think it's going to create a foundation for a gospel that will actually change the city that we live in.

How many of you realize that the local church is the hope of the world? Right? The Bible says that all creation is waiting for the manifestation of the sons of God. It does not say that they're waiting on a rapture. Does not say that they're waiting on death. Doesn't say they're waiting on the coming of Jesus. It says that they want manifest sons of God so that all of creation can be delivered into the liberty of sons of God. So you and I are the hope of the world. Jesus sat down. Do you know when God sits down? When He's done. When He's done, right? God created the earth in six days; on the seventh day He rested. Hebrew says that He rested because He's finished.

So Jesus ascended above every principality, power, might, and dominion, and sat down at the right hand of the Father. They are done. Tapped out, tagged out, you're in. Right? That's how this thing works. So to put our best foot forward as the local church, to reprioritize being a functioning member of a local ekklēsia, the very institution that's supposed to be governing all of human life, is something that you and I need to put in perspective. The fact that you're here says a whole lot about you. I'm going to take a moment and I'm going to call out the people that are watching live. We have an international audience; I will not fault them. But if they are local and able to be here, I am calling you back to the local body. We need you. You're important. You have function, you have destiny, and we need you in these seats. So don't sleep on what's happening in New Philadelphia, because life is coming to New Philadelphia. Amen. All right.

Adam Versus Jesus

All right, so the title of this message is called "Deathless." Romans chapter 5, verse 12: Paul starts to compare the difference between Adam and Jesus. One of the things that I want you to understand is he is not talking about the fallen Adam and the risen Jesus. Adam was flawed from the beginning. I told you I'm going to talk direct about these things, okay? Adam was a

living soul; Jesus was a life-giving spirit. The two embodied were completely different species of being. So when you're born in Adam, it's not just talking about the frailty of Adam's fall, it's talking about Adam's likeness. Adam was made in the image of God. Everybody say, "Image." You are not being returned to the image of Adam. Adam was created; Jesus was begotten. He was the monogenetic Son of God. Jesus is a better Adam. Does this make sense? If your gospel restores you to Adam, it restores you to an image and not the Creator. If you're restored to Adam, you're restored to all of Adam's shortcomings.

The Bible says that Jesus is the only begotten Son of God. So if He's the only begotten Son of God, Adam couldn't be the son of God too. Adam was created in the image of God, so Adam was inherently flawed. So when the Bible contrasts Adam and Jesus, it's contrasting them as men. There are issues with Adam. The issue with Adam was that he was a living soul after he was breathed life into. Okay, I'm going too fast. Book of Romans chapter 5 compares Adam and Jesus. It says Adam, the first man, was a living soul; Jesus, the last Adam, was a life-giving spirit. Right? Adam was a vacuum; Jesus was a resource. The Bible says that Jesus is the last Adam, so there are no more vacuums. There are only resources. "From your innermost being," right, "will flow rivers of living water." You are not the one in need now; you are the one that supplies.

You are not the second born. Jesus was the firstborn among many brethren, and this is how it works: we didn't come to being in order; we came to being in Him all at once. The Bible refers to you and I as the church of the firstborn, meaning collectively we are all as He is, not like Adam is. So for us to understand this, I'm gonna really shoot some sacred cattle right between the eyes, and I hope that's okay. Okay? Only when we establish the gospel that we will establish this morning can we

The Gospel of Victory

see our cities change. Okay? So this is going to take some... like, this is going to take some comprehension. This is going to take some following. This is going to take you not muting your ears when you hear things that are absolutely shocking, because I'm going to wreck some things. Is that all right? Okay. Romans chapter 5, verse 12. It says, "Therefore, just as through one man," everybody say, "One man," "sin entered the world, and death came through sin, thus death spread to all men, because all sinned." Right? Here's our issue: Adam's an issue. Right? Adam fell. Sin came through Adam and death came through Adam. If Jesus is a new man, right, He's the last Adam, but He's the firstborn of many brethren, then is sin or death found in the second Man? Can't be, right? He is the new... He's the never-before-seen version of humanity. He's not a restoration of Adam; He is the monogenetic Son of God.

So if sin and death were the issue, then what's the solution? Righteousness and life. Following me? I want you to keep the title of this message in mind, because it's important: "Deathless." Say, "Deathless." Okay. The salvation that Jesus preached was on this side of death. Okay? Think about it. The salvation that Jesus preached was on our side of death. You cannot responsibly approach the Scriptures and find, in the framework of God, the mouth of the prophets, or the life of Jesus, a message that only gives you hope after you die. Jesus never used the fear of what happens after you die as motivation to follow Him while you live. The gospel that Jesus preached gave you victory now, not in death. We can't pollute the two. We can't say, "It's mostly about that, but it's a little about this." Absolutely not. That is a disgusting reduction in the accomplishment of Jesus.

"I won't have money troubles when I'm dead. I won't be in pain when I'm dead. I won't be depressed when I'm dead. I won't be anxious when I'm dead. My marriage won't suck when I'm dead." Do you hear yourself? How many of you actually can continue to believe that that is the gospel? Good news: die, and all of your problems... Chris, how do I... Yeah, that's what I'm talking about. Okay, now I'm gonna give you

Challenging False Doctrines

something. First, let's lay this foundation. Does something happen to you when you leave this mortal body? You bet it does. Absolutely. Jesus defeated death, so death will never have the final say over humanity. But it's not His intention, right? He gave you a safeguard against death. The safeguard is called sleep. Right? To be absent from the body is to be present with the Lord. So the afterlife is a component of the gospel, but it's not the gospel. Okay? It's not the gospel. And I want to share something with you that might hurt your feelings, but it will also... this is the sacred cattle that's on the griddle today. Okay?

Your soul, by definition, is not an entity. It's a set... it's a possession that allows you to animate this mortal body. The Bible defines it as your mind, will, and emotions; the seat of your emotions, affections, and aversions. Right? It is what people experience of you when they experience your body. You can tell what I do, you can tell what I think, you can tell what I feel, because you see my soul animating this body. Right? It is not an entity. It is a component of your inherent humanity, and when your body dies, so does your soul. Your spirit is the eternal component of your humanity. Does this make sense? Okay.

Now, how many of you ever heard of Socrates and Plato? Yep. Socrates was the mentor of Plato. Plato published a lot of what Socrates spoke of, kind of got some credit for it. But here's the deal: how many have you ever heard of a soul winner? Right? Or a burden for souls? Or "Let's get souls saved"? Right? The Bible says that the salvation of your soul is the end of your

faith. The salvation of your soul isn't the eternal destination of your soul. It's literally when there's no believing left to do, then your soul will be in perfect harmony with your spirit. It has nothing to do... either there's nothing that you can tactfully superimpose over this that makes your soul your eternal component.

Socrates had a theory, and his theory initially was kind of, like, tongue-in-cheek. They were trying to figure out how they can control civilized society. They weren't Christians; they were philosophers. So Socrates was the first one that said, "Why don't we tell everyone that the non-material portion of their humanity is going to be in deep trouble if they're not compliant while they're in their body?" Do you know that Socrates said it kind of as a joke to Plato? And then when Socrates was dying, he told Plato, like, winking, "Remember, today you're only burying my body and not my soul." And then Plato said, "You know what? This can be very useful. We can manipulate and control droves of people." Did you know this is where your gospel originated?

"We can manipulate and control droves of people if we convince them that there is a punishment that we can't prove. If they aren't compliant to the state while they're in the body, if they're not functioning moral members of society, then we will convince them that punishment awaits. But we can't prove it. We can't say that anybody's ever gone there. We can't say that anybody's ever gone through it, which is why we can hold our story with dignity, because if you can't prove it, you can't deny it either." Do you understand what I'm saying? Okay. I'm not attacking the heaven-hell thing. I'm not attacking the judgment thing right now. All I'm saying is that the gospel we preach is a Platonic gospel, not Jesus's. Okay? "If you repeat my prayer and you follow these rules, then there is no non-material punishment waiting for you when you're done." That's a terrifying message, right? And it really works to bring civilized society into manipulation and control. Here's the problem: Jesus never preached it.

Reigning in Life

Paul... Jesus never preached it. John never preached it. Peter preached it, and then he got in trouble for it. You guys with me? The authentic gospel gives you victory in this life, not in death. Not... I shouldn't say that; you guys are going to tweet the wrong thing. Okay. The authentic gospel is intended to give you victory in life, not just victory in death. Are you with me? Okay. Romans chapter 5, verse 13. It says, "For until the law sin was in the world, but it wasn't imputed where there's no law. Nevertheless death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over those who had not sinned according to the likeness of the transgression of Adam, who is a type of Him who is to come. But the free gift is not like the offense. For if by one man's offense many died, much more the grace of God and the gift by the grace of one Man, Jesus Christ, abounded to many. And the gift is not like that which came through the one who

sinned. For the judgment which came from the offense resulted in condemnation, but the free gift which comes from..." offense, excuse me, "from many offenses resulted in justification."

Here's what I'm trying to get to: "For if by one man's offense death reigned through the one, much more those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness will..." Is anybody following along? What's this say? "...reign in life through the One, Jesus Christ." Is that different than making sure that you suffer through this but a moment so that you can get to a grave and have a better experience? Nobody wants that gospel. I won't want that gospel. I don't want to preach that gospel. I don't want to be known for that gospel. I want to live a victorious, ever-increasing life where people can see it in my marriage, they can see it in my finances, they can see it in my health, and by God, they're going to see it in my city.

We've wondered why the church is such a laughingstock. We're going to the streets; we're literally sacrificing our dignity to tell people bad news. Guys with me? "Hey, repeat my prayer and you won't have to go get punished after you die." "You didn't even know you were going to get punished? So sorry." It's not there. That's not the gospel. The gospel is that decay would be lifted from your life. You hear me? The gospel is that decay would be lifted from your life, and that everything about you would start to keep pace with an ever-increasing kingdom. Okay. Let's talk about the word "death" real quick. Okay? Death

Defining Death as Decay

in the Bible has zero definitions that implicate eternal separation from God. That is a man-made... Listen, I'm not attacking your hell. I'm not. But I am fixing your life. Okay? Zero implications about it being torturous, about it being eternal separation. None of that. When the Bible uses the word "death," it literally means decay. It's a universal decline. It's a universal rotting away of everything about you. Right? The life that we live now, what we expect is to hit a hill. Right? We use the term "over the hill." Over the hill. What do we expect on the back side of the hill? Right? You spend the first 55 years of your life earning, earning, earning, earning, earning, and they hit 55 and you start spending, spending, spending, spending, spending, spending, and you go to the grave with nothing. Right?

Where you spend the first 55 years of your life getting healthy and learning skills and learning trades, and then your mind goes bad and you start forgetting said skills and trades and relationships. And we expect a moment where we begin to decay, and oddly, we expect that decay to lead us to our salvation. What an odd gospel. If the gospel were about death, the most compassionate thing that you can do for any human being is hold them under longer when you baptize them. It's a funny thought, but consider this, please. One of the things that is lacking in our Western culture is that we refuse to question the things that we take for granted. What I

mean by that is you can believe in a gospel that is completely centered around where you're going to spend eternity, and you never consider the fact that you never have read it in your Bible.

We can spend our entire lives trying to become soul winners without ever realizing that the souls that we're trying to save don't have an eternal component. The gospel that we preach more accurately accompanies Plato's philosophy than it does Jesus's doctrine. Now, one of the things that I don't want to do is I don't want to have to, like, give disclaimers every time I say something shocking. I'm not saying that, like, the eternal state of your spirit is a guarantee. Okay? So I'm not saying that... just because your soul isn't eternal doesn't mean that there isn't an eternal component of your humanity. To be absent from your body is to be eternally present with the Lord. So I'm not taking that from you. Nobody will take that from you. Jesus won't take that from you, and I certainly won't. But what I also won't rob you of is reigning in life.

If sin and death are the issue... right? Sin and death are the issue. Hell is not the issue; sin and death are the issue. So verse 17 gives us the illusion: "If by one man's offense death reigned through the one, much more those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness will reign in life through the One, Jesus Christ." So sin and death are the issues; righteousness and life are the solutions. It's not a get-out-of-hell-free pass. It's a live-abundantly-now pass. It's a deathless pass. It removes decay from your life. You guys okay? Okay. Hmm. The word that the Bible uses

Jesus and Deathlessness

for death as a human being is the Greek word apothnēskō, and it uses the word over and over and over and over again. And one of the easiest ways for you to understand the definition of a word is to find all of its contexts. Right? Okay. So Jesus announces Himself in Lazarus's predicament as two different solutions. Right? He tells Lazarus's sister that He's the resurrection and the life. Right? Why is He the resurrection? Because death's an issue. Why is He the life? Because there are some that won't taste death. So you do not have to die to get your inheritance. That's not how wills and testaments work. You guys ever question that? Right? "I'm an heir and I have to die to get what's coming to me." That's just flat-out not how they work.

So Jesus announces Himself as the resurrection and the life. He said, "He who believes in Me, though he may die, he shall live." Right? So He's giving an after-death solution to death, which is resurrection. But then He says, "And whoever lives and believes in Me..." Everybody say this: "Everybody who lives and believes in Me." Okay, we're going to go through a short checklist. Are you alive? Do you believe in Him? We're done. Here's the next line: "...shall

never die." How do you feel about this? You good with it? Okay. Because I just showed you two spots. Romans 5:17 says they will reign in life. So here's another one, where He says, "If you die, I'm the resurrection. Even though you do die, you'll live. And those who believe in Me and are alive shall never die." They're deathless. Okay?

Death is a principle. Okay? The ultimate culmination of apothnēskō is that your body ceases to exist. Okay? But that is not the entire picture of death. The entire picture of death is decay. Okay? It's anything... anything that does not keep pace with an ever-increasing kingdom. How's your mood? Death. How's your anxiety? Death. Jesus didn't even allow apothnēskō death to enter His finances. Jesus saw 5,000 hungry people, and when He told His disciples that it was their responsibility to feed them, He demonstrated that He lived according to a different realm, because giving for Him did not mean that what I have minus what I give equals what I have left. Can you hear me? What He gave was more than what He had, and then what He was left with was twelve baskets. Okay?

So what did He start with? Loaves, fish. Right? Five loaves, two fish. Regular loaves, smaller fish than I catch. They fed 5,000 people. Now how's this work? And they took up twelve baskets full for themselves. He did not allow His finances to see decay. How's your mood? How's your anxiety? How are your finances? How's your marriage? How's your attitude? Is it life? Are you reigning in life, or are you allowing... listen... the seed of death to reign? Apothnēskō. Are you allowing the seed of death to permeate the areas where you're supposed to be reigning in life? Because that's what this gospel does. Right? Here's the trap:

Destroying the Power of Fear

if you allow bad teaching and poor doctrine to push your promises into an era that nobody has guaranteed that they see, you will live without... you will live as a pauper when you're supposed to be reigning right now. There's a reason Jesus said, "No one has seen the Father at any time except for the One that came down from the Father." He was the only one, the only begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth. That's the guy. Right? So if the church, listen, keeps preaching, "You have your promise when you die." "How do you know?" "I don't know. I can't prove it. I've never been there." What a garbage gospel. What happens when we get hold of this and we start expecting increase, governing increase, rather than allowing apothnēskō to govern us? It's not okay. It's not the gospel. It's not the way that it's supposed to be.

Go to the book of Hebrews, chapter 2. You guys all right? Okay, ready? Verse 14. Is that where I told you to start? No, I did. "Inasmuch then as the children have partaken of flesh and blood, He Himself likewise shared in the same." Okay, it's kind of an odd way to put it, but let me break it down for you: His children became human, so did He. So it says, "Inasmuch as the

children have partaken of flesh and blood, He Himself likewise shared the same, that through death He might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil." Okay? You understand what it's saying? The God of creation became a human being so He could die on your behalf, so that He could allow, by His own will and intention, death to overtake Him, so He could step on death's head for you.

He tasted death, the Bible says, once and for all. And when we use the word "death," we're not talking about hell. We're not talking about just the separation from your spirit and body. We're talking about the environment of decay, everything that does not keep pace with an ever-increasing kingdom. Mortal death is the recognition point of a life lived under a government of decay.

Salvation as Wholeness

It's important that you don't confuse failure with the recognition of failure, success with the recognition of success, right? On your graduation day you held up a diploma or a doctorate or whatever it might be. That day was not your day of success; that was the recognition of probably seven solid years of discipline and commitment. So death, bodily death, is the result of a long time of being held in the bondage of death. Being delivered from the bondage of death is the gospel. With me? Okay.

"Inasmuch then as the children have partaken of flesh and blood, He Himself likewise shared in the same, that through death He might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil, and release those who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage." Where does bondage come from? Fear of death, right? Think about everything that causes you fear and anxiety, right? What are you afraid of? Decay, right? You're afraid to give because you're afraid of death, right? You're afraid to let your walls down relationally because you're afraid of relational death. Everything that you do that holds you in bondage is actually just being governed by apothnēskō, by death. Jesus tasted death for everybody so that you who were held in the fear of death would be released from your bondage. Once you're not afraid of death anymore, you're free.

It is confounding to watch somebody run to Jesus and say, "My brother's sick unto death," and Him say, "I'm gonna take a four-day vacay, and then I'll come check it out," right? Why do you think He was able to do that? Because listen, He wasn't Adam. He wasn't something that was an open vacuum that needed something from the outside in to sustain Him. He was the river of life. He was a life-giving spirit. He was not held in the bondage of fear. He could give away His five loaves and two fish and know that at the end of His giving He would have more than He started with, because He knows that His entire environment is an environment of increase.

That was God's intention for Adam. It says that God created the garden, but then He wouldn't allow it to rain until Adam was in it, because Adam's responsibility was to govern increase. Making sense? Are you okay with it so far? Are you sure?

The Thief vs. the Shepherd

John 10. How do you guys feel about the word "saved"? You like it? I like it. It's a biblical word, but all of its definitions are natural. Sōzō, saved: all of its definitions are natural. It means healed, delivered, made whole, kept safe and sound, the absence of all things harmful and the presence of all things beneficial. So the salvation that we preach is healing, it's deliverance, it's safety, it's provision, and it's heaven on earth. When we ask ourselves if our loved ones are saved, you would be able to see the evidence of their salvation in their life, not just in their death. Make sense? Where'd I tell you to go? John. Good idea. John 10, I'll just keep flipping. John 10, let's go to verse 7. Nope, let's go to verse 1.

"Most assuredly, I say to you, he who does not enter the sheepfold by the door, but climbs up some other way, the same is a thief and a robber." Everybody hear that? Who's a thief and a robber? Anybody that climbs up another way. "But he who enters by the door is the shepherd of the sheep. To him the doorkeeper opens, and the sheep hear his voice; and he calls his own sheep by name and leads them out. And when he brings out his own sheep, he goes before them; and the sheep follow him, for they know his voice. Yet they will by no means follow a stranger, but will flee from him, for they do not know the voice of strangers. Jesus used this illustration, but they did not understand the things which He spoke to them." Then He explained Himself: "Most assuredly, I say to you, I am the door of the sheep. All who ever came before Me are thieves and robbers, but the sheep did not hear them."

Okay, did you check that out? Okay, you have to read that for you to have good theology about theft, death and destruction. "All who ever came before Me are thieves and robbers, but the sheep did not hear them. I am the door. If anyone"—excuse me—"enters by Me, he will be saved"—whole, healed, delivered, kept safe and sound, the absence of all things harmful, the presence of all things beneficial—"and will go in and out and find pasture. The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly." Okay, so how many of you ever heard, "That old devil comes to steal, kill and destroy"? Is that what this passage says? No. All who came before Me—anybody that told you that you could get to life by earning, striving, trying and deserving—is a thief and is a robber. Legalism is death, right?

I'm almost done, I promise. "But I have come that they might go to heaven when they die, and go to heaven when they die hard." Is that what it says? No. He released you through the fear of

death, right? He released you by tasting death for you. He says in John 10 that He did not come so that you could be stolen, killed or destroyed. He took that from you, that you might have life, and that life would be more abundant, right? Okay, last thing, promise. Three things. Three things that you need to be keenly

The Keys to Life

aware of concerning life and death. Wow, this is a long message. You're lucky I didn't preach it. Okay, Alan, quickly, probably ten minutes. Baptizers, wherever they are. Okay, so three things concerning increase and decay. Whether you live a life of increase or a life of decay is biblically founded on three things. One is what you choose. Life and good is a free-will decision. All three of the things that I'm about to explain to you tie in, because if your paradigm expects death and decay, then you will die in decay by faith. Make sense? Death comes as a seed.

How many of you ever had something really tragic happen around a holiday, right? Okay, so certain holidays have, like, weather patterns, they have music, they have sensory things that remind you of the bad thing that happened, right? So anytime that you have sensual stimulation, you immediately go to an emotion that's based on a prediction, right? So somebody passed away Christmas 20 years ago; now Christmas is terrible every Christmas, because your emotion comes back based on your sensual perception. That's the seed of death, right? That's something that's coming to try to govern you, and if you don't know any better, you will welcome it in by faith.

The next time you write a check, just like Jesus did, right? You write a check, you expect what you had minus what you gave to be what you're left with. That is not Jesus's economy. "I had a little bit, I gave a whole bunch, and then I had more than I started with": that's Jesus's economy. It's an ever-increasing economy. He had no fear of lack, He had no fear of death, He had no fear of disease. He demonstrated that. The leper says, "Are You willing to make me clean?" and Jesus touched him. Why do you think He touched him? To demonstrate that decay was not part of His life. This is what Jesus modeled.

So what was the first thing I told you? Choice. Choice. Deuteronomy 30, you don't have to turn here, I'm just going to read it. It says, "This commandment which I command you today"—and this is, I love how they put it, you need to pay attention—"is not too mysterious for you, nor is it far off. It is not in heaven, that you should say, 'Who will ascend into heaven for us and bring it to us, that we may hear it and do it?' Nor is it beyond the sea, that you should say, 'Who will go over the sea for us and bring it to us, that we may hear it and do it?' But the word is very near you, in your mouth and in your heart, that you may do it. See, I have set before you today

life and good, death and evil, in that I command you today to love the Lord your God, to walk in His ways, and to keep His commandments, His statutes, and His judgments, that you may live and multiply."

So what is He saying? It's not tough to figure out. How would you like it if a prophet came to you and said, "It's not that hard, guys. You don't have to go to heaven, you don't even have to cross the sea. It's in your mouth and it's in your heart. I put before you life and good, death and evil." Notice how these things are in clusters: life is good, death is evil. Now He gives them some instructions: "The Lord your God will bless you in the land which you go to possess. But if your heart turns away so that you do not hear, and are drawn away, and worship other gods and serve them, I announce to you today that you shall surely perish; you shall not prolong your days in the land which you cross over the Jordan to go in and possess. I call heaven and earth as witnesses today against you, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing; therefore choose life, that both you and your descendants may live."

You have this moment, this opportunity, every moment of every day. When you decide to partner with that next mood, when you decide to partner with that next criticism, when you decide to partner with the next judgment, offense, whatever it might be, you have the opportunity: "I have life and good in front of me, and I have death and decay." Oh, that you might choose, because your grandkids are watching. And that's what He said: "you and your descendants may live." What if your grandkids never saw you out of step with an ever-increasing kingdom? Come on, guys. What happens then?

Number one, it's a choice. Number two, it's a confession. The Bible says life and death is in the power of the tongue. Every time you open your mouth, you kill something or give it life. Get used to that. Death comes as a seed. You won't complain and have something fall over dead in front of you, but it will happen. You understand that all of creation responds to your voice? All of creation responds to your attitude and atmosphere. Life and death is in the power of the tongue. So once you've chosen, you have to confess what you've chosen.

And lastly, the Bible says, "My people perish." Does anybody know the rest? "For lack of knowledge." You have to choose, you have to confess, by God, you have to be aware. You have to ditch your doctrines of death. You have to ditch your doctrines of demons. "My people perish." Now, I would go through it; it'll take me 20 minutes to go through a lexicon—what's it called?—a contextual study of apothnēskō, but the word always means death. It never means hell, it never means the grave; it just means decay, every single time. Class, what kind of death? Death death, but for-real kind. So life and death is in the power of the tongue, right? Oh, that you would choose life, and life more abundantly. And "my people perish," because that's what they expect, because they don't know any better. Would you stand with me?

Call to Repentance

The local church ceased to be Adamic 2,000 years ago. The Bible refers to Jesus as the last Adam. So how many Adams do we have now? Absolutely zero. He became like Adam so He could kill Adam's shortcomings and be raised the only begotten Son of the Father. And then He placed you in Himself, in His death, burial and resurrection, so that His life is now your life. His conquest and victory over death is in your past, not your future. Paul said today is the day of salvation: not when you die, not when you repeat a prayer. Today, the whole thing, is the day of salvation.

And here's what I'd like to submit to you: it is the workings of an effective local church that bring life to a region. I'll be quick about this, but do you realize that there are apostolic outpost centers in every—that is God's design. To redeem creation was to establish an ekklesia and put a government in that ekklesia. The responsibility of that government was to bring believers to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ, so that we could continually give life to our metron, to our region. We're responsible for New Philly. We can't be responsible for New Philly sitting on our couches. We can't be responsible for addiction recovery in New Philly if we won't get involved in addiction recovery. We can't be responsible for New Philly if you won't control your attitude and mood. Every time you open your mouth, something comes to life or starts to die.

Oh, that you would choose life, because your grandkids are counting on it: you and your kids, your kids' kids, and your kids' kids' kids. They want to live. And I would venture to say that there's never been a generation that has glamoured and glorified death more than ours. Today's a day of reckoning and repentance. Amen? Amen. My goodness. So listen: choose, confess and know. Those are the keys to life and life abundant. Amen? Amen.

All right, can I pray over all of you again? There's this thing that I believe heavily in: when you take a physical act of obedience to step forward into what you believe God's calling you to, you'll be able to recognize moments, and there'll be supernatural spiritual release over your physical response to what God's doing. So if you are repenting of your lifestyle of death and decay, would you just put your hands out while I pray over you and receive an impartation? And while your hands are out, if you feel something change in your body—I fully expect disease to disintegrate, I fully just expect pain to go away, because you're going to be living, moving into an area of increase rather than decay. Amen.

All right, so Father, I thank You so much for this incredible group of human beings. I thank You that we receive and believe that Your gospel is one that causes us to reign in life as we confess, choose and know this morning. I thank You that bank accounts are being

supernaturally filled today. I thank You that people are becoming supernaturally generous, because they're not using the same math they used to when contemplating what they might give. I thank You that bodies are being healed, that decay no longer has a say over where we go, what we do and what we receive. And I confess this morning that these be the sons of life and life abundant. Father, we receive these things in Jesus' name.